

ALGEBRAIC TOPOLOGY

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References and textbooks: [Vic94; Hat02; Kam22]. Further reading: [May99; Die08; GJ09; BT82; Bre93]. For the required homological algebra preliminary, we refer to [Wei94, Chapter 1-3], and a cheat sheet is in Appendix A.

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PREFACE

These are the lecture notes for Algebraic Topology, taught in the summer term of 2026 at the Kyiv School of Economics for master students. In this lecture, we try to give an introduction to basic notions and applications for algebraic topology. Due to time constraints, we will not try to cover too many details, but at least we will state many results precisely.

However, we also do not want students to restrict themselves on very standard topics. So, we try to present materials in a way that is easier to relate to some further aspects of algebraic topology that we didn't carefully discuss in the lecture.

Here are some examples: 1) We try to emphasize more about the simplicial set structure of singular simplexes, which gives a first glimpse of simplicial homotopy theory and ∞ -category in an introductory course for algebraic topology; 2) We focus on the Mayer-Vietoris and mapping cone approach for the long exact sequence rather than the relative homology approach. The reason is that those tools are somewhat closer to sheaf theory and stable ∞ -categories (the ∞ -version of triangulated categories). In the process, we may see more about how to use

the notion of cofibration without going too much into actual homotopy theory. Especially, we will construct the cellular homology without relative homology, which essentially has no big difference but sees a little more on the space level.

In addition, we make such an attempt by state supplement comments on some content about their related notion in different/further directions (which means that you can safely skip them). We will see some short discussions on de Rham theory, some ideas on $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -algebra when discussing the cup product, and many others.

On the other hand, we put many technical discussions in exercises, but we try to organize all those materials easy to follow by students themselves by subdividing the big results into more step-by-step questions. We hope students will not lose too much technical training by carefully completing all those exercises.

Theoretically, our students have basic knowledge about homological algebra, so the discussion didn't show too much in the main content, but we still prepared a cheat sheet for the convenience of readers.

PHILOSOPHICAL INTRODUCTION

Algebraic topology aims to use **invariants** constructed from abstract algebra to help us detect **different** topological spaces. Let's start with one example.

Example. Consider the digits with the following font



We treat them as subspaces A of $\mathbb{R}^2$ (i.e., the blackboard). Could you classify them up to homeomorphisms?

Answer: They form 4 homeomorphic classes (for simplicity, we use the usual font to represent them)

$$\{1, 2, 5, 7\}, \{6, 9\}, \{3, 4\}, \{8\}.$$

For the class $\{1, 2, 5, 7\}$, it is direct to construct homeomorphisms between them, and all of them are homeomorphic to the interval $[0, 1]$.

For the class $\{6, 9\}$, they are related by a rotation by π .

For the class $\{3, 4\}$, they are homeomorphic to a letter Y .

However, how to show they are different classes? First tool, we consider we can consider the number of (path) connected components after removing one point from A . Then you can distinguish the class $\{1, 2, 5, 7\}$ and $\{3, 4\}$. Second tool, you can consider how many loops are in A .

You may abstract the strategy into graph theory. But we are thinking differently, we are more interested in what kind of invariant we can extract from topology! For example, here we use

$$|\pi_0(A \setminus a)| = |\{\text{Path components of } A \setminus a\}|,$$

and

$$b_1(A) = \text{"The number of (independent) loops in } A\text{"}$$

Both of them can be constructed from the invariant we will develop in the course!

The next question: for the two classes $\{1, 2, 5, 7\}$ and $\{3, 4\}$, if we allow them to be manipulated like play-dough (for example, we can flatten and stretch), then these two classes cannot be distinguished.

It tells us one important idea: It is crucial to tell the precise meaning of **different**! It means you need to have a standard to distinguish spaces. Moreover, sometimes, it makes things easier if you allow a more flexible classification standard!

- Whether something is an invariant or not is sensitive to your standard.
- In the future, you will find that the idea you can learn from the course can be applied not only to topological spaces, but also to algebraic varieties, or many other things (for example, data, where there exists a subject called topological data analysis).

In this course, we will mainly focus on

Homotopy invariants such as homology, cohomology, and homotopy groups of spaces.

With them, we will see some of the very famous theorems are proven easily using homology theory:

- (1) Brouwer fixed point theorem: A continuous map between D^n must have a fixed point.
- (2) Dimension invariance: Let $U \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ and $V \subset \mathbb{R}^m$ are non-empty open sets. Suppose U and V are homeomorphic, then $m = n$.

Remark. It is possible to define certain homeomorphic invariants, or diffeomorphic invariants. However, it would be hard to define and compute them. It is a compromise that we focus on homotopy invariants. They are rough in some sense, however, computable (but still hard in general). But anyway: Good invariants are those both computable and distinguish enough things! It means that you have to give up something to make life easier and more effective.

1. HOMOTOPY AND HOMOTOPIC EQUIVALENCE

Now, we go to some actual math.

In this course, we always equip $I = [0, 1]$ with the usual topology. We set $S^n = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^{n+1} \mid |x| = 1\}$ and $D^{n+1} = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^{n+1} \mid |x| \leq 1\}$, where $|x|$ is the 2-norm of x .

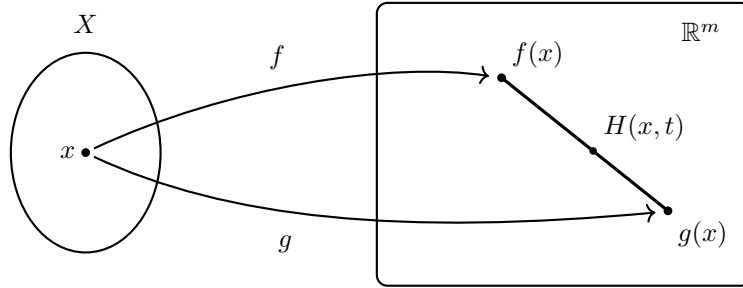
All spaces are assumed to be topological spaces, and all maps are assumed to be continuous (in case I forget to mention topological/continuity).

Definition 1.1. Let $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$ be two continuous maps. We say they are homotopic if there exists a continuous map $H : X \times I \rightarrow Y$ such that $H(x, 0) = f(x)$ and $H(x, 1) = g(x)$, and we say the map H is a homotopy between f, g . We often denote $f \stackrel{H}{\simeq} g$, or $f \simeq g$ if H is clear.

Exercise 1.2. Show that the homotopic relation between maps defines an equivalence relation on the set of continuous maps $C^0(X, Y)$. We often write $[X, Y] = C^0(X, Y)/hmtp$, and a homotopy class is denoted by $[f]$. For composable maps, we may define $[g] \circ [f] := [g \circ f]$, and show that this is well-defined.

Example 1.3. Let $f, g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ be two continuous maps, then they are homotopic. In fact, we can set the straight line homotopy

$$H(x, t) = (1 - t)f(x) + tg(x).$$



Notice that it is important that $\mathbb{R}^m$ is linear, otherwise it does not make sense for the formula.

Example 1.4. Set $S^1 = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : |z| = 1\}$. Let $f, g : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ where f is the identity map, and g is the constant map $g(z) = 1$. Then we have f and g are not homotopic. We are not able to prove it at this time.

But you can learn from the example that the homotopic relation is sensitive to the codomain of the maps since f, g are indeed homotopic if we think of them as maps into $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Definition 1.5. We say two topological spaces are homotopy equivalent if there exists $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow X$ such that $fg \simeq \text{id}_Y$ and $gf \simeq \text{id}_X$.

Exercise 1.6. Show that the homotopy equivalence relation between spaces defines an equivalence relation on the set of all topological spaces.

If the two spaces are homotopy equivalent, then we say they have the same homotopy type, and in the same manner, we say one equivalent class of spaces with respect to the homotopy equivalence relation is a homotopy type.

Remark 1.7. It is clear that if two spaces are homeomorphic, then they are homotopy equivalent (i.e., have the same homotopy type). But the converse is not true, for example, $\mathbb{R}^m$ ($m \geq 1$) is homotopy equivalent to a point by Example 1.9 below, but $\mathbb{R}^m$ is not homeomorphic to a point since they have different cardinality.

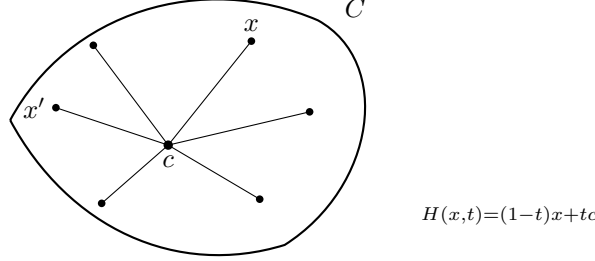
You may think that the homotopy equivalence relation is too flexible. However, you will see in the future that classifying spaces by homotopy equivalence is an impossible mission (but still more approachable than homeomorphic classification)

Definition 1.8. A non-empty space X is said to be contractible if it is homotopy equivalent to a point, equivalently, if it has the homotopy type of a point.

Example 1.9. Let $C \subset V$ be a convex set in a real topological vector space V (for example $V = \mathbb{R}^n$). We claim that for any $c \in C$, the two spaces C and $\{c\}$ are homotopy equivalent. In particular, convex sets are contractible.

In fact, let $i : \{c\} \rightarrow C$ be the inclusion, and we define $r : C \rightarrow \{c\}$ as the constant map. Then we have $ri = \text{id}_{\{c\}}$, and $f = ir : C \rightarrow C$ is given by $f(x) = c$ (but whose codomain is C not $\{c\}$). We conclude by showing that $f \simeq \text{id}_C$.

We can actually use the linear homotopy constructed in Example 1.3, which works since C is a convex set.



Exercise 1.10. Show 1) a space X is contractible if and only if the id_X is homotopic to a constant map $c_{x_0} : X \rightarrow X$ for $x_0 \in X$; 2) a contractible space is path-connected; 3) Similar to Example 1.3, show that if Y is contractible, then any two continuous map $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$ are homotopic.

Remark 1.11. Variants of the definitions

(1) For $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$, and a subspace $A \subset X$, we say $f \simeq_A g$, and say f is homotopic to g relative to A , if $f \simeq g$ and $H(a, t) = f(a) = g(a)$ for $(a, t) \in A \times I$.

(2) For a topological space X and a subspace $A \subset X$, we consider the space pair (X, A) . A map $f : (X, A) \rightarrow (Y, B)$ means a map $f : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $f(A) \subset B$.

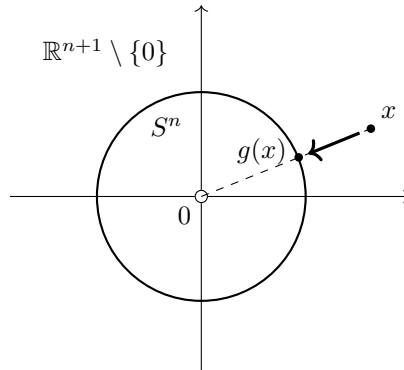
Then one can define homotopic maps and homotopy equivalence between pairs similarly.

It is often (but NOT always) the case that during a topology space is homotopy equivalent to a subspace. We have the definition:

Definition 1.12. A subspace $i : A \subset X$ is a deformation retract of X if there is a retraction $g : X \rightarrow A$ (i.e., a map $g : X \rightarrow A$ with $g(a) = a$ for every $a \in A$) such that $ig \simeq \text{id}_X$.

A subspace A of X is a strong deformation retract if there is a retraction $g : X \rightarrow A$ such that $ig \stackrel{H}{\simeq} \text{id}_X$ through a homotopy H with the property $H(a, t) = a$ for all $(a, t) \in A \times I$. Precisely, i.e. $ig \stackrel{H}{\simeq} \text{id}_X$ relative to A .

Example 1.13. Let $X = \mathbb{R}^{n+1} \setminus \{0\}$, and $A = S^n$. Then we have $g(x) = x/|x|$ gives a retraction that makes A a strong deformation retract of X , where we may take $H(x, t) = |x|^{t-1}x : X \times I \rightarrow X$.

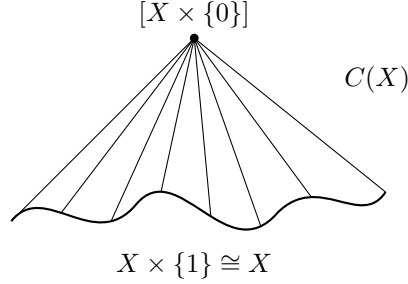


Exercise 1.14. Similar to the argument of Example 1.9, show that if A is a deformation retract of X , then A is homotopy equivalent to X .

Exercise 1.15. Let X be a topological space, and we define the cone of X as the quotient space $C(X) := X \times [0, 1] / X \times \{0\}$.

Show that 1) $C(S^n) \cong D^{n+1}$ are homeomorphic; 2) For any X , we have $C(X)$ is contractible. In particular, D^{n+1} is contractible.

Hint: Try to show that $[X \times \{0\}] \in C(X)$ is a strong deformation retract of $C(X)$. You may also convince yourself by seeing what happened for $X = S^n$.



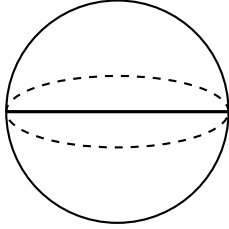
Exercise 1.16. Try to convince yourself that the following spaces are all homotopy equivalent. If it is possible, write down homotopies between the relevant maps.

- A S^2 adding a diameter.
- A torus $T^2 = S^1 \times S^1$ glued with a disk along the meridian.
- A S^2 glued with a tangential S^1 .

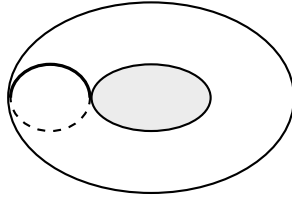
S^2 with a diameter

T^2 with a disk glued along a meridian

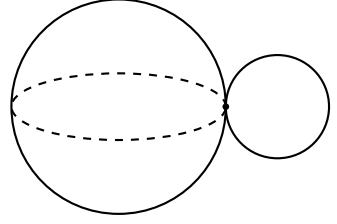
S^2 with a tangential S^1



(1)



(2)



(3)

Definition 1.17. Let $(X_k, x_k)_{k \in K}$ be a K family of pointed spaces, i.e. $x_k \in X_k$ is a given point for every $k \in K$. We define

$$\bigvee_{k \in K} X_k = \bigsqcup_{k \in K} X_k / \sim$$

where the relation is asking all base points $(x_k, k) \in \bigsqcup_{k \in K} X_k$ are identified to a single new marked point pt and equipping the quotient topology on it. Then the pointed space $(\bigvee_{k \in K} X_k, \text{pt})$ is called the wedge sum (or one-point union, or simply wedge) of the family $(X_k, x_k)_{k \in K}$.

For example, all of 3 spaces in the previous example are homotopy equivalent to $S^2 \vee S^1$ for some marked points. Or $S^n / \sim$ by collapsing the equator is homeomorphic to $S^n \vee S^n$.

Exercise 1.18. We consider the infinite-dimensional sphere: Consider the space of square summable sequences $\ell^2(\mathbb{C})$, and set

$$S^\infty := \{(c_i)_{i \in \mathbb{N}} \in \ell^2(\mathbb{C}) \mid c_i \in \mathbb{C}, \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}} |c_i|^2 = 1\}.$$

Show that S^∞ is contractible.

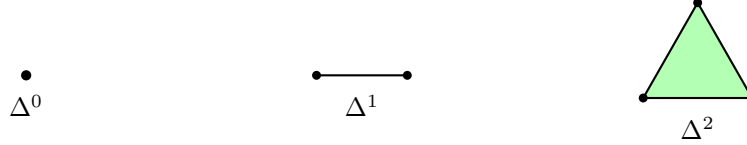
Notice that: we will see later that for each $n \geq 1$, S^n is not contractible.

2. SINGULAR HOMOLOGY

2.1. Singular simplexes. We start from the combinatorial structure of topological simplexes.

Definition 2.1. Let $q \geq 0$ be an integer, we set q -simplex as the topological space (with the subspace topology).

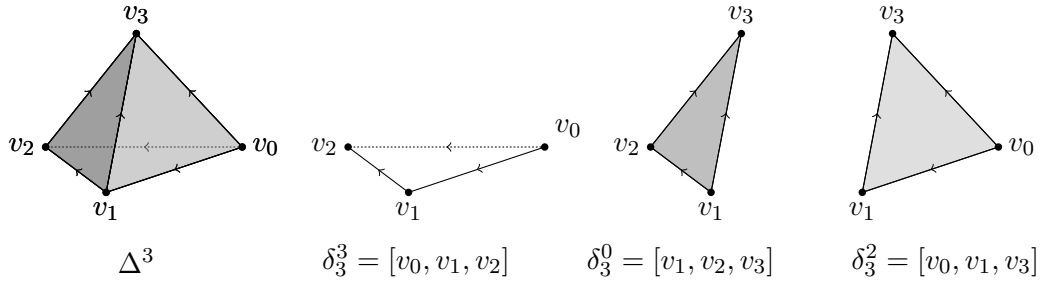
$$\Delta^q = \{(t_0, \dots, t_q) \in \mathbb{R}^{q+1} \mid \forall i, t_i \geq 0, \sum_{i=0}^q t_i = 1\}.$$



Example 2.2. For example, we have $\Delta^1 \cong I = [0, 1]$. Precisely, $\Delta^1 = \{(1-t, t) \mid t \in [0, 1]\} \cong \{t \mid t \in [0, 1]\}$.

It is easy to see that $\Delta^q \cong D^q$ for all q . All Δ_q are convex, so they are contractible.

We set v_i for $i = 0, \dots, q$ to be the vertices of Δ^q where only $t_i = 1$ and all others are zero. With the notation, we often write a simplex by $[v_0, \dots, v_q]$.



It is important that Δ^q carries many combinatorial information: Fix $q \geq 1$, for all $i = 0, \dots, q$, we can define a continuous map (be careful when $i = 0$)

$$\delta_q^i : \Delta^{q-1} \rightarrow \Delta^q, \quad \delta_q^i(t_0, \dots, t_{q-1}) = (t_0, \dots, t_{i-1}, 0, t_i, \dots, t_{q-1}).$$

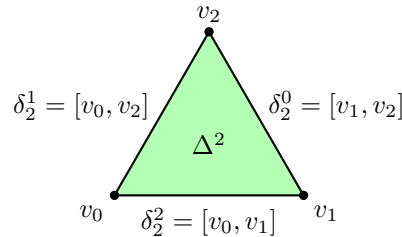
We call δ_q^i or its image the i -th face of Δ^q . If you draw the picture, the name motives very well!

If q is clear, we often write $\delta^i = \delta_q^i$. Using the notation $[v_0, \dots, v_q]$, we can write $\delta_q^i = [v_0, \dots, \hat{v}_i, \dots, v_q]$.

Example 2.3. When $q = 1$, we have $\delta_1^0 = \{(0, 1)\} \subset \Delta^1$, and $\delta_1^1 = \{(1, 0)\} \subset \Delta^1$.

Under the identification $\Delta^1 = \{(1-t, t) \mid t \in [0, 1]\} \cong \{t \mid t \in [0, 1]\}$. We have δ_1^0 is identified with $1 \in [0, 1]$ and δ_1^1 is identified with $0 \in [0, 1]$.

When $q = 2$, you can see the picture below, and $q = 3$ above (space reason there is no δ_3^1)



On the other hand, we shall consider, for $i = 0, \dots, q$,

$$\sigma_q^i : \Delta^{q+1} \rightarrow \Delta^q, \quad \sigma_q^i(t_0, \dots, t_{q+1}) = (t_0, \dots, t_{i-1}, t_i + t_{i+1}, t_{i+2}, \dots, t_{q+1}).$$

They are called elementary degenerate simplexes: Degeneration in the sense that the domain has a higher dimension than the range, and some parts of Δ^q are collapsed in a certain way. Similar to faces, we often write $\sigma^i = \sigma_q^i$.

Exercise 2.4. (1) For every $q \geq 2$ and every $0 \leq i < j \leq q$,

$$\delta_q^j \circ \delta_{q-1}^i = \delta_q^i \circ \delta_{q-1}^{j-1} : \Delta^{q-2} \rightarrow \Delta^q.$$

(2) For every $q \geq 0$ and every $0 \leq i \leq j \leq q$,

$$\sigma_q^j \circ \sigma_{q+1}^i = \sigma_q^i \circ \sigma_{q+1}^{j+1} : \Delta^{q+2} \rightarrow \Delta^q.$$

(3) For every $q \geq 1$, every $0 \leq i \leq q$, and every $0 \leq j \leq q+1$,

$$\sigma_q^j \circ \delta_{q+1}^i = \begin{cases} \delta_q^i \circ \sigma_{q-1}^{j-1}, & i < j, \\ \text{id}_{\Delta^q}, & i = j \text{ or } i = j+1, \\ \delta_q^{i-1} \circ \sigma_{q-1}^j, & i > j+1, \end{cases} : \Delta^q \rightarrow \Delta^q.$$

A magic is that those data helps us to encode all homotopic information for a given topological space.

Definition 2.5. For a given topological space X , a **singular q -simplex** is a continuous map: $\Delta^q \rightarrow X$. We denote the set of singular q -simplexes as

$$\text{Sing}(X)_q := C^0(\Delta^q, X).$$

For a singular simplex $f : \Delta^q \rightarrow X$, we also often write $f = [f_0, \dots, f_q]$ in a similar (but with a different meaning from previous notations), where $f_q = f(v_q)$.

By pre-composing with faces and degenerations (for suitable q, i), we define

$$d_q^i : \text{Sing}(X)_q \rightarrow \text{Sing}(X)_{q-1}, \quad f = [\Delta^q \rightarrow X] \mapsto d_q^i(f) = f \circ \delta_q^i = [\Delta^{q-1} \xrightarrow{\delta_q^i} \Delta^q \xrightarrow{f} X],$$

$$s_q^i : \text{Sing}(X)_q \rightarrow \text{Sing}(X)_{q+1}, \quad f = [\Delta^q \rightarrow X] \mapsto s_q^i(f) = f \circ \sigma_q^i = [\Delta^{q+1} \xrightarrow{\sigma_q^i} \Delta^q \xrightarrow{f} X].$$

With the bracket notation, we have $d_q^i(f) = [f_0, \dots, \hat{f}_i, \dots, f_q]$ for simplicity.

As a consequence of Exercise 2.4, we have

(1) For every $q \geq 2$ and every $0 \leq i < j \leq q$,

$$d_{q-1}^i \circ d_q^j = d_{q-1}^{j-1} \circ d_q^i.$$

(2) For every $q \geq 0$ and every $0 \leq i \leq j \leq q$,

$$s_{q+1}^i \circ s_q^j = s_{q+1}^{j+1} \circ s_q^i.$$

(3) For every $q \geq 1$, every $0 \leq i \leq q+1$, and every $0 \leq j \leq q$,

$$d_{q+1}^i \circ s_q^j = \begin{cases} s_{q-1}^{j-1} \circ d_q^i, & i < j, \\ \text{id}_{\text{Sing}(X)_q}, & i = j \text{ or } i = j+1, \\ s_{q-1}^j \circ d_q^{i-1}, & i > j+1. \end{cases}$$

Warning: In this course, we will only use faces d_i as well as the equations

$$d_q^j \circ d_{q-1}^i = d_q^i \circ d_{q-1}^{j-1}.$$

So feel free to ignore degeneration during this course. But the role of degeneration will somehow be explained in the following.

Supplement material 2.6. Those commuting relations means that all those data $\text{Sing}(X)_\bullet = (\text{Sing}(X)_q, d_q^i, s_q^j)_{q,i,j}$ form a simplicial set. (And all faces data $(\text{Sing}(X)_q, d_q^i)_{q,i}$ form a semi-simplicial set.)

Moreover, one can show that $\text{Sing}(X)_\bullet$ is a so-called Kan complex (in particular a quasi-category), which is a model for ∞ -groupoid (in particular ∞ -category).

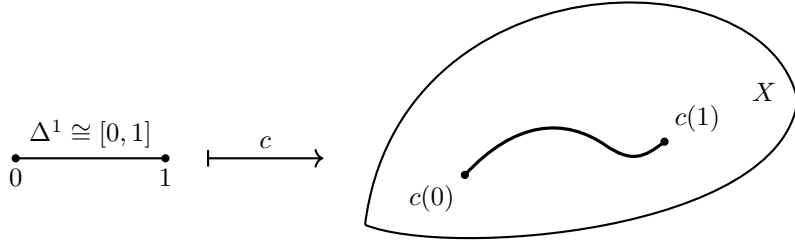
It is proven by Milnor that you can learn all the information of X as a homotopy type from $\text{Sing}(X)_\bullet$.

Let us see some examples.

Example 2.7. For any curve $c : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$, we may naturally define a singular 1-simplex

$$c : \Delta^1 \cong [0, 1] \xrightarrow{c} X.$$

As explained in Example 2.3, we have $d^0(c) = c(1) \in X$ and $d^1(c) = c(0) \in X$.

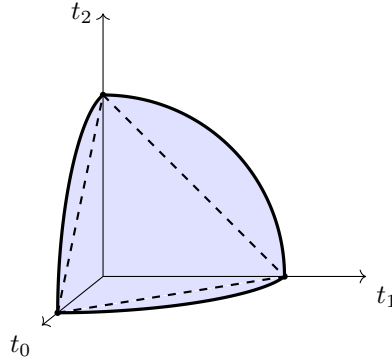


Example 2.8. Consider $X = S^n$, we define

$$f : \Delta^n \rightarrow S^n, \quad t \in \Delta^n \mapsto t/|t|.$$

Similarly, for $I \subset \{0, \dots, n\}$, we set $t_I = ((-1)^{\chi_I(i)} t_i)$ (χ_I is the indicator function of the set I), and $\sigma_I(t) = t_I/|t_I| \in S^n$. Then we obtain 2^{n+1} many n -simplexes in S^n .

You may also easily describe their boundary.



Remark 2.9. Historically, the adjective “singular” means that, compared to literally topological simplexes, you can allow really weird simplexes.

For example, Constant maps $\Delta^q \rightarrow X$ are singular simplexes. The Peano curve $\Delta^1 = I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ is also a singular simplex.

2.2. Singular chain and singular homology. Seems that what we do just repeats certain geometric constructions and no algebra yet. Here it is!

Recall: For any set S , there exists an abelian group freely generated by S , say

$$\mathbb{Z}[S] = \bigoplus_{x \in S} \mathbb{Z}x = \{(n_x)_{x \in S} \mid \text{finitely many non-zero } n_x\}.$$

If $m : S \rightarrow T$ a map, we can define $\mathbb{Z}[m] : \mathbb{Z}[S] \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}[T]$ by assign $\mathbb{Z}[m](x) = m(x)$ and extend linearly $\mathbb{Z}[m](\sum_x n_x x) = \sum_x n_x m(x)$. Then $\mathbb{Z}[m]$ is a group homomorphism between abelian groups.

Here, we shall apply the construction to $\text{Sing}(X)_q$ and d_q^i :

Definition 2.10. We define the abelian group of singular chains as

$$S_q(X) := \mathbb{Z}[\text{Sing}(X)_q]$$

and $\mathbb{Z}$ -linear faces maps as group homomorphisms

$$\partial_q^i := \mathbb{Z}[d_q^i] : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_{q-1}(X).$$

By definition, a singular q -chain is a formal linear combination of finitely many singular q -simplexes

$$\sigma = n_1\sigma_1 + \cdots + n_k\sigma_k, \quad n_i \in \mathbb{Z}, \sigma_i \in \text{Sing}(X)_q.$$

Remark 2.11. It is explained in Definition 2.5, we may consider $\mathbb{Z}[s_q^i]$ as well. In this case, we get a simplicial abelian group $(S_q(X), \partial_q^i, \mathbb{Z}[s_q^i])$, as well as a corresponding semi-simplicial abelian group $(S_q(X), \partial_q^i)$.

Lemma 2.12. *We define*

$$\partial_q = \sum_i (-1)^i \partial_q^i : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_{q-1}(X),$$

then it satisfies that $\partial_{q-1}\partial_q = 0$. In particular, we set $S_q(X) = \{0\}$ for $q < 0$, and set $\partial_q = 0$ for $q \leq 0$; then $S_(X) = (S_q(X), \partial_q)$ form a chain complex (in homological degree convention).*

Proof. You will see that the result is a purely algebraic corollary of the faces relation $d_{q-1}^i \circ d_q^j = d_{q-1}^{j-1} \circ d_q^i$.

We only need to verify the equation $\partial_{q-1}\partial_q = 0$ on generators of $S_q(X)$ (i.e., singular simplices). For a singular simplex $\sigma : \Delta^q \rightarrow X$, recall the definition $\partial_q^i(\sigma) = d_q^i(\sigma)$.

Hence

$$\partial_{q-1}\partial_q(\sigma) = \sum_{i=0}^{q-1} \sum_{j=0}^q (-1)^{i+j} d_{q-1}^i \circ d_q^j(\sigma).$$

Using the faces relation $d_{q-1}^i \circ d_q^j = d_{q-1}^{j-1} \circ d_q^i$. We see that each term with indices (i, j) such that $j < i$ is equal to the term with indices $(j, i-1)$, but with the opposite sign $(-1)^{i+j} = -(-1)^{j+i-1}$.

Therefore, all terms cancel in pairs, and so

$$\partial_{q-1}\partial_q(\sigma) = 0. \quad \square$$

Supplement material 2.13. The proof Lemma 2.12 only uses the face relation, and nothing is about the topology except the constructions. This is a pattern of a general theorem that relates simplicial abelian groups and chain complexes: *Dold-Kan correspondence*. We have an equivalence between the category of simplicial abelian groups and the category of (non-negatively homological graded) chain complexes,

$$\mathbf{sAb} \cong \mathbf{Ch}_{\geq 0}(\mathbb{Z}).$$

Definition 2.14. For a topological space X , we define the **singular chain** complex as the following chain complex $S_*(X) = (S_q(X), \partial_q)$:

$$\cdots \rightarrow S_{q+1}(X) \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+1}} S_q(X) \xrightarrow{\partial_q} S_{q-1}(X) \rightarrow \cdots$$

We set abelian groups

$$B_q(X) := \text{im}(\partial_{q+1}) \subset \ker(\partial_q) =: Z_q(X)$$

and define the q -th **singular homology** group as the quotient

$$H_q(X) := Z_q(X)/B_q(X).$$

We call chains in $Z_q(X)$ cycles and chains in $B_q(X)$ boundaries. Elements in $H_q(X)$ as homology classes. If two cycles σ_1, σ_2 are in the same homology class, i.e. $\sigma_1 - \sigma_2 = \partial_{q+1}\tau$, we say they are homologous.

As usual, we will simply write $\partial = \partial_q$ if q is clear.

Notice that we do not emphasize $q \geq 0$ since we get trivial data when $q < 0$.

Remark 2.15. Compare to $\text{Sing}(X)_q$, the key point for $S_q(X)$ is that it is an abelian group, so we can actually do “linear algebra” to perform computation! In fancy words, $S_q(X)$ are linearization of $\text{Sing}(X)_q$.

However, $S_q(X)$ is a huge abelian group. It is impossible to compute the singular homology by definition. We need to develop sufficient computational tools later, such as the Mayer-Vietoris sequence and the excision principle.

The advantage of singular homology is that it is easier to construct the entire homology theory.

On the other hand, we will see that $S_*(X)$ loses some information compare to $\text{Sing}(X)_\bullet$ that knows all the homotopic information of X .

Example 2.16. A continuation of Example 2.7. For a curve $c : I \rightarrow X$, we regard it as a singular 1-simplex. Then we can also regard it as a singular 1-chain $c \in S_1(X)$. Then we have

$$\partial c = \partial^0(c) - \partial^1(c) = d^0(c) - d^1(c) = c(1) - c(0)$$

where we regard points $c(i)$ as singular 0-simplexes.

Consequently, c is a cycle if and only if c is a closed curve, i.e., $c(1) = c(0)$.

Exercise 2.17. Let $C \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ be a convex set. Take $x, y \in C$. We denote $[x, y]$ (resp. $[y, x]$) the linear singular simplex defined by the segment $I \rightarrow C$ from x to y (resp. from y to x).

Show that $[x, y] \neq -[y, x]$ in $S_1(C)$, but $[x, y] + [y, x]$ is homologous to the zero cycle 0, i.e. $[x, y] + [y, x] = \partial_2 \sigma$ for some $\sigma \in S_2(X)$.

Exercise 2.18. A continuation of Example 2.8. Let $X = S^n$, in this example, we construct a singular n -simplex $\sigma_I(t) = t_I/|t_I| \in S^n$ where $I \subset \{0, \dots, n\}$ and $t_I = ((-1)^{\chi_I(i)} t_i)$ (χ_I is the characteristic function of the set I).

Then we have

$$\sigma_{S^n} := \sum_I (-1)^{|I|} \sigma_I.$$

Show that σ_{S^n} is a cycle. Hint: you can start by understanding $n = 1, 2$ cases.

Later, we will see that $[\sigma_{S^n}]$ is called a fundamental class of S^n , which is a generator of $H_n(S^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$!

2.3. First computation and properties.

Proposition 2.19. *Singular homology for a point $X = \text{pt}$. We have*

$$H_0(\text{pt}) \cong \mathbb{Z}, \quad H_q(\text{pt}) = 0, \forall q \geq 1.$$

Proof. The idea is that the only possible singular q -simplex is the constant map c_q , so we have $\text{Sing}(\text{pt})_q = \{c_q\}$ is a single point set, then we have $S_q(\text{pt}) = \mathbb{Z}c_q$ for $q \geq 0$. So, the singular chain complex is of the form

$$\cdots \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}c_{q+1} \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+1}} \mathbb{Z}c_q \xrightarrow{\partial_q} \mathbb{Z}c_{q-1} \rightarrow \cdots \xrightarrow{\partial_1} \mathbb{Z}c_0 \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow \cdots$$

It remains to compute ∂_q . Since $\text{Sing}(\text{pt})_{q-1}$ also only consists of constant map, we have that $d_q^i(c_q) : \Delta^{q-1} \rightarrow \text{pt}$ are all the same map c_{q-1} . Consequently, we have

$$\partial_q c_q = \sum_i (-1)^i \partial_q^i(c_q) = \sum_i (-1)^i c_{q-1} = c_{q-1} - c_{q-1} + c_{q-1} - c_{q-1} + \cdots$$

Therefore, we have

$$\partial_{2i-1} c_q = 0, \quad \partial_{2i} c_q = c_{q-1},$$

and the singular complex becomes

$$\cdots \rightarrow \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{0} \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{1} \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \cdots \xrightarrow{0} \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow \cdots$$

Consequently, we have

$$H_0(\text{pt}) \cong \mathbb{Z}, \quad H_q(\text{pt}) = 0, \forall q \geq 1. \quad \square$$

Proposition 2.20. *For any topological space X , we have for all q*

$$H_q(X) \cong \bigoplus_{X_\alpha \in \pi_0(X)} H_q(X_\alpha).$$

Proof. In fact, since Δ_q is path connected. Then we have

$$\text{Sing}(X)_q = \bigsqcup_{X_\alpha \in \pi_0(X)} \text{Sing}(X_\alpha)_q.$$

And the same reason shows that d^i respects the components decomposition. Consequently, we have the decomposition of chain complex

$$S_*(X) \cong \bigoplus_{X_\alpha \in \pi_0(X)} S_*(X_\alpha),$$

which induces decomposition on homology. $\square$

Exercise 2.21. 1) Complete the detail of Proposition 2.20. 2) Based on the same idea, show that for all q

$$H_q\left(\bigsqcup_i X_i\right) \cong \bigoplus_i H_q(X_i).$$

Proposition 2.22. *If X is non-empty and path connected, then we have $H_0(X) = \mathbb{Z} \cdot [x]$, where x means either an (arbitrary) base point or the singular 0-simplex given by x .*

Consequently, for all spaces X , we have

$$H_0(X) \cong \bigoplus_{X_\alpha \in \pi_0(X)} \mathbb{Z}.$$

Proof. Consider the augmentation homomorphism

$$\epsilon : S_0(X) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad \sum_i n_i p_i \mapsto \sum_i n_i,$$

where points p_i are regarded as 0-simplexes.

It is clear that ϵ is surjective for all spaces. However, we shall prove that if X is path-connected, then

$$\ker(\epsilon) = \text{im}(\partial_1).$$

Proof of the equality: it is clear that $\text{im}(\partial_1) \subset \ker(\epsilon)$. Conversely, take $a \in \ker(\epsilon)$ and we write $a = \sum_i n_i p_i$, then we have $0 = \epsilon(a) = \sum_i n_i$. For a fixed point $x \in X$, we pick paths γ_i from x to p_i , which is possible since X is path-connected. Then we regard γ_i as 1-simplexes, and then set

$$c = \sum_i (n_i) \gamma_i.$$

You can compute that (recall Example 2.16)

$$\partial_1 c = \sum_i n_i \partial_1 \gamma_i = \sum_i n_i (p_i - x) = \sum_i n_i p_i - \left(\sum_i n_i\right) x = a \in \text{im}(\partial_1).$$

Consequently, we have the following exact sequence

$$S_1(X) \rightarrow S_0(X) \xrightarrow{\epsilon} \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow 0$$

and then $H_0(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}x$ (try to supplement some detail).

The second statement follows from Proposition 2.20. $\square$

Corollary 2.23. *A space X is path connected if and only $H_0(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}$.*

Remark 2.24. Here, by the proposition, we know that the number of path components can be computed by the rank of H_0 as a free abelian group.

2.4. Variant of definition.

2.4.1. Homology with coefficient.

Definition 2.25. Let M be an abelian group and X be a space, we define

$$S_*(X; M) := (S_q(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} M, \partial_q \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} M),$$

and $Z_q(X; M)$, $B_q(X; M)$ and $H_q(X; M)$ in the similar way. Then we call $H_q(X; M)$ singular homology with coefficients.

Remark 2.26. We need the coefficient setup especially when $M = \mathbb{F}_p$, where some interesting chain may show up in $\mathbb{Z}$ -coefficient. Also, certain computations would be simplified for non $\mathbb{Z}$ -coefficient. So this is an important variant.

Exercise 2.27. Show 1) $H_q(X; \mathbb{Z}) = H_q(X)$. 2) Write down and prove all properties in Subsection 2.3 for $H_q(X; M)$. 3) When $M = R$ is a commutative ring, show that $H_q(X; R)$ are R -modules.

The following result compares homology with M -coefficient and $\mathbb{Z}$ -coefficient.

Theorem 2.28 (Universal coefficient theorem for homology). *Let M be an abelian group and X be a space, for each q , we have the following short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow H_q(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} M \rightarrow H_q(X; M) \rightarrow \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_{q-1}(X), M) \rightarrow 0.$$

Proof. Noticed that $S_*(X)$ is a free chain complex, then you can apply the algebraic universal coefficient theorem A.17 to $S_*(X; M) = S_*(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} M$. $\square$

Remark 2.29. If you don't know what I am talking about here, you may use it directly based on the following information: 1) $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}$ commute with arbitrary direct sum, and $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A, B) \simeq \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(B, A)$. 2) $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(\mathbb{Z}/n, \mathbb{Z}/m) \cong \mathbb{Z}/\gcd(m, n)$. 3) $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(\mathbb{Z}/n, M) = 0$ if M is a flat abelian group, for example $\mathbb{Z}$ or $\mathbb{F}$ is a field of characteristic 0.

We mainly use the theorem for $M = \mathbb{Z}/n$ or $M = \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$. The data shall be enough in practice.

2.4.2. Reduced singular homology. In the proof of Proposition 2.22, we notice that the augmentation

$$\epsilon : S_0(X; M) \rightarrow M, \quad \sum_i n_i p_i \mapsto \sum_i n_i$$

is useful.

Definition 2.30. Let M be a non-trivial abelian group and X be a space, we define the reduced singular chain $\tilde{S}_*(X; M)$ as

$$\cdots \rightarrow S_{q+1}(X; M) \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+1}} S_q(X; M) \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow S_1(X; M) \xrightarrow{\partial_1} S_0(X; M) \xrightarrow{\epsilon} M \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow \cdots,$$

i.e. $\tilde{S}_q(X; M) = S_q(X; M)$ for $q \geq 0$, $\tilde{S}_{-1}(X; M) = M$ and $\tilde{S}_q(X; M) = 0$ for $q < -1$.

Its homology groups are denoted as $\tilde{H}_q(X; M)$.

Exercise 2.31. Show that 1) $\tilde{H}_q(X; M) = H_q(X; M)$ for $q > 0$ and $H_0(X; M) = \tilde{H}_0(X; M) \oplus M$ (try to write down the generator). 2) $\tilde{H}_q(\text{pt}; M) = 0$ for all $q \geq 0$. 3) X is path connected if and only if $\tilde{H}_0(X; M) = 0$.

Remark 2.32. In practice, we may use the reduced homology to simplify some arguments, especially when we want $\tilde{H}_0$ to be trivial (when the space is path-connected).

3. FUNCTORIALITY AND HOMOTOPY INVARIANCE

Previously, we defined singular homology. In this section, we study in what sense singular homologies are topological invariants.

3.1. Pushforward maps. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map. Then by post-composition, we can define

$$\text{Sing}(f)_q : \text{Sing}(X)_q \rightarrow \text{Sing}(Y)_q, \quad [\Delta^q \rightarrow X] \mapsto [\Delta^q \rightarrow X \xrightarrow{f} Y].$$

Exercise 3.1. Recall faces maps d_q^i . To distinguish them for different spaces, we write $d_{q,X}^i$ and $d_{q,Y}^i$. Show that

$$d_{q,Y}^i \circ \text{Sing}(f)_q = \text{Sing}(f)_{q-1} \circ d_{q,X}^i.$$

Bonus: Try to write down and prove similar statements for degeneration maps. Consequently, $\text{Sing}(f)_\bullet : \text{Sing}(X)_\bullet \rightarrow \text{Sing}(Y)_\bullet$ is a map of simplicial sets.

Exercise 3.2. For two composable maps $X \xrightarrow{f} Y \xrightarrow{g} Z$, show that

$$\text{Sing}(g)_q \circ \text{Sing}(f)_q = \text{Sing}(g \circ f)_q.$$

Now, passing to the singular chain, we define

Definition 3.3. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map. We define

$$S_q(f) = f_{\#,q} := \mathbb{Z}[\text{Sing}(f)_q] : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_q(Y).$$

Here we use both $S_q(f)$ and $f_{\#,q}$ for the same map, the former emphasize the S_* is a functor, and the later is more refreshing. If q is clear, or we consider it for all q , we often write $f_\#$ instead.

Lemma 3.4. The maps $f_\#$ commute with ∂ , i.e. $f_\# \partial = \partial f_\#$. Therefore, $f_\# : S_*(X) \rightarrow S_*(Y)$ form a chain map between chain complexes.

Proof. Similar to Lemma 2.12, this is a consequence (linearization) of

$$d_{q,Y}^i \circ \text{Sing}(f)_q = \text{Sing}(f)_{q-1} \circ d_{q,X}^i. \quad \square$$

Exercise 3.5. Complete detail for Lemma 3.4.

Definition 3.6. With the notation, we define

$$H_q(f) = f_q : H_q(X) \rightarrow H_q(Y)$$

as $H_q(f_\#)$ via the formula $H_q(f)([\sigma]) := [f_\#(\sigma)]$. It is well-defined via the standard algebraic fact: a chain map between chain complexes induces maps on homology. (Do it if you are not familiar enough with homological algebra.)

Here we use both $H_q(f)$ and f_q for the same map, the former emphasize the H_* is a functor, and the later is more refreshing. If q is clear, we often write f_* instead.

Remark 3.7. Precisely, for $\sigma = \sum_i n_i \sigma_i$ where σ_i are q -simplexes and $n_i \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have

$$f_\#(\sigma) := \sum_i n_i (f \circ \sigma_i), \quad f_q([\sigma]) := [f_\#(\sigma)] = [\sum_i n_i (f \circ \sigma_i)].$$

Proposition 3.8. Show that 1) $\text{Sing}(\text{id}_X)_\bullet = \text{id}_{\text{Sing}(X)_\bullet}$ and $(\text{id}_X)_\# = \text{id}_{S_*(X)}$.

2) For two composable maps $X \xrightarrow{f} Y \xrightarrow{g} Z$, show that $g_\# \circ f_\# = (g \circ f)_\#$, and then $g_q \circ f_q = (g \circ f)_q$.

3) The constant map $f : X \rightarrow \text{pt} \rightarrow X$ induces $H_q(f) = 0$ for $q > 0$ and $H_0(f) = \text{id}_{\mathbb{Z}}$ if X is path connected (try to figure out the general case).

4) Homology groups are homeomorphic invariants.

Proof. Term (1) is clear. The term (2) is a consequence of $\text{Sing}(g)_q \circ \text{Sing}(f)_q = \text{Sing}(g \circ f)_q$.

Here, we show (3). In fact, by (2), we have f_q factor through

$$f_q : H_q(X) \rightarrow H_q(\text{pt}) \rightarrow H_q(X).$$

Then by Proposition 2.19, we conclude for $q > 0$. For $q = 0$, we left as an exercise (Hint: compare to Proposition 2.22).

(4) is also an exercise. $\square$

Exercise 3.9. Finish the exercise in Proposition 3.8.

Remark 3.10. You may know what functors are. Here, the upshot is that homology groups are functors from the category of topological spaces and continuous maps to the category of abelian groups.

Exercise 3.11. Write down and prove the corresponding statements for $H_q(X; M)$.

3.2. Homotopy invariance. Previously, we showed that homology groups are homeomorphic invariants. Here, we show that homology groups are actually homotopy invariants. Compared with the routine verification in the previous subsection, we require a real effort here.

First, we claim the following fact

Theorem 3.12. *Suppose two maps $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$ are homotopic through H . Then there exists a chain homotopy h between chain maps $f_\#$ and $g_\# : S_*(X) \rightarrow S_*(Y)$, i.e. for every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$, a homomorphism*

$$h_q : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_{q+1}(Y)$$

such that

$$\partial_{q+1,Y} h_q + h_{q-1} \partial_{q,X} = g_{\#,q} - f_{\#,q}.$$

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \longrightarrow & S_{q+1}(X) & \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+1,X}} & S_q(X) & \xrightarrow{\partial_{q,X}} & S_{q-1}(X) & \longrightarrow \\ & \searrow & \swarrow h_q & \downarrow f_{\#,q} & \downarrow g_{\#,q} & \swarrow h_{q-1} & \searrow \\ \longleftarrow & S_{q+1}(Y) & \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+1,Y}} & S_q(Y) & \xrightarrow{\partial_{q,Y}} & S_{q-1}(Y) & \longrightarrow \end{array}$$

Corollary 3.13. *Suppose two maps $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$ are homotopic. Then they define the same map on the homology groups*

$$f_q = g_q : H_q(X) \rightarrow H_q(Y).$$

In particular, if X and Y are homotopy equivalent, then $H_q(X) \cong H_q(Y)$ for all q .

Proof. For the first statement, this is a standard homological fact: chain homotopic chain maps induces the same map on homology groups. Do it by hand if you are not familiar with it!

For the second, we notice that by the definition of homotopy equivalence, we have f, g such that $fg \simeq \text{id}_X$ and $gf \simeq \text{id}_Y$. Then we have

$$f_q g_q = (fg)_q = (\text{id}_X)_q = \text{id}_{H_q(X)}, g_q f_q = (gf)_q = (\text{id}_Y)_q = \text{id}_{H_q(Y)}. \quad \square$$

Therefore, the main technical point is the proof of Theorem 3.12.

Let me explain some ideas behind: So far, we have the homotopy

$$H : X \times I \rightarrow Y.$$

As usual, we apply Sing to H to obtain

$$\text{Sing}(X \times I)_{q+1} \xrightarrow{\text{Sing}(H)_{q+1}} \text{Sing}(Y)_{q+1}.$$

If we simply linearize it, we get a chain map $S_{q+1}(X \times I) \rightarrow S_{q+1}(Y)$.

However, what we want is actually $S_q(X) \rightarrow S_{q+1}(Y)$, which does not follow from any naive construction we have so far.

To do so, we should expect to have some maps

$$\text{Sing}(X)_q \rightarrow \text{Sing}(X \times I)_{q+1}$$

compatible with faces.

It means that we should have some constructions

$$\sigma : \Delta^q \rightarrow X \rightsquigarrow ? : \Delta^{q+1} \rightarrow X \times I.$$

On the other hand, we have the following naive construction

$$\sigma : \Delta^q \rightarrow X \rightsquigarrow \sigma \times I : \Delta^q \times I \rightarrow X \times I.$$

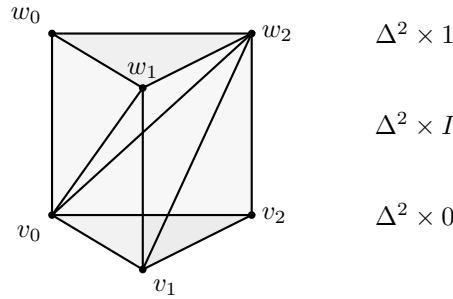
Therefore, seems that all magic is in how we divide the cylinder $\Delta^q \times I$ into simplexes.

Construction [Simplicial decomposition of $\Delta^q \times I$]: Here, we denote vertices in $\Delta^q \times 0$ by $[v_0, v_1, \dots, v_q]$ and vertices in $\Delta^q \times 1$ by $[w_0, w_1, \dots, w_q]$. Then we construct a sequence of $q+1$ -simplexes in $\Delta^q \times I$ for $i = 0, \dots, q$:

$$\tau_q^i = [v_0, \dots, v_i, w_i, \dots, w_q] : \Delta^{q+1} \rightarrow \Delta^q \times I.$$

Notice here, it means that we match the vertices first, and since $\Delta^q \times I$ is convex, we can extend the maps between vertices linearly to a linear simplex.

Now, we have $\Delta^q \times I = \cup_i \text{im}(\tau_q^i)$. More importantly, we have certain relations. Here, let us phrase them in Sing level.



We define maps for $i = 0, \dots, q$ by composing τ_i

$$T_q^i : \text{Sing}(X)_q \rightarrow \text{Sing}(X \times I)_{q+1}, \quad [\Delta^q \xrightarrow{\sigma} X] \mapsto [\Delta^{q+1} \xrightarrow{\tau_i} \Delta^q \times I \xrightarrow{\sigma \times I} X \times I].$$

Exercise 3.14. For those $T^i = T_q^i$, we have the following commutative relations.

$$d^j T^i = \begin{cases} T^{i-1} d^j, & 0 \leq j < i, \\ d^i T^{i-1}, & j = i, 1 \leq i \leq q, \\ d^{i+1} T^{i+1}, & j = i+1, 1 \leq i \leq q-1, \\ T^i d^{j-1}, & i+1 < j \leq q+1. \end{cases}$$

and

$$d^0 T^0(\sigma) = (\sigma \times \text{id}_I) \circ [w_0, \dots, w_q], \quad d^{q+1} T^q(\sigma) = (\sigma \times \text{id}_I) \circ [v_0, \dots, v_q].$$

Supplement material 3.15. Those data actually define a certain simplicial homotopy between simplicial maps. But we left those discussions to further reading/courses.

Now, we may linearize those maps to get

$$\mathbb{Z}[T_q^i] : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_{q+1}(X \times I)$$

and set

$$T_q = \sum_i (-1)^i \mathbb{Z}[T_q^i] : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_{q+1}(X \times I).$$

Lemma 3.16. For $t \in I = [0, 1]$, we set $i_t : X \rightarrow X \times I, x \mapsto (x, t)$. We have

$$\partial_{q+1, X \times I} T_q + T_{q-1} \partial_{q, X} = i_{1, \#} - i_{0, \#} : S_q(X) \rightarrow S_q(X \times I).$$

Proof. Similar to previous proofs, this is a corollary of Exercise 3.14. □

Exercise 3.17. Finish the proof of the lemma.

Now, we can prove Theorem 3.12

Proof of Theorem 3.12. We define

$$h_q : S_q(X) \xrightarrow{T_q} S_{q+1}(X \times I) \xrightarrow{H_{\#,q}} S_{q+1}(Y).$$

Then we have

$$\partial h + h\partial = \partial H_{\#}T + H_{\#}T\partial = H_{\#}\partial T + H_{\#}T\partial = H_{\#}(\partial T + \partial T) = H_{\#}(i_{1,\#} - i_{0,\#}) = g_{\#} - f_{\#}.$$

One small exercise for you is to think about what results we use here. $\square$

Exercise 3.18. State and prove the homotopy invariance for $H_q(X; M)$ and $\tilde{H}_q(X; M)$. Notice that you do not need to do all the construction again by hand. In principle, you only need to manipulate the tensor product.

3.3. Applications. Finally, let's see some very simple applications.

Exercise 3.19. Show that if X is a contractible space, then

$$H_q(X; M) = 0, \forall q \geq 1, H_0(X; M) = M.$$

In particular, now, you shall know $H_q(D^n; M)$, $H_q(C(X); M)$, $H_q(C; M)$ for a convex set C .

Exercise 3.20. Show that if $A \subset X$ is a deformation retraction. Then the inclusion map $i : A \subset X$ induces group isomorphisms

$$i_q : H_q(A; M) \xrightarrow{\cong} H_q(X; M).$$

So, for example, now you shall know that $H_q(S^n; M) \cong H_q(\mathbb{R}^{n+1} \setminus \{0\}; M)$.

Definition 3.21. For a space X , if $H_q(X)$ is a finitely generated abelian group, then the free part of $H_q(X)$ has finite rank, we define $b_q(X) = \text{rank} H_q(X)$, the q -th Betti number.

We define the Euler number to be

$$\chi(X) = \sum_q (-1)^q b_q(X).$$

For example, we have $\chi(\text{pt}) = 1$.

Corollary 3.22. *Betti numbers and Euler number are homotopy invariants of spaces.*

Exercise 3.23. In fact, for fields $\mathbb{K}$, for example $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{F}_p, \mathbb{Q}$, you may define the $\mathbb{K}$ -Betti number $\beta_q(X; \mathbb{K}) := \dim_{\mathbb{K}} H_q(X, \mathbb{K})$.

Use the universal coefficient theorem Theorem 2.28 to show that 1) If $\beta_q(X)$ are finite for all q ; then $\beta_q(X; \mathbb{K})$ are finite for all q ; 2) $\beta_q(X; \mathbb{Q}) = \beta_q(X)$ for all q when they can be defined, 3) Suppose $\beta_q(X)$ are finite for all q . Then the Euler number is $\chi(X) = \sum_q (-1)^q \beta_q(X; \mathbb{K})$ for all $\mathbb{K}$.

Supplement material 3.24. However, we will see later that $\beta_q(X; \mathbb{F}_p)$ may differ with $\beta_q(X)$ (for example, $X = \mathbb{R}P^2$ the real projective plane is an example). So, sometimes the $\mathbb{F}_p$ -coefficient homology might be a more interesting invariant.

4. MAYER-VIETORIS SEQUENCE

In this section, we develop a major tool for computing homology: the Mayer-Vietoris sequence.

4.1. Small chain theorem. We start from an important technical result.

Let X be a space and $\mathcal{U} = \{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a family of subspaces (NOT necessarily open, but historically we use U) such that $X = \cup_{i \in I} \text{Int}(U_i)$, we define

$$\text{Sing}^{\mathcal{U}}(X)_q := \{\sigma \in \text{Sing}(X)_q \mid \exists i \in I, \text{im}(\sigma) \subset U_i\}.$$

It is clear that faces maps map $\text{Sing}^{\mathcal{U}}(X)_q$ into $\text{Sing}^{\mathcal{U}}(X)_{q-1}$. So, its linearization form

$$S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X) = (S_q^{\mathcal{U}}(X) = \mathbb{Z}[\text{Sing}^{\mathcal{U}}(X)_q], \partial_q),$$

which is a sub-chain complex of $S_*(X)$.

Exercise 4.1. We naturally think $S_*(U_i)$ as sub-complex of $S_*(X)$, show that

$$S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X) = +_{i \in I} S_*(U_i) \subset S_*(X)$$

where $+_{i \in I}$ simply means Minkovski sum (or non-direct sum) in $S_*(X)$.

Theorem 4.2 (Small chain theorem). *With the above notation, the inclusion of chain complexes*

$$i_* : S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X) \subset S_*(X)$$

has a chain homotopy inverse $r_ : S_*(X) \rightarrow S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X)$ such that $r_* i_* = \text{id}$ and $i_* r_*$ is chain homotopic to id through a chain homotopy F_* , and moreover $F_*(S_*(U_i)) \subset S_{*+1}(U_i)$ for all $i \in I$.*

In particular, i_ induces isomorphisms on homology groups*

$$H_q^{\mathcal{U}}(X) := H_q(S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X)) \xrightarrow{\cong} H_q(X).$$

Moreover, i_ commutes with the augmentation ε , and then can be extended to a chain homotopy equivalence on the reduced singular chains, and then induces isomorphisms on reduced homologies.*

Proof. You can find it in [Hat02, Proposition 2.21]. □

Remark 4.3. Its proof is very technical and long (even Hatcher uses 4 pages to prove it), and we will only try to explain the idea behind it. But the idea is very intuitive: We want to find chains small enough from an arbitrary chain but does not change homology groups. So, we may try to subdivide the Δ^q into a bunch of smaller Δ^q , and we can make the process chain homotopy! The standard technique is called the *barycenter subdivision*: you simply divide Δ^q from its barycenter according to a certain rule. We give a picture for the barycenter subdivision of Δ^2 once and twice here:



So, for a given $\mathcal{U}$, you can use the Lebesgue number lemma to show that if you subdivide enough time for Δ^q , then smaller simplexes will eventually be in some $U_i \in \mathcal{U}$.

4.2. Mayer-Vietoris sequence.

Definition 4.4. For a space X and two subspaces X_1, X_2 of X . We say $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo if the inclusion of chain complex

$$S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2) \rightarrow S_*(X_1 \cup X_2)$$

is a quasi-isomorphism, where $S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2)$ is the Minkowski sum of sub-chain complexes in $S_*(X_1 \cup X_2)$.

Example 4.5. By Theorem 4.2, we have if $X = X_1 \cup X_2$ with $X = \text{Int}(X_1) \cup \text{Int}(X_2)$ as well. Then $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo.

Theorem 4.6. If $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo, then there exists a long exact sequence

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_q(X_1 \cap X_2) \xrightarrow{s_q} H_q(X_1) \oplus H_q(X_2) \xrightarrow{a_q} H_q(X_1 \cup X_2) \xrightarrow{\delta} H_{q-1}(X_1 \cap X_2) \rightarrow \cdots,$$

which is called the Mayer-Vietoris sequence.

Proof. We start by constructing a short exact sequence of complexes. We first write down the following diagram of inclusions

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & X_1 & & \\ & \nearrow i_1 & & \searrow j_1 & \\ X_1 \cap X_2 & & & & X_1 \cup X_2 \\ & \searrow i_2 & & \nearrow j_2 & \\ & & X_2 & & \end{array}$$

Then we set

$$\begin{aligned} s_{\#} : S_*(X_1 \cap X_2) &\rightarrow S_*(X_1) \oplus S_*(X_2), & c &\mapsto (i_{1\#}(c), -i_{2\#}(c)) \\ a_{\#} : S_*(X_1) \oplus S_*(X_2) &\rightarrow S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2), & (x, y) &\mapsto j_{1\#}(x) + j_{2\#}(y). \end{aligned}$$

Then one can check that the following is a short exact sequence of chain complexes

$$0 \rightarrow S_*(X_1 \cap X_2) \xrightarrow{s_{\#}} S_*(X_1) \oplus S_*(X_2) \xrightarrow{a_{\#}} S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2) \rightarrow 0.$$

Then we have a long exact sequence

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_q(X_1 \cap X_2) \xrightarrow{H_q(s_{\#})} H_q(X_1) \oplus H_q(X_2) \xrightarrow{H_q(a_{\#})} H_q(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2)) \xrightarrow{\delta} H_{q-1}(X_1 \cap X_2) \rightarrow \cdots.$$

Here we denote $s_q = H_q(s_{\#})$, but for the next term, we define

$$a_q : H_q(X_1) \oplus H_q(X_2) \xrightarrow{H_q(a_{\#})} H_q(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2)) \xrightarrow{\cong} H_q(X_1 \cup X_2)$$

where the last isomorphism follows from that $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo. With this notation, we have the Mayer-Vietoris sequence

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_q(X_1 \cap X_2) \xrightarrow{s_q} H_q(X_1) \oplus H_q(X_2) \xrightarrow{a_q} H_q(X_1 \cup X_2) \xrightarrow{\delta} H_{q-1}(X_1 \cap X_2) \rightarrow \cdots. \quad \square$$

Exercise 4.7. Show that the reduced singular homology and homology with coefficients also have the Mayer-Vietoris sequence for the Mayer-Vietoris duo if X_1, X_2 and $X_1 \cap X_2$ are non-empty.

Remark 4.8. Important information on some constructions

(1) Here, we describe the connecting map

$$H_q(X_1 \cup X_2) \xrightarrow{\delta} H_{q-1}(X_1 \cap X_2) :$$

By definition of Mayer-Vietoris duo, for $z \in H_q(X_1 \cup X_2)$, the class z has a representative singular chain σ (i.e. $z = [\sigma]$) such that $\sigma = x_1 + x_2$ where $x_i \in S_q(X_i)$. Moreover, σ is a cycle, so $\partial_q \sigma = \partial_q x_1 + \partial_q x_2 = 0$, and $\partial_q x_1 = -\partial_q x_2$. As $\partial_q x_i \in S_{q-1}(X_i)$, then the equation $\partial_q x_1 = -\partial_q x_2$ shows $\partial_q x_1 = -\partial_q x_2 \in S_{q-1}(X_1 \cap X_2)$.

We claim that, by certain diagram chasing,

$$\delta z = \delta[\sigma] = [\partial x_1] = -[\partial x_2].$$

(2) Compare to the definition of $s_{\#}$ and $a_{\#}$, we may also define $s'_{\#} = (i_{1\#}, i_{2\#})$ and $a'_{\#} = j_{1\#} - j_{2\#}$. It does not really matter which pair of conventions we take, but we need to fix one during your application, especially when comparing two Mayer-Vietoris sequences (for example, in Exercise 4.10).

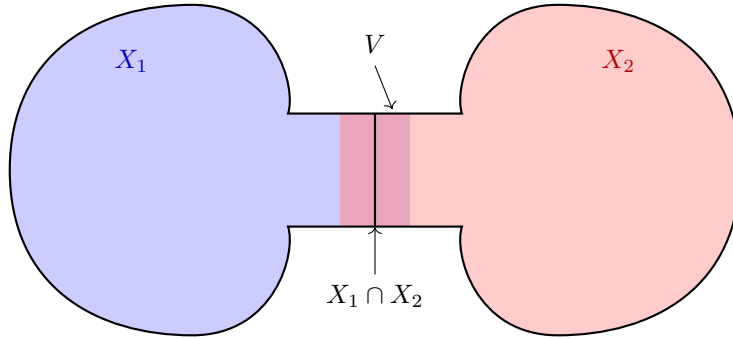
Supplement material 4.9. For a topological space X , the assignment $U \mapsto S_*(U)$ actually defines a ∞ -cosheaf valued in the derived category of $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules. The main ingredient to prove the fact is the Mayer-Vietoris sequence. That explains why it is really like the definition of sheaf in a proper meaning.

Exercise 4.10. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo in X and $\{Y_1, Y_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo in Y such that $f(X_i) \subset Y_i$. Then we have a commutative diagram of Mayer-Vietoris sequences:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} \longrightarrow & H_q(X_1 \cap X_2) & \xrightarrow{s} & H_q(X_1) \oplus H_q(X_2) & \xrightarrow{a} & H_q(X_1 \cup X_2) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & H_{q-1}(X_1 \cap X_2) & \longrightarrow \\ & \downarrow f_q & & \downarrow f_q & & \downarrow f_q & & \downarrow f_q & \\ \longrightarrow & H_q(Y_1 \cap Y_2) & \xrightarrow{s} & H_q(Y_1) \oplus H_q(Y_2) & \xrightarrow{a} & H_q(Y_1 \cup Y_2) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & H_{q-1}(Y_1 \cap Y_2) & \longrightarrow \end{array}$$

To simplify certain discussions, we give one more criterion for the Mayer-Vietoris duo.

Proposition 4.11. *Let $X = X_1 \cup X_2$ be a union of two closed subspaces. Assume that $X_1 \cap X_2$ is a deformation retraction for one open neighborhood V of $X_1 \cap X_2$, then $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo.*



Proof. Let $V_i = X_i \cup V$, then we know by the small chain theorem that $\{V_1, V_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo with $X = V_1 \cup V_2$.

We have that V_i deformation retracts to X_i . In fact, let $H : V \times I \rightarrow V$ be the deformation retraction homotopy from V to $X_1 \cap X_2$, then we can check that $H_i : V_i \times I \rightarrow V_i$ defined by

$$H_i(x, t) = x, \quad x \in X_i, \quad H_i(x, t) = H(x, t), \quad x \in V \setminus X_i$$

is a deformation retraction from V_i to X_i .

Now, we run the proof of Theorem 4.6 to get the following commutative diagram of long exact sequences

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \longrightarrow & H_q(X_1 \cap X_2) & \xrightarrow{s} & H_q(X_1) \oplus H_q(X_2) & \xrightarrow{H_q(a_{\#})} & H_q(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2)) & \xrightarrow{\delta} \\ & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & \\ \longrightarrow & H_q(V = V_1 \cap V_2) & \xrightarrow{s} & H_q(V_1) \oplus H_q(V_2) & \xrightarrow{a} & H_q(X = V_1 \cup V_2) & \xrightarrow{\delta} \end{array}$$

In those vertical homomorphisms, we are only unsure if $H_q(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2)) \rightarrow H_q(X)$ is isomorphic or not, and all others are isomorphisms by homotopy invariance. However, in this case, by the five lemma, we conclude that $H_q(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2)) \rightarrow H_q(X)$ is an isomorphism. i.e., $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo. $\square$

As an application, we can finally compute homology for S^n .

Proposition 4.12. *For $n \geq 1$, we have $\tilde{H}_q(S^n) = \mathbb{Z}$ for $q = n$ and otherwise $\tilde{H}_q(S^n) = 0$. Consequently, we have $H_q(S^n) = \mathbb{Z}$ for $q = 0, n$ and otherwise $H_q(S^n) = 0$ by Exercise 2.31, and then $\chi(S^n) = 1 + (-1)^n$ (recall Definition 3.21).*

Proof. Consider S^n and we decompose it into D_+^n and D_-^n by upper and lower semi-spheres. Then one can check $\{D_+^n, D_-^n\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo by Proposition 4.11. Notice that $D_+^n \cap D_-^n = S^{n-1}$ is the meridian sphere

Then we have the associated Mayer-Vietoris sequence. To simplify the discussion, we use the reduced version:

$$\cdots \rightarrow \tilde{H}_q(D_+^n) \oplus \tilde{H}_q(D_-^n) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_q(S^n) \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_{q-1}(S^{n-1}) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_{q-1}(D_+^n) \oplus \tilde{H}_{q-1}(D_-^n) \rightarrow \cdots$$

Now, as $\tilde{H}_q(D_-^n)$ are trivial for all q , then we have

$$\tilde{H}_q(S^n) \cong \tilde{H}_{q-1}(S^{n-1}) \cong \tilde{H}_{q-2}(S^{n-2}) \cong \cdots \cong \tilde{H}_{n-q}(S^0).$$

Then we conclude by recall that $S^0 = \text{pt} \sqcup \text{pt}$ and $\tilde{H}_q(S^0) = \mathbb{Z}$ when $q = 0$ and trivial otherwise by the reduced version of Proposition 2.20. $\square$

We have the following quick application.

Example 4.13. Go back to Example 1.4. We have $f, g : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ where $f = \text{id}$ and g is the constant map.

Then we have f and g are not homotopic. In fact, $f_1 = \text{id}_{\mathbb{Z}}$ and $g_1 : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is 0 by Proposition 3.8. So they cannot be homotopic. The point for Proposition 4.12 here is that we now know $H_1(S^1)$ is non-trivial!

Exercise 4.14. Take finitely many path-connected spaces X_i with closed based point x_i for $i = 1, \dots, d$, and we consider their wedge sum (recall Definition 1.17)

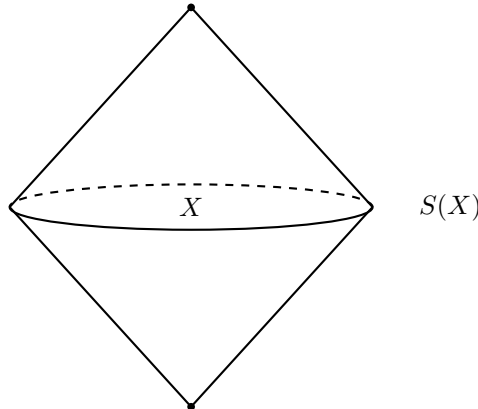
$$X = X_1 \vee \cdots \vee X_d.$$

Assume that for all i , $x_i \in X_i$ has a contractible neighborhood U_i , which is a deformation retraction of x_i in X_i .

1) Show that $\tilde{H}_q(X) \cong \oplus_{i=1}^d \tilde{H}_q(X_i)$ for all q ; 2)* Try to prove the same result $X = \vee_{i \in I} X_i$ for a infinite index set I .

Hint: For 1), you may do induction on d . For 2), you really need to use the universal property of direct sum, as well as a trick you will learn from Exercise 4.38 about compactness of Δ^q .

Exercise 4.15. Let X be a space. Its suspension $S(X)$ is defined as the quotient of $X \times I$ by collapsing top $X \times \{1\}$ to one point and the bottom $X \times \{0\}$ to another point. For example, it is easy to see that $S(S^{n-1}) \cong S^n$.



Show that for all q , we have $\tilde{H}_q(X) \cong \tilde{H}_{q+1}(S(X))$. Hint: The subspace of $S(X)$ consist of points $[x, t]$ with $t \in [0, 1/2]$ is homeomorphic to the cone $C(X)$.

4.3. Further applications about sphere.

4.3.1. Brouwer fixed point theorem. We may also prove the Brouwer fixed point theorem. We start from the following lemma, which is left as an exercise

Exercise 4.16. For $n \geq 2$, show that for $i : \partial D^n \cong S^{n-1} \subset D^n$, there is no continuous map $r : D^n \rightarrow \partial D^n$ such that $ri = \text{id}_{\partial D^n}$. Hint: you shall use $H_{n-1}(S^{n-1}) = \mathbb{Z}$ and the functoriality of homology.

Theorem 4.17 (Brouwer fixed point theorem). *For $n \geq 1$, every continuous map*

$$f : D^n \rightarrow D^n$$

has a fixed point.

Proof. Here, we assume $n \geq 2$, since the case $n = 1$ is trivial.

Assume that f has no fixed point, namely $f(x) \neq x$ for all $x \in D^n$. For each $x \in D^n$, define $r(x)$ to be the unique intersection point of ∂D^n with the half-line

$$\{f(x) + t(x - f(x)) \mid t \geq 0\}.$$

Then $r : D^n \rightarrow \partial D^n$ is continuous and satisfies $ri = \text{id}_{\partial D^n}$ where $i : \partial D^n \subset D^n$.

This contradicts Exercise 4.16. Therefore, f must have a fixed point. $\square$

4.3.2. Mapping degree of sphere. Here, we study further the homology of S^n . By Proposition 4.12, we know that $H_n(S^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$. We will give an explicit generator and see the effect of the sphere's self-maps.

Exercise 4.18. Recall that Exercise 2.18, we construct a cycle σ_{S^n} . Here, we try to show that $[\sigma_{S^n}]$ is a generator of $H_n(S^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ by the following two steps.

1) Show that under the Mayer-Vietoris boundary map $\delta : H_n(S^n) \cong H_{n-1}(S^{n-1})$, associated with the MV duo $\{D_+^n, D_-^n\}$ where $D_\pm^n = S^n \cap \{(x_0, \dots, x_n) \mid \pm x_n \geq 0\}$, we have $\delta[\sigma_{S^n}] = (-1)^n [\sigma_{S^{n-1}}]$. 2) The cycle σ_{S^n} can be defined for $n = 0$, show that $[\sigma_{S^0}]$ is a cycle of 2 points that generates $H_0(S^0) \cong \mathbb{Z}$.

Comment: Notice, there is a sign shown in 1). To avoid it, one can normalize by using $\tau_{S^n} = (-1)^{n(n+1)/2} \sigma_{S^n}$. Then we have $\delta[\tau_{S^n}] = [\tau_{S^{n-1}}]$. You might notice that this sign is kind of annoying; this is related to the orientation of S^n (as a manifold).

You shall also know that we have many other choices of chains that represent the generators.

Definition 4.19. Let $f : S^n \rightarrow S^n$, and we consider $f_n : H_n(S^n) \rightarrow H_n(S^n)$. Since $H_n(S^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$, there exists unique $d \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $f_n(z) = dz$ for all $z \in H_n(S^n)$. We define d as the mapping degree of f , and denoted by $\deg(f)$.

Remark 4.20. The notion of mapping degree has now been generalized to many different settings and is deeply rooted in many directions. For example, characteristic class, index theory, enumerative geometry, and many!

We start from some elementary properties.

Exercise 4.21. Show the following 1) $\deg(\text{id}_{S^n}) = 1$. 2) $\deg(f \circ g) = \deg(f) \deg(g)$. 3) $\deg(\text{const}) = 0$. 4) If $f \simeq g$, then $\deg(f) = \deg(g)$. 5) Let $r : S^n \rightarrow S^n$ be the reflection $r(x_0, \dots, x_n) = (-x_0, \dots, x_n)$, we have $\deg(r) = -1$. Hint: use $[\sigma_{S^n}]$ (equivalently $[\tau_{S^n}]$) or do induction using $\delta : H_n(S^n) \cong H_{n-1}(S^{n-1})$.

Example 4.22. By the previous exercise, we find that homeomorphisms of sphere give degree ± 1 maps. Here, we give one example of degree 1 map, which is NOT a homeomorphism.

Let D_-^n be the lower-half ball of S^n , and consider the quotient map $q : S^n \rightarrow S^n/D_-^n \cong S^n$. Since D_-^n is contractible, we know that q is a homotopy equivalence by Theorem 5.9. Then we have $q_n : H_n(S^n) \rightarrow H_n(S^n/D_-^n) \cong H_n(S^n)$ is an isomorphism between $\mathbb{Z}$. Notice that, it may possible that the homeomorphism $S^n/D_-^n \cong S^n$ change the orientation, but we always pick the one such that q_n is of degree 1. However, it is clear that q is not a homeomorphism.

Using this computation, we can see that the quotient map $S^n \rightarrow S^n/S^{n-1} \cong S^n \vee S^n$ induces $\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}^2, x \mapsto (x, x)$ on H_n (recall Exercise 4.14).

Next, we show the ampleness of the degree for the sphere.

Exercise 4.23. We show that for all $n \geq 1$ and $d \in \mathbb{Z}$, there exists a map $f_d : S^n \rightarrow S^n$ with degree d .

Hint: You can start from $n = 1$, where $f(z) = z^d$ is the candidate. Then you can do induction using suspension construction Exercise 4.15, which is functorial both at the space level and at the homology group level.

Remark 4.24. Roughly speaking: A degree d map is given by wrapping a sphere onto itself d -times. Meanwhile, it does not change the degree of maps if we collapse or expand small disks.

By those two exercises, we can see that

$$\deg : [S^n, S^n] \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

is a surjective homomorphism between multiplicative monoid (recall that $[X, X]$ is the monoid of homotopy class of maps between X).

The following is harder, and we omit its proof.

Theorem 4.25 (Hopf). *The degree map $\deg : [S^n, S^n] \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is injective.*

Supplement material 4.26. Now, you can use the tool from this section to show the Jordan curve theorem and the invariance of domain. We refer to [Hat02, Section 2.B] for further reading.

4.4. Mapping cone sequence. Here, we study the mapping cone using the Mayer-Vietoris sequence.

We start from some topological constructions.

Let X be a space, and $A \subset X$ is a subspace. We take $f : A \rightarrow Y$, and then we define

$$Y \cup_f X := X \sqcup Y / (a \in A) \sim (f(a) \in Y),$$

whose topology is the quotient topology inherited from the disjoint union $X \sqcup Y$.

In fact, the following diagram is a pushout in the category of topological spaces

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{i} & X \\ f \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ Y & \longrightarrow & Y \cup_f X. \end{array}$$

In the simplest case, we consider $f : A \rightarrow \text{pt}$ to be the constant map, then $\text{pt} \cup_f X = X/A$ is the quotient space.

Example 4.27. Let $(X, A) = (D^n, S^{n-1})$, and $f : S^{n-1} \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Then we call $Y \cup_f D^n$ as the space glued with an n -dimensional cell D^n on Y .

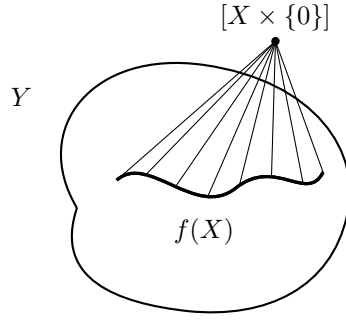
Example 4.28. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map and consider the pair $(C(X), X \times 1)$ where we regard the bottle $X \times 1$ as X . Then we define the (topological) mapping cone as

$$C(f) = Y \cup_f C(X).$$

The inclusion $Y \rightarrow Y \sqcup C(X)$ induces a continuous map $e : Y \rightarrow C(f)$

Notice the following property: $f \mapsto C(f)$ is functorial. If $f \simeq g$, then $C(f) \simeq C(g)$.

Compare to the $X/A = \text{pt} \cup_A X$, we may regard the mapping cone $C(f) = Y \cup_f C(X)$ as a homotopy quotient since $C(X)$ is contractible.



$$C(f) = (Y \sqcup C(X)) / ([x, 1] \sim f(x))$$

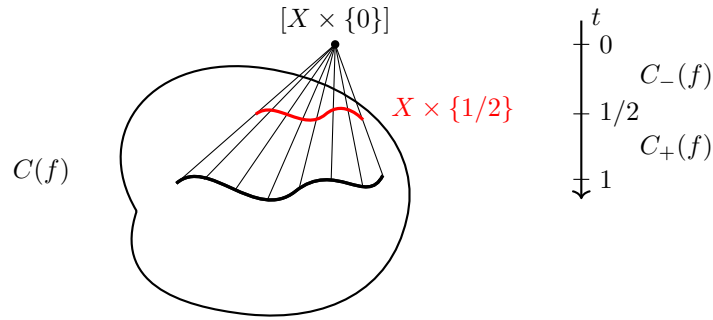
Proposition 4.29. *Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map, then there exists a long exact sequence*

$$\cdots \rightarrow \tilde{H}_q(X) \xrightarrow{f_q} \tilde{H}_q(Y) \xrightarrow{e_q} \tilde{H}_q(C(f)) \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_{q-1}(X) \rightarrow \cdots,$$

where $e : Y \rightarrow C(f)$ is the inclusion map.

Proof. We apply the Mayer-Vietoris sequence to the Mayer-Vietoris duo $\{C_+(f), C_-(f)\}$ in $C(f)$ given by

$$C_+(f) = Y \cup_f X \times [1/2, 1], \quad C_-(f) = X \times [0, 1/2] / X \times 0.$$



Notice that $C_-(f) \cong C(X)$ is contractible, then $\tilde{H}_q(C_-(f)) = 0$ for all q . So, the reduced Mayer-Vietoris sequence becomes

$$\cdots \rightarrow \tilde{H}_q(X \times 1/2) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_q(C_+(f)) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_q(C(f)) \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_{q-1}(X \times 1/2) \rightarrow \cdots.$$

We also notice that $C_+(f) \simeq Y$. Then we conclude by replacing $\tilde{H}_q(C_+(f))$ by $\tilde{H}_q(Y)$ and carefully match related maps $\square$

Exercise 4.30. Finish the proof of Proposition 4.29. And prove that for the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ \downarrow \alpha & & \downarrow \beta \\ X' & \xrightarrow{f'} & Y' \end{array}$$

there exists a map $\gamma : C(f) \rightarrow C(f')$ and the following commutative diagram of mapping cone sequences:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \longrightarrow & \tilde{H}_q(X) & \xrightarrow{f_q} & \tilde{H}_q(Y) & \xrightarrow{e_q} & \tilde{H}_q(C(f)) & \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_{q-1}(X) \longrightarrow \\ & \downarrow \alpha_q & & \downarrow \beta_q & & \downarrow \gamma_q & \downarrow \alpha_{q-1} \\ \longrightarrow & \tilde{H}_q(X') & \xrightarrow{f'_q} & \tilde{H}_q(Y') & \xrightarrow{e'_q} & \tilde{H}_q(C(f')) & \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_{q-1}(X') \longrightarrow \end{array}$$

Remark 4.31. If you want to use the non-reduced homology in mapping cone sequence, it is clear that nothing will change for $q \geq 1$, but for $q = 0$, the sequence will be

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_1(C(f)) \xrightarrow{\delta} H_0(X) \xrightarrow{f_0 \oplus \varepsilon_X} H_0(Y) \oplus \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{E} H_0(C(f)) \rightarrow 0,$$

where $E(b, n) = e_0(b) - n[v]$ for arbitrary but a fixed $v \in C(f)$. We use the same δ since it factor through the (non-canonical) inclusion $\tilde{H}_0(X) \hookrightarrow H_0(X)$ by the reduced version of δ . More concretely, for $p, q \in X \simeq X \times 1/2$ and pick paths $\alpha \subset C_+(f)$ (resp. $\beta \subset C_-(f)$) from p to q (resp. from q to p), then $c = \alpha + \beta \in S_1(C(f))$ and $\delta[c] = [\partial\alpha] = [q] - [p]$. It is clear that $\delta[c]$ is a class in the reduced homology no matter which base point we take.

We left the verification to readers.

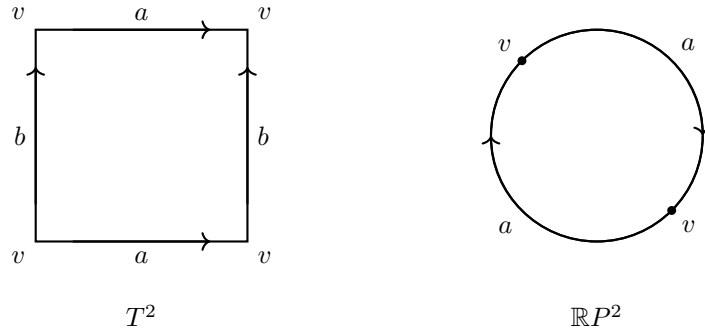
Remark 4.32. This construction essentially motivates the definition of the algebraic mapping cone. In fact, by a careful construction, you can see from the chain level Mayer-Vietoris sequence how to give the algebraic mapping cone.

Corollary 4.33. *Let $f : S^{n-1} \rightarrow X$ be a map, we have 1) $\tilde{H}_q(X \cup_f D^n) = \tilde{H}_q(X)$ for $q \neq n, n-1$; 2) an exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_n(X) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_n(X \cup_f D^n) \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_{n-1}(S^{n-1}) \simeq \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{f_{n-1}} \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X \cup_f D^n) \rightarrow 0.$$

Proof. Notice that $D^n \cong C(S^{n-1})$. Then it follows from Proposition 4.29. $\square$

Example 4.34. We now compute $\tilde{H}_n(T^2)$. We may treat T^2 as the quotient of the square I^2 in the following manner by identifying edges with the same labeling, we denote the quotient map $p : I^2 \rightarrow T^2$.



We take $X = S^1 \vee S^1$, i.e., the boundary of the square after the quotient (where the wedge point is v), and $f : S^1 \rightarrow S^1 \vee S^1$ is defined as $f : S^1 \cong \partial I^2 \xrightarrow{p} S^1 \vee S^1$ where p is the quotient map. Then we have that $T^2 \cong X \cup_f D^2$ (here, we think of the closed square I^2 as D^2 .)

We know that $\tilde{H}_q(S^1 \vee S^1) = \mathbb{Z}^2$ only when $q = 1$ and otherwise 0 by Exercise 4.14.

By Corollary 4.33, we know $\tilde{H}_0(T^2) = \tilde{H}_0(S^1 \vee S^1) = 0$, and we have the following exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_2(T^2) \xrightarrow{\delta} \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{f_1} \mathbb{Z}^2 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_1(T^2) \rightarrow 0.$$

So, we need to compute $H_1(S^1) = \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{f_1} \mathbb{Z}^2 = H_1(S^1 \vee S^1)$. We keep track of the proof of Exercise 4.14, we know the projection of f_1 into the first factor of $\mathbb{Z}$ is given by the degree of S^1 along the first circle in the wedge $S^1 \vee S^1$ (i.e. a in the picture), which is 0: go along a circle once and back (i.e. go along a with the opposite direction) is homotopic to the constant map. Similarly, for the second wedge component. Therefore, we have $f_1 = 0$.

Consequently, by the exact sequence above, we have

$$\tilde{H}_2(T^2) \cong \mathbb{Z}, \quad \tilde{H}_1(T^2) \cong \mathbb{Z}^2,$$

and two generators of $\tilde{H}_1(T^2)$ are represent by circles gives meridian and longitude of T^2 .

Example 4.35. Similarly, the real projective plane $\mathbb{R}P^2 = S^1 \cup_f D^2$ can be glued along $f : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ with $f(z) = z^2$ of degree 2. It is clear that $\mathbb{R}P^2$ is path-connected, so $H_0 = \mathbb{Z}$.

$$0 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_2(S^1) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_2(\mathbb{R}P^2) \xrightarrow{\delta} \tilde{H}_1(S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{f_1} \tilde{H}_1(S^1) \rightarrow \tilde{H}_1(\mathbb{R}P^2) \rightarrow 0,$$
$$0 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_2(\mathbb{R}P^2) \xrightarrow{\delta} \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{2} \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \tilde{H}_1(\mathbb{R}P^2) \rightarrow 0.$$

It is interesting to consider the $\mathbb{F}_2$ coefficient. In this case, the exact sequence becomes

$$0 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_2(\mathbb{R}P^2; \mathbb{F}_2) \xrightarrow{\delta} \mathbb{F}_2 \xrightarrow{0} \mathbb{F}_2 \rightarrow \tilde{H}_1(\mathbb{R}P^2; \mathbb{F}_2) \rightarrow 0.$$

It is our first example that the coefficient of homology really makes a difference.

A diagram of a 12-sided polygon (dodecagon) with vertices labeled v . The edges are labeled a_1, a_2, a_3 and b_1, b_2, b_3 in a repeating pattern. The labels a_i are placed on the edges that are closer to the vertices labeled v , while the labels b_i are placed on the edges that are further from the vertices labeled v . The edges are arranged in a repeating pattern of a_i and b_i around the polygon.

$$\tilde{H}_2(\Sigma) \cong \mathbb{Z}, \quad \tilde{H}_1(\Sigma) \cong \mathbb{Z}^{2g}, \quad \chi(\Sigma) = 2 - 2g.$$

Show that 1) $\mathbb{C}P^{n+1} \cong \mathbb{C}P^n \cup_{\pi_n} D^{2n+2}$ for the quotient map $\pi_n: S^{2n+1} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}P^n = S^{2n+1}/S^1$. 2) $H_q(\mathbb{C}P^n) = \mathbb{Z}$ for $q = 0, 2, \dots, 2n$ and trivial otherwise. 3) Let $q < 2n + 1$, then the inclusion $\mathbb{C}P^n \subset \mathbb{C}P^{n+1}$ induces isomorphism $H_q(\mathbb{C}P^n) \subset H_q(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1})$.

Exercise 4.38. Now, consider $\mathbb{C}P^\infty$, which is defined as S^∞/S^1 , where S^∞ is defined in Exercise 1.18. By the inclusion $S^{2n+1} \subset S^\infty$, we modulo it by S^1 -action, and then we have an inclusion $i_N : \mathbb{C}P^N \subset \mathbb{C}P^\infty$ with $\mathbb{C}P^\infty = \cup_N \mathbb{C}P^N$. Show that for all $q \geq 0$, there exists $N > q$, we have $H_q(\mathbb{C}P^N) \xrightarrow{\cong} H_q(\mathbb{C}P^\infty)$. Consequently, we have $H_q(\mathbb{C}P^\infty) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ if $q = 2k$ for $k \geq 0$, and otherwise trivial.

Hint: You may use the following idea: For a singular simplex $\sigma : \Delta^q \rightarrow \mathbb{C}P^\infty$, as Δ^q is compact, its image is also compact, so there exists N such that the image of σ is in $\mathbb{C}P^N \subset \mathbb{C}P^\infty$. This is enough to show $H_q(i_N)$ is surjective. To say injectivity, you may use the same idea and Exercise 4.37-(3).

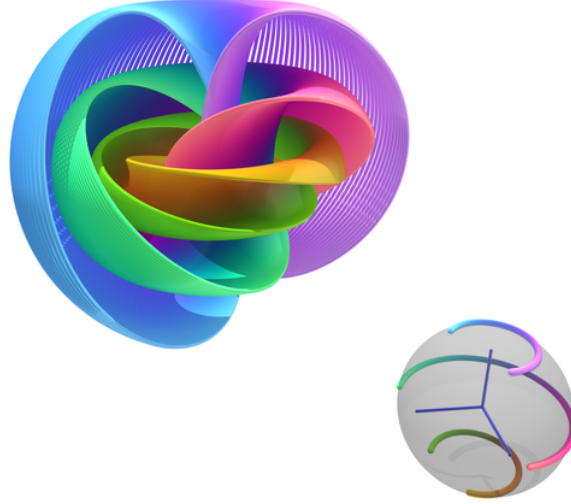


FIGURE 1. Hopf fibration. From Wikipedia.

Exercise 4.39. * We have done $\mathbb{R}P^2$ in Example 4.35, now you may try $\mathbb{R}P^n$. As the case of $\mathbb{R}P^2$, you should be careful on the coefficient.

At the end, we use mapping cone to prove the invariance for dimension

Proposition 4.40. *Let $U \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ and $V \subset \mathbb{R}^m$ be open sets. Suppose $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$ is a homeomorphism, then $m = n$.*

Proof. We pick a closed ball in $i : D \subset U$ ($D \cong D^n$), this is possible by taking an inner closed ball inside an open ball. We also pick $x \in D$ (for example the center of D)

Consider $j_x : U \setminus x \hookrightarrow U$ and $d_x : D \setminus x \hookrightarrow D$.

Then we have i induces homotopy equivalence

$$S^n \simeq C(d_x) \xrightarrow{\cong} C(j_x).$$

Therefore, we have

$$\tilde{H}_n(C(d_x)) \cong \mathbb{Z}, \quad \tilde{H}_q(C(j_x)) \cong 0, \quad q \neq n.$$

We can apply the same discussion to V .

Now, if U and V are homeomorphism, we must have

$$\varphi_q : H_q(C(j_x)) \cong H_q(C(j_{\varphi(x)})).$$

Then we must have $n = m$ since they must be non-zero for the same q . □

Remark 4.41. Here, the construction $H_q(C(X \setminus x \hookrightarrow X))$ is called **local homology** of X near x . It will be very useful when we discuss manifolds. The above argument already shows that if X is a manifold of dimension n , then $H_n(C(X \setminus x \hookrightarrow X)) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ and $H_q(C(X \setminus x \hookrightarrow X))$ is trivial otherwise (if $q > 0$).

Supplement material 4.42. Traditionally, there exists an equivalent toolkit for computation: relative homology + excision principle, where we will present in Section 12.

However, we choose this slightly different way to build the theory entirely based on Mayer-Vietoris and mapping cone.

One reason for that: this flavor is more close to sheaf theory and stable ∞ -categories (a modern version of triangulated categories), where relative homology is either tricky to define, or simply defined using mapping cone.

It makes relative homology less useful for certain situations (but NOT for all!). To save some time, we left the relative homology as a reading section at the end of the notes.

5. CELLULAR HOMOLOGY

Generally, Mayer-Vietoris sequence and mapping cone sequence are effective tools for computation. But still need some case-by-case studies. Here, we define a class of spaces and a certain homology theory such that: the chains are not too huge, the differential is computable in finite time, and the resulting homology coincides with singular homology. Prototype of the construction is the discussion of Subsection 4.4.

Warning: The entire section would serve as an exercise sheet.

5.1. CW complex. Recall that D^n is the closed disk, and we write $E^n = \text{Int}(D^n)$. They are called cells in some content.

Definition 5.1. For a topological space X , we say a CW decomposition or cellular decomposition consists of the following data

(1) A filtration of closed subspaces

$$\emptyset = X^{-1} \subset X^0 \subset X^1 \subset \cdots \subset X^q \subset \cdots, \quad X = \bigcup_q X^q,$$

where X^q is called the q -skeleton of X .

(2) X^q is glued from X^{q-1} by q -cells. Precisely:

For each $q \geq 0$, there exists a family of continuous maps, called the characteristic maps of the q -cells,

$$\varphi_\alpha^q : D^q \rightarrow X^q, \quad \alpha \in I_q,$$

such that

- $\varphi_\alpha^q(\partial D^q) \subset X^{q-1}$ for all $\alpha \in I_q$ and we set $\partial\varphi_\alpha^q = \varphi_\alpha^q|_{\partial D^q} : \partial D^q \rightarrow X^{q-1}$,
- the restriction of φ^q on $E^q = \text{Int}(D^q)$: $\varphi_\alpha^q|_{E^q} : E^q \rightarrow X^q \setminus X^{q-1}$ is a homeomorphism onto its image, and
- if we set $\varphi^q := \sqcup_{\alpha \in I_q} \varphi_\alpha^q : \sqcup_{\alpha \in I_q} D^q \rightarrow X^q$ and $\partial\varphi^q := \sqcup_{\alpha \in I_q} \partial\varphi_\alpha^q : \sqcup_{\alpha \in I_q} \partial D^q \rightarrow X^{q-1}$, then φ^q extends to a homeomorphism

$$\text{id}_{X^{q-1}} \cup_{\partial\varphi^q} \varphi^q : X^{q-1} \cup_{\partial\varphi^q} \bigsqcup_{\alpha \in I_q} D^q \xrightarrow{\cong} X^q.$$

The image $e_\alpha^q := \varphi_\alpha^q(E^q)$ is called an (open) q -cell of X . We also call $\partial\varphi_\alpha^q$ the gluing map of the cell e_α^q .

(3) The topology of X is homeomorphic to the weak topology: $F \subset X$ is closed if and only if $F \cap X^q$ are closed for all q .

A CW complex or cellular complex is a topological space with a fixed CW decomposition. We say X is a finite-type CW complex if there are only finitely many cells in each dimension q , and say X is a finite CW complex if the total number of all cells are finite.

Remark 5.2. (1) CW means Closure finite and Weak topology. The notion was introduced by J. H. C. Whitehead, which is a funny coincidence (maybe intentional) that CW appears again. (2) **Warning:** When you first learn all the machines here, you may consider finite-type CW complexes only to avoid too much technical discussion, especially about the weak topology in the absence of infinitely many q -cells. But most of the results hold without finiteness, although the proof is harder (the only exception concerns the product of CW complexes).

(3) By definition, X^0 is a discrete space for points, and X^q has cells of dimension at most q . (4) One can prove that: CW complexes are Hausdorff; finite CW complexes are compact; finite-type CW complexes are locally compact. A closed subspace of CW complex is compact if and only if it meets finitely many cells.

Example 5.3. (1) The sphere S^n is a CW complex with only one 0-cell and one n -cell.

(2) In Example 4.34, we give T^2 a CW decomposition with one 0-cell v , two 1-cells a, b and one 2-cell I^2 . The 1-skeleton is $S^1 \vee S^1$.

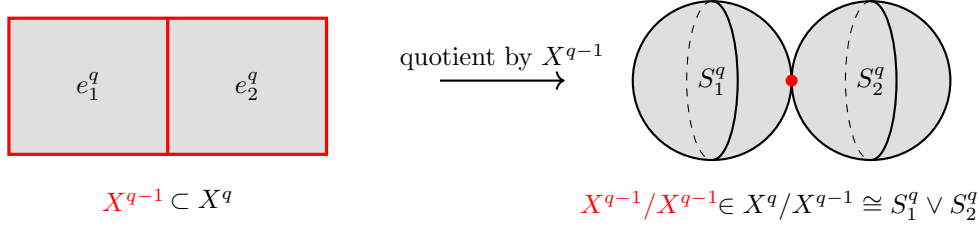
(3) You can see that $\mathbb{R} = \cup_n [n, n+1]$ can be regarded as a non finite-type CW complex. Also, $\mathbb{C}P^\infty$ is a finite-type but not finite CW complex.

Exercise 5.4. If X is a CW complex, then show that the cone $C(X)$ has a structure of CW complex. Hint: this follows from the functoriality of cones (see Example 4.28) and (1) of Exercise 1.15. Notice that, for $q \geq 1$, q -cells of $C(X)$ are classified by q -cells of X and $q-1$ -cells of X times $(0, 1)$; and the 0-cell is given by $C(X)^0 = X^0 \times \{1\} \cup [X \times \{0\}]$.

Exercise 5.5. The exercise provides certain preparation for our applications later.

Let X be a CW complex, show that for $q \geq 1$ that all characteristic maps of q -cells φ_α^q combined together induce a homeomorphism between pointed space

$$\Phi : \left(\bigvee_{\alpha} S_{\alpha}^q, \text{pt} \right) \xrightarrow{\cong} (X^q/X^{q-1}, X^{q-1}/X^{q-1}).$$



Hint: By definition of φ_α^q , it descends to $\Phi_\alpha^q : S^q = D^q/\partial D^q \rightarrow X^q/X^{q-1}$. Then all of them form a map $\sqcup_\alpha \Phi_\alpha^q : \sqcup_\alpha S_\alpha^q \rightarrow X^q/X^{q-1}$. Then $\sqcup_\alpha \Phi_\alpha^q$ descends to the wedge sum to get Φ , which matches the marked points. By definition, you may easily show Φ is a continuous bijection. Then you conclude Φ is a homeomorphism: If X is finite-type, you can argue from a short-cut that all spaces here are compact Hausdorff spaces (notice that X^q is a finite CW complex for each q); in the general case, you may use the following point set topology result: if $q_1 : Y \rightarrow Z_1$ and $q_2 : Y \rightarrow Z_2$ are two quotient map (i.e., q_i are surjective continuous map and Z_i equip the quotient topology), and q_1, q_2 define the same equivalence relation, then there exists a homeomorphism between Z_1 and Z_2 .

Definition 5.6. Let X be a CW complex. A closed subspace $A \subset X$ is called a subcomplex if A is a union of cells of X (i.e. there exists subsets $J_q \subset I_q$ for all q so that $A = \bigcup_q \bigcup_{\alpha \in J_q} e_\alpha^q$).

For a subcomplex $A \subset X$, A has an obvious structure of CW complex.

Example 5.7. If X is a CW complex, then for all q , the q -skelton $X^q \subset X$ is a subcomplex. The technique in Exercise 5.5 often use to study the quotient X/A , which gives X/A a structure of CW complex.

Now, we recall two useful technical results without proof.

Theorem 5.8 ([Hat02, Proposition 0.16]). *Let X be a CW complex and $A \subset X$ be a subcomplex. Then the map $i : A \subset X$ satisfies the homotopy extension property for all space Y . In other word, i is a cofibration.*

Theorem 5.9 ([Hat02, Proposition 0.17]). *For a topological space X and $i : A \subset X$ be a subspace. If i satisfies the homotopy extension property and A is contractible, then $q : X \rightarrow X/A$ has a homotopy inverse such that X and X/A are homotopy equivalent.*

In particular, if X is a CW complex and $A \subset X$ is contractible subcomplex, $q : X \rightarrow X/A$ has a homotopy inverse such that X and X/A are homotopy equivalent.

Exercise 5.10. Let $i : A \subset X$ be a subspace of a space, then we have a quotient map $C(i) = X \cup_i C(A) \rightarrow X \cup_i C(A)/C(A) \cong X/A$. Show that if X is a CW complex and $i : A \subset X$ is a subcomplex, then the quotient map $X \cup_i C(A) \rightarrow X \cup_i C(A)/C(A) \cong X/A$ is a homotopy equivalence. Hint: Recall that Exercise 5.4.

A class of CW complexes, called Δ -complex, is more combinatorial and easier to understand. It also deeply relates to the so-called simplicial complex (an ancestor of CW complex), but not exactly the same.

Definition 5.11. A Δ -decomposition (or Δ -complex structure) of X is CW decomposition of X such that

- All characteristic maps are singular simplexes $\varphi_\alpha^q : \Delta^q \rightarrow X$. (Here, you may feel weird since $\Delta^q \cong D^q$, the point here is we do not want to specify those homeomorphisms $\Delta^q \cong D^q$, which makes the following condition more natural.)
- For all $\alpha \in I_q$ and $0 \leq i \leq q$, there exists $\beta \in I_{q-1}$ such that the composition $\Delta^{q-1} \xrightarrow{\delta_q^i} \Delta^q \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha} X$ equals φ_β^{q-1} .

Exercise 5.12. In Example 2.8, we define some singular simplexes σ_I . Show that all those σ_I and their all faces (including faces of faces, and so on) define a Δ -complex structure on S^n .

Another example of Δ -complex structure is for T^2 , where we present in Example 11.36.

5.2. Cellular homology. Here, we define a particular chain complex for CW complex, say, the cellular chain. And we eventually show that the homology for the cellular chain computes the singular homology for CW complexes.

Notice, we may assume X is a finite-type CW complex to avoid more technical details for *your first reading* (and feel free to assume finite-type condition in all questions below if you want). But all results and constructions in this section are true for general CW complexes.

Let us take a CW complex X , for¹ $k \geq 0$, we define spaces

$$Q^k = X^k / X^{k-1}, \quad E^k = X^k / X^{k-2},$$

where $X^{-1} = X^{-2} := \emptyset$, together with the evident commutative diagram for $k \geq 1$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X^{k-1} & \xrightarrow{i_k} & X^k & \xrightarrow{u_k} & C(i_k) \\ \downarrow q_{k-1} & & \downarrow \pi_k & & \downarrow c_k \\ Q^{k-1} & \xrightarrow{j_k} & E^k & \xrightarrow{v_k} & C(j_k) \end{array}$$

where u_k, v_k are natural maps comes with mapping cone, c_k is induced by π_k on $X^k / \sim$ and induced by q_{k-1} on $C(X^{k-1}) / \sim$ (the map γ in Exercise 4.30). Evidently, we set $C(i_0) = C(j_0) = X^0$ and $q_0 = \pi_0 = c_0 = u_0 = v_0 = \text{id}$.

Remark 5.13. The motivation for the construction is that: Based on the experience of Corollary 4.33, only H_k, H_{k-1} changes if we glue some k -cell. So, we would like to focus on X^k, X^{k-1} by modulo X^{k-2} on the space level. You might see that j_k could be understood as i_k / X^{k-2} in some sense.

In the next exercise, we will see that both $C(i_k)$ and $C(j_k)$ has the homotopy type of Q^k .

Exercise 5.14 (Definition for cellular chain groups). Recall that in Exercise 5.10 we show that for a subspace $i : A \subset X$, the quotient maps $C(i) = X \cup_i C(A) \rightarrow X \cup_i C(A) / C(A) \cong X / A$ is a homotopy equivalence when i is a subcomplex of CW complexes. Here, we would like to use it.

For $k \geq 1$, i_k and j_k gives inclusions of subspaces, then we have quotient maps

$$s_k : C(i_k) \rightarrow Q^k, \quad t_k : C(j_k) \rightarrow Q^k.$$

Remark that, as before, we simply set $s_0 = t_0 = \text{id}$.

It is direct to verify that $s_k = t_k \circ c_k$ (recall $c_k : C(i_k) \rightarrow C(j_k)$ defined before).

Show that $C(i_k) \simeq Q^k$ and $C(j_k) \simeq Q^k$. Then we have a commutative diagram of ISOMORPHISMS

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H_q(C(i_k)) & \xrightarrow{H_q(s_k)} & H_q(Q^k) \\ \downarrow H_q(c_k) & & \parallel \\ H_q(C(j_k)) & \xrightarrow{H_q(t_k)} & H_q(Q^k). \end{array}$$

Hint: To apply Exercise 5.10, the main job here is to show that i_k and j_k are inclusion for subcomplexes of CW complexes.

Now we already show Exercise 5.5 that $Q^k \cong \vee_\alpha S_\alpha^k$, we have that when $k = q$ all four terms are isomorphic to $\oplus_\alpha \mathbb{Z}[e_\alpha^k]$ for $k \geq 1$ by Exercise 4.14 and for $k = 0$ by Proposition 2.20.

¹In most of subsections, we use q to indicate grading; the only exception is this subsection where we prefer k .

Notice that here we use an annoying notation $H_k(f_k)$. Later we will simply write f_k if no further confusion.

Then we **define** for $k \geq 0$

$$C_k(X) := H_k(Q^k) \cong \oplus_{\alpha} \mathbb{Z}[e_{\alpha}^k],$$

and $C_k(X) = 0$ for negative k .

Exercise 5.15 (Definition for cellular differential). For $k \geq 1$, show that

(1) We have commutative diagrams, for $k \geq 2$,

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & H_k(X^{k-1}) & \xrightarrow{i_k} & H_k(X^k) & \xrightarrow{q_k} & C_k(X) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & H_{k-1}(X^{k-1}) & \longrightarrow & H_{k-1}(X^k) \\ \parallel & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \pi_k & & \parallel & & \downarrow q_{k-1} & & \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & 0 & \longrightarrow & H_k(E^k) & \xrightarrow{\pi_k} & C_k(X) & \xrightarrow{d_k} & C_{k-1}(X) & \longrightarrow & H_{k-1}(E^k) \end{array}$$

and, for $k = 1$,

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & H_1(X^0) & \xrightarrow{i_1} & H_1(X^1) & \xrightarrow{q_1} & C_1(X) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & H_0(X^0) & \longrightarrow & H_0(X^1) \oplus \mathbb{Z} \\ \parallel & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \pi_1 & & \parallel & & \parallel & & \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & 0 & \longrightarrow & H_1(E^1) & \xrightarrow{\pi_1} & C_1(X) & \xrightarrow{d_1} & C_0(X) & \longrightarrow & H_0(E^1) \oplus \mathbb{Z} \end{array}$$

where all horizontal sequences are exact.

Hint: To construct δ and exact sequences, we first use the mapping cone sequence Proposition 4.29 (but the non-reduced version in $k = 1$, as explained in Remark 4.31), and then use Exercise 5.14 to show that maps in mapping cone sequence can be replaced by maps here. The commutativity relations for maps is then either true on spaces level, or by commutative relations in Exercise 5.14. We also use Exercise 5.14 to show some homologies are trivial.

In particular, we have a homomorphism

$$d_k : C_k(X) \rightarrow C_{k-1}(X).$$

(2) Show $d_k d_{k+1} = 0$ by embedding the composition $d_k d_{k+1}$ into the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} & & C_{k+1}(X) & & & & \\ & & \downarrow \delta & \searrow d_{k+1} & & & \\ \longrightarrow & H_k(X^k) & \xrightarrow{q_k} & C_k(X) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & H_{k-1}(X^{k-1}) & \longrightarrow \\ & & & \searrow d_k & \downarrow q_{k-1} & & \\ & & & & C_{k-1}(X), & & \end{array}$$

where the horizontal line is the mapping cone sequence for i_k .

Definition 5.16. For a CW complex X , we define its cellular chain complex by

$$C_*(X) = (C_k(X), d_k).$$

Its homology groups are called the cellular homology of X , denoted by $H_k^{CW}(X)$.

Theorem 5.17. We have $H_k^{CW}(X) \simeq H_k(X)$ for a CW complex. In particular, cellular homology is independent of choices of CW decompositions.

We prove it through the following 2 exercises.

Exercise 5.18. For a CW complex X , show that 1) $H_k(X^n) = 0$ for $k > n$. 2) $H_k(X^n) \cong H_k(X^{n+1})$ for $k < n$. 3) $H_k(X^n) \cong H_k(X)$ for $k < n$. Hint: Use the mapping cone sequence for i_k for 1) and 2); and for 3) you shall use the idea in Exercise 4.38 and (4)-Remark 5.2.

Exercise 5.19. Using the commutative diagram in Exercise 5.15, do some diagram chasing to show that 1) $\ker d_k \cong H_k(X^k)$, and $\operatorname{im}(d_{k+1}) \cong \ker(H_k(X^k) \xrightarrow{H_k(i_{k+1})} H_k(X^{k+1}))$. 2) Conclude the result of Theorem 5.17 using Exercise 5.18 - 2) and 3).

Exercise 5.20 (Explicit formula for cellular differential). Let X be a CW complex. Recall $C_k(X) = \bigoplus_{\alpha} \mathbb{Z}[e_{\alpha}^k]$ where e_{α}^k are k -cells.

For each pair $(e_{\alpha}^k, e_{\beta}^{k-1})$ with $k \geq 2$, define

$$f_{\alpha\beta} : S_{\alpha}^{k-1} \xrightarrow{\partial\varphi_{\alpha}^k} X^{k-1} \xrightarrow{q_{k-1}} Q^{k-1} = X^{k-1}/X^{k-2} \xrightarrow{p_{\beta}} S_{\beta}^{k-1}$$

to be the composite, where the last map p_{β} is the projection to the β -th wedge summand

$$X^{k-1}/X^{k-2} \cong \bigvee_{\beta} S_{\beta}^{k-1}.$$

In this exercise, we shall show that for $k \geq 2$

$$d_k(e_{\alpha}^k) = \sum_{\beta} \deg(f_{\alpha\beta}) e_{\beta}^{k-1},$$

i.e. the matrix coefficient of d_k from e_{α}^k to e_{β}^{k-1} is exactly $\deg(f_{\alpha\beta})$. Notice that this is a finite sum because of (4)-Remark 5.2.

(1) Let $u_k \in H_k(S^k) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ be the generator u_k such that $\delta(u_k) = u_{k-1}$ under the Mayer-Vietoris differential (for example, we can take $u_k = [\tau_{S^k}]$ in Exercise 4.18), and recall the map $\Phi_{\alpha}^k : S^k \cong D^k/S^{k-1} \rightarrow Q^k = X^k/X^{k-1}$. Show that $e_{\alpha}^k = (\Phi_{\alpha}^k)_k(u_k) \in H_k(Q^k) = C_k(X)$.

(2) By definition of characteristic map φ_{α}^k , we have the following commutative diagram of maps

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} S^{k-1} & \xrightarrow{i} & D^k & \longrightarrow & D^k/S^{k-1} \cong S^k & \xleftarrow{\cong} & C(i) \\ \downarrow q_{k-1} \circ \partial\varphi_{\alpha}^k & & \downarrow \pi_k \circ \varphi_{\alpha}^k & & \downarrow \Phi_{\alpha}^k & & \downarrow c_{\alpha}^k \\ Q^{k-1} & \xrightarrow{j_k} & E^k & \longrightarrow & Q^k & \xleftarrow[t_k]{\simeq} & C(j_k), \end{array}$$

where c_{α}^k is the map between cones constructed in Exercise 4.30 (i.e. γ there).

Prove the following commutative diagram of homologies follows from Exercise 4.30:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H_k(S^k) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & H_{k-1}(S^{k-1}) \\ (\Phi_{\alpha}^k)_k \downarrow & & \downarrow (q_{k-1} \circ \partial\varphi_{\alpha}^k)_{k-1} \\ C_k(X) = H_k(Q^k) & \xrightarrow{d_k} & H_{k-1}(Q^{k-1}) = C_{k-1}(X), \end{array}$$

and show that

$$d_k(e_{\alpha}^k) = d_k((\Phi_{\alpha}^k)_k(u_k)) = (q_{k-1} \circ \partial\varphi_{\alpha}^k)_{k-1}(\delta(u_k)).$$

(3) By our choices of u_k (i.e. $\delta(u_k) = u_{k-1}$), we have $d_k(e_{\alpha}^k)$ is the image the generator u_{k-1} of $H_{k-1}(S^{k-1})$ under the gluing map $q_{k-1} \circ \partial\varphi_{\alpha}^k$. Conclude the matrix coefficient of d_k from e_{α}^k to e_{β}^{k-1} is $\deg(f_{\alpha\beta})$.

Exercise 5.21. For $k = 1$, notice that $\phi_{\alpha}^1 : D^1 \simeq I \rightarrow X^1$ is a path and $\phi_{\alpha}^1(t) \in X^0$ for $t = 0, 1$. Show that²

$$d_1(e_{\alpha}^1) = \phi_{\alpha}^1(1) - \phi_{\alpha}^1(0).$$

Hint: This is essentially a manipulation for the comparison of reduced $\tilde{H}_0$ and non-reduced H_0 , compare to Exercise 2.31 and Remark 4.31.

Exercise 5.22. Write down the cellular chain $C_*(X)$ for $X = S^n, T^2, \Sigma$ surface of genus $g, \mathbb{CP}^n$, and compute their homology (surely computing the cellular homology, but we know the result is isomorphic to the singular homology). Then compare your computation with Example 4.34. Notice, you shall give CW decomposition first!

²In principle, we can state the d_1 formula in terms degree as well. But then we need to be careful with the notion of degree for S^0 , which is a little fretful.

Exercise 5.23. Suppose X has a Δ -complex structure, show that for $k \geq 1$ that

$$d(e_\alpha^k) = \sum_{i=0}^k (-1)^i \partial_i e_\alpha^k,$$

where $\partial_i e_\alpha^k$ means the cell given by the map $\varphi_\alpha^k \circ \delta_k^i$. I.e the cellular boundary of e_α^k is the usual simplicial boundary of the singular simplex φ_α^k .

In this case, we also call the $H_*^{CW}(X)$ the simplicial homology of X .

Remark 5.24. In this section, we mainly consider cellular homology as a computational tool. However, we may also develop an entire homology theory for cellular homology, for example, functoriality and long exact sequences. We left the discussion to interested readers.

5.3. Some fun applications.

Exercise 5.25. If X is a finite-type CW complex, show that $H_q(X)$ is a finitely generated abelian group for all q . In particular, one can define Betti numbers for finite CW complexes.

Exercise 5.26. Recall Definition 3.21. For a finite-type CW complex X , denote $c_q(X)$ as the rank of $C_q(X)$, i.e. the number of q -cells. Show that if X is finite, then

$$\chi(X) = \sum_q (-1)^q c_q(X).$$

This is the fancy version of $2 = \chi(S^2) = V - E + F$.

6. KÜNNETH FORMULA

In this section, we discuss the product space and its homology.

6.1. Alexander-Whitney map and Eilenberg-Zilber theorem. To study $S_*(X \times Y)$, we are trying to compare it with $S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y)$. Therefore, it means that for a singular simplex $\sigma : \Delta_n \rightarrow X \times Y$, we are trying to find some simplexes $\Delta_p \rightarrow X$ or $\Delta_{n-p} \rightarrow Y$. We're gonna give those construction.

Construction: For $n \geq 0$ and $0 \leq p \leq n$, we define two maps

$$[v_0, \dots, v_p] : \Delta^p \rightarrow \Delta^n, \quad [v_p, \dots, v_n] : \Delta^{n-p} \rightarrow \Delta^n,$$

i.e., the first p -dimensional simplex and the last $(n-p)$ -dimensional simplex.

Definition 6.1. For singular simplex³ $\sigma : \Delta^n \rightarrow Z$ and $0 \leq p \leq n$, we define

$${}_p\sigma : \Delta^p \xrightarrow{[v_0, \dots, v_p]} \Delta^n \xrightarrow{\sigma} Z, \quad \sigma_{n-p} : \Delta^{n-p} \xrightarrow{[v_p, \dots, v_n]} \Delta^n \xrightarrow{\sigma} Z.$$

Definition 6.2. For $X \times Y \xrightarrow{p_1} X$ and $X \times Y \xrightarrow{p_2} Y$, we define the Alexander-Whitney map

$$AW_n : S_n(X \times Y) \rightarrow (S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y))_n, \quad \sigma \mapsto \sum_{p=0}^n p_{1\#}({}_p\sigma) \otimes p_{2\#}(\sigma_{n-p}).$$

Supplement material 6.3. The essence of the construction is the following question: For the diagonal map $\delta : \Delta_p \rightarrow \Delta_p \times \Delta_p$, it is clear that Δ_p has a CW decomposition such that q -cells are q -faces of Δ_p , and $\Delta_p \times \Delta_p$ has a product CW decomposition (Exercise 6.13). But in this case, δ does not map q -skeleton to q -skeleton. The work of Alexander-Whitney gives a map $\delta' : \Delta_p \rightarrow \Delta_p \times \Delta_p$ such that $\delta' \simeq \delta$ and δ' respects the CW decomposition. And the above construction is deeply related to the construction of δ' .

Exercise 6.4. Prove the following face identities

$$\begin{aligned} d_i({}_p\sigma) &= {}_{p-1}(d_i\sigma), & 0 \leq i \leq p-1, \\ d_j(\sigma_{n-p}) &= (d_{p+j}\sigma)_{n-p-1}, & 1 \leq j \leq n-p, \\ d_p({}_p\sigma) &= {}_{p-1}\sigma, \\ d_0(\sigma_{n-p}) &= \sigma_{n-p+1}. \end{aligned}$$

Then show that the Alexander-Whitney map $AW : S_*(X \times Y) \rightarrow S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y)$ is a chain map, and moreover, if $f : X \rightarrow X'$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Y'$, then $f_{\#} \otimes g_{\#} \circ AW = AW \circ (f \times g)_{\#}$.

Theorem 6.5 (Eilenberg-Zilber). *The Alexander-Whitney map $AW : S_*(X \times Y) \rightarrow S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y)$ is a chain homotopy equivalence, i.e. there exists $EM : S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y) \rightarrow S_*(X \times Y)$ such that $AW \circ EM \simeq \text{id}$ and $EM \circ AW \simeq \text{id}$.*

Moreover, we can take EM such that for $f : X \rightarrow X'$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Y'$, then $(f \times g)_{\#} \circ EM = EM \circ f_{\#} \otimes g_{\#}$.

Proof. The proof needs some more fancy algebra, or careful geometry. We omit it in our course. We refer to [Die08, Section 9.7] and exercises therein. $\square$

Supplement material 6.6. Both EM and the homotopies here are unique up to (higher) homotopies.

To the reader's convenience, we write down one very common formula of EM : We say a permutation λ of $1, \dots, p+q$ is a (p, q) -shuffle if $\lambda(1) < \dots < \lambda(p)$, and $\lambda(p+1) < \dots < \lambda(p+q)$. For a (p, q) -shuffle, one can define a linear map $[\lambda] : \Delta^{p+q} = [v_i]_i \rightarrow \Delta^p \times \Delta^q = [s_a]_a \times [t_b]_b$. Let $a_i = |\{1 \leq k \leq p \mid \sigma(k) \leq i\}|$, $b_i = |\{1 \leq l \leq q \mid \sigma(p+l) \leq i\}|$, then $[\lambda]$ is the linear extension the assignment

$$[\lambda](v_i) = (s_{a_i}, t_{b_i}).$$

³Here, we use Z to indicate that the construction does not only work for $X \times Y$, or X, Y .

Then we set

$$EM : S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y) \rightarrow S_*(X \times Y), \quad \sigma \otimes \tau \mapsto \sum_{\lambda} \text{sign}(\lambda)(\sigma \times \tau) \circ [\lambda],$$

where λ runs for all (p, q) -shuffles.

If you know the wedge of differential form, you are probably familiar with this formula. Also, the decomposition shown in the proof of the homotopy invariance is a special case here by taking $q = 1$.

Supplement material 6.7. Another interesting point is that both AW and EM works in some way for simplicial sets. Then we can actually show that the Dold-Kan correspondence (Supplement material 2.13) is a monoidal functor in a certain sense.

Remark 6.8. Here, we should be careful on the coefficient. If we consider $S_*(-; R)$ for a commutative ring R and treat $S_*(-; R)$ as chain complex over R , then we also have $S_*(X; R) \otimes_R S_*(Y; R) \simeq S_*(X \times Y; R)$ since $S_*(X)$ is a free chain complex.

Theorem 6.9 (Künneth formula). *For X, Y be two space, we have a short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=r} H_p(X) \otimes H_q(Y) \rightarrow H_r(X \times Y) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=r-1} \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_p(X), H_q(Y)) \rightarrow 0.$$

Proof. Under Theorem 6.5, we have chain homotopy equivalence $S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y) \simeq S_*(X \times Y)$.

Notice that $S_*(X)$ and $S_*(Y)$ are free chain complex, so $S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y)$ computes the derived tensor product. Then we can use the algebraic Künneth formula Theorem A.19. $\square$

Remark 6.10. Here, we refer to Remark 2.29 for the black-box of $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}$. The theorem has a generalization for all commutative rings R , but the statement is more subtle: the above argument still work but the subtlety is that when you compute a derived tensor product over R , you need a spectral sequence for higher Tor_k^R . The simpleness of $\mathbb{Z}$ is it is a PID, so only $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}$ is non-zero; and for a field $\mathbb{F}$, $\text{Tor}_k^{\mathbb{F}} = 0$ for all k .

Therefore, for a field $\mathbb{F}$, we actually have

$$\bigoplus_{p+q=r} H_p(X; \mathbb{F}) \otimes_{\mathbb{F}} H_q(Y; \mathbb{F}) \cong H_r(X \times Y; \mathbb{F}).$$

Exercise 6.11. Suppose for X, Y we have $H_p(X), H_q(Y)$ are finitely generated abelian groups for all p, q , then $H_r(X \times Y)$ is finitely generated abelian group for all r .

In particular, we have $b_r(X \times Y) = \sum_{p+q=r} b_p(X) b_q(Y)$.

Exercise 6.12. Show that $H_q(T^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}^d$ where $d = \binom{n}{q}$.

6.2. Product of CW complex. Though the general product theorem is harder to prove. The case for CW complex is more intuitive. Here, we give the explanation.

Exercise 6.13. Let X, Y be two finite-type CW complexes with the set of cells $\{e_i^p\}$ and $\{e_j^q\}$. We define $(X \times Y)^r = \cup_{p+q \leq r} X^p \times Y^q$ with the cells set $\{e_i^p \times e_j^q\}$, and characteristic maps for $e_i^p \times e_j^q$ by $\varphi_i^p \times \varphi_j^q : D^{p+q} \cong D^p \times D^q \rightarrow X \times Y$. Show⁴ that this is indeed a finite-type CW decomposition of $X \times Y$. Try to see the CW decomposition of T^2 we gave in Example 4.34 is the one that comes from the product of S^1 (with the evident CW decomposition).

Exercise 6.14. ** Show the following differential formula

$$d_{p+q}(e_i^p \times e_j^q) = (d_p e_i^p) \times e_j^q + (-1)^p e_i^p \times (d_q e_j^q).$$

Hint: The technique is similar to Exercise 5.20. But the mystery sign $(-1)^p$ comes from choices of orientation of spheres (i.e., choice of the generator of $H_n(S^n)$).

⁴The product decomposition still gives a CW decomposition if one of X or Y is finite-type or both X and Y have countably many q -cells for all q , but it is more tricky.

Exercise 6.15. Let X, Y be two finite-type CW complexes, and equip $X \times Y$ the product CW decomposition of Exercise 6.13. Show that the following map induces isomorphism of chain complex

$$C_*(X \times Y) \rightarrow C_*(X) \otimes C_*(Y), \quad e_i^p \times e_j^q \mapsto e_i^p \otimes e_j^q.$$

Consequently, we have

Theorem 6.16. *For X, Y be two finite-type CW complexes, we have a short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=r} H_p^{CW}(X) \otimes H_q^{CW}(Y) \rightarrow H_r^{CW}(X \times Y) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=r-1} \operatorname{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_p^{CW}(X), H_q^{CW}(Y)) \rightarrow 0.$$

Then by Theorem 5.17, you may obtain a different proof of Theorem 6.9 for finite-type CW complexes.

Notice that the discussion of Remark 6.10 for the coefficient also applies.

Proof. Under Exercise 6.15, we can use the algebraic Künneth formula Theorem A.19. □

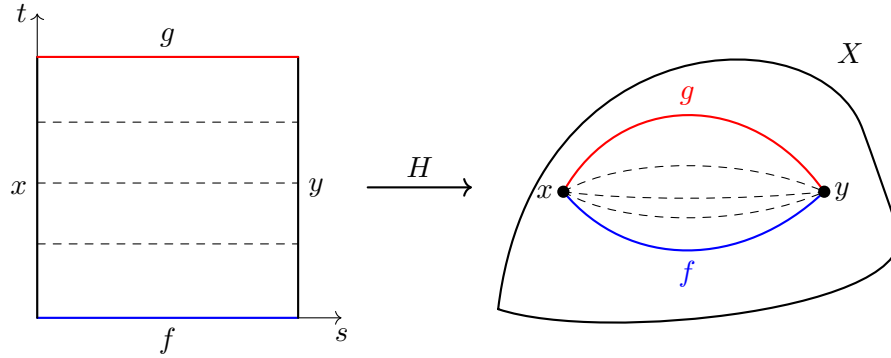
7. TOPOLOGICAL FUNDAMENTAL GROUP

We are now switching to the study of the fundamental group $\pi_1(X)$ of a topological space X . Its flavor is different from homology, even though, as we will see, there is a deep connection between the fundamental group and the first homology group $H_1(X)$ of X . The definition of the fundamental group is rather simple compared to homology groups: it is just defined as the group of homotopy classes of loops based at a fixed point, so we do not need any chain complexes nor homological algebra here. However, homology groups are more simple in the sense that they happen to be abelian, whereas the fundamental group might be highly non-abelian. In fact, as we will see, every group can be realized as the fundamental group of a space.

7.1. Construction and first properties.

Let X be a topological space. A *path* is a continuous map $I \rightarrow X$. As a specialization of Remark 1.11, we want to be able to deform two paths with fixing endpoints, so when we speak about homotopy of paths we require the homotopy to fix the two endpoints:

Definition 7.1. If f and g are two paths in X from x to y , f and g are *homotopic* if there exists a homotopy $H : I \times I \rightarrow X$ between them: we should have the usual conditions $H(s, 0) = f(s)$ and $H(s, 1) = g(s)$, and also the stability of endpoints: $H(0, t) = x$ and $H(1, t) = y$, for all $t \in I$.



This defines an equivalence relation on paths (basically the same as Exercise 1.2), and we write $[f]$ for the class of f . A *loop* is defined as a path $f : I \rightarrow X$ with equality of the endpoint: $f(0) = f(1)$. The space obtained from I by identifying 0 and 1 is homeomorphic to the sphere S^1 , so loops can be seen as maps $S^1 \rightarrow X$.

Definition 7.2. Fix a point $x \in X$. The *fundamental group* $\pi_1(X, x)$ is defined as the homotopy classes of loops based at x .

This defines $\pi_1(X, x)$ as a set, but in fact composition of paths gives a natural structure of group, as we explain now:

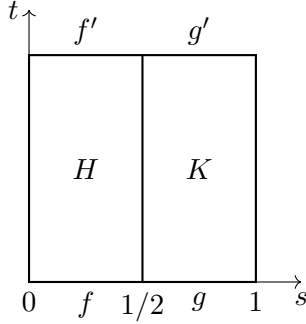
Composition: Given two paths $f : x \rightarrow y$ and $g : y \rightarrow z$, $g \cdot f$ is the path $x \rightarrow z$ defined by traversing first f , and then g , twice as fast:

$$(g \cdot f)(s) = \begin{cases} f(2s) & 0 \leq s \leq 1/2, \\ g(2s - 1) & 1/2 \leq s \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

Be aware that there are two different conventions appearing in the literature. Our convention, where we read the product from right to left, keeps the idea of composition of functions. The other convention, from left to right (where ours $g \cdot f$ would be written $f \cdot g$), is more geometrical. This choice will be important when we speak about the monodromy action and the equivalence between covering spaces and $\pi_1(X, x)$ -sets.

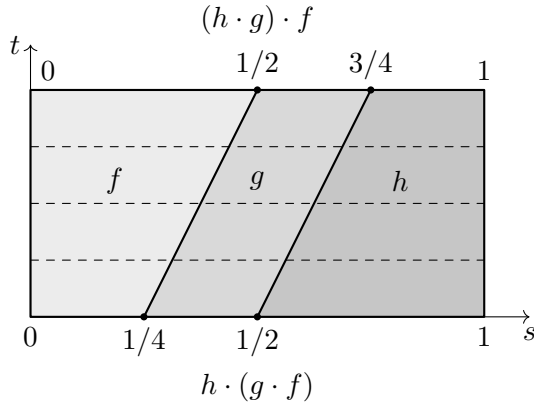
An important property is that composition of paths passes to homotopy equivalence: if $f \simeq f'$ and $g \simeq g'$ via some respective homotopies H and K , the picture below (showing the square

domain of homotopies) shows that $g \cdot f \simeq g' \cdot f'$. Hence we can define the composition on homotopy classes without any ambiguity: $[g][f] = [g \cdot f]$.



$$(K \cdot H)(s, t) = \begin{cases} H(2s, t), & 0 \leq s \leq 1/2, \\ K(2s - 1, t), & 1/2 \leq s \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

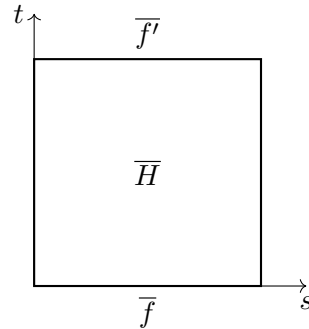
Composition of paths is associative on homotopy classes: if f, g and h are composable paths, we have $h \cdot (g \cdot f) \simeq (h \cdot g) \cdot f$, as shown in the picture below.



$$H(s, t) = \begin{cases} f\left(\frac{4s}{1+t}\right), & 0 \leq s \leq \frac{1+t}{4}, \\ g(4s - 1 - t), & \frac{1+t}{4} \leq s \leq \frac{2+t}{4}, \\ h\left(\frac{4s - 2 - t}{2 - t}\right), & \frac{2+t}{4} \leq s \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

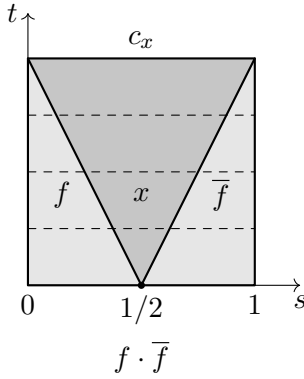
Constant path: If $x \in X$, write c_x for the constant path based at x : $c_x(s) = x$ for all $s \in I$.

Inverse: The inverse of $f : x \rightarrow y$ is the path $f^{-1} : y \rightarrow x$, also written $\bar{f}$, defined by $\bar{f}(s) = f(1 - s)$. Any homotopy H between f and f' gives a homotopy $\bar{H}$ between $\bar{f}$ and $\bar{f}'$:



$$\bar{H}(s, t) = H(1 - s, t)$$

Moreover, we have $\bar{f} \cdot f \simeq c_x$, as shown in the picture below:



$$H(s, t) = \begin{cases} f\left(\frac{2s}{1-t}\right), & 0 \leq t < 1, 0 \leq s \leq \frac{1-t}{2}, \\ x, & 0 \leq t < 1, \frac{1-t}{2} \leq s \leq \frac{1+t}{2}, \\ f\left(\frac{2(1-s)}{1-t}\right), & 0 \leq t < 1, \frac{1+t}{2} \leq s \leq 1, \\ x, & t = 1. \end{cases}$$

Finally, it is easy to see that $f \cdot c_x \simeq f \simeq c_y \cdot f$.

These observations imply that $\pi_1(X, x)$ is a group with the composition of homotopy classes of paths, where the identity element is $1 = [c_x]$, and the inverse of $[f]$ is $[f]^{-1} = [\bar{f}]$.

Dependence on the basepoint:

How much does $\pi_1(X, x)$ depend on the basepoint x ? Let's take $y \in X$, and try to relate $\pi_1(X, x)$ and $\pi_1(X, y)$. We need at least x and y to be in the same path-connected component. Let $h : x \rightarrow y$ be a path in X . If f is a loop based at x , then $hf\bar{h}$ is a loop based at y . This observation leads to the following result:

Proposition 7.3. *The map*

$$\pi_1(X, x) \xrightarrow{\gamma_h} \pi_1(X, y)$$

defined by $[f] \mapsto [h \cdot f \cdot \bar{h}]$ is well-defined and defines an isomorphism of groups.

Proof. It is easy to see that the map $f \mapsto hf\bar{h}$ passes to homotopy equivalence of loops, so γ_h is well-defined. Let f_1 and f_2 be two loops based at x :

$$\gamma_h([f_1 \cdot f_2]) = [h \cdot f_1 \cdot f_2 \cdot \bar{h}] = [h \cdot f_1 \cdot \bar{h} \cdot h \cdot f_2 \cdot \bar{h}] = \gamma_h([f_1]) \cdot \gamma_h([f_2]).$$

Moreover, at the level of identity elements we have $\gamma_h([c_x]) = [h \cdot \bar{h}] = [c_y]$. We conclude that γ_h is a group morphism. In fact, it is easy to check that $\gamma_{\bar{h}} : \pi_1(X, y) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$ is an inverse of γ_h since it satisfies $\gamma_h \circ \gamma_{\bar{h}} = \text{id}_{\pi_1(X, y)}$ and $\gamma_{\bar{h}} \circ \gamma_h = \text{id}_{\pi_1(X, x)}$, so γ_h is an isomorphism of groups. $\square$

Exercise 7.4. Check that the morphism γ_h depends only on the homotopy class $[h]$.

Corollary 7.5. *If X is path-connected, the fundamental group $\pi_1(X, x)$ is independent from x up to isomorphism. It is often denoted $\pi_1(X)$.*

Remark 7.6. If $h : x \rightarrow y$ and $g : y \rightarrow x$ are paths in X and f is a loop based at x , we have $\gamma_{g \cdot h}([f]) = [g \cdot h][f][g \cdot f]^{-1}$, so $\gamma_{g \cdot h}([f]) = [f]$ if $\pi_1(X, x)$ is abelian. Therefore, if $\pi_1(X, x)$ is abelian, γ_h is independent on the choice of $h : x \rightarrow y$, hence there is a canonical way to identify $\pi_1(X, x)$ and $\pi_1(X, y)$.

Definition 7.7. A space X is called *simply-connected* if it is path-connected and has trivial fundamental group: $\pi_1(X) = \{1\}$. (By the preceding discussion, the triviality of the fundamental group does not depend on the choice of any basepoint.)

Example 7.8. A contractible space is always simply-connected. From (Example 1.9), we have that any convex subspace of a real vector space is simply connected. We have for instance for all $n \geq 1$:

$$\pi_1(\mathbb{R}^n) = \{1\}, \quad \pi_1(\mathbb{C}^n) = \{1\}, \quad \pi_1(D^n) = \{1\}.$$

Be aware that not all simply-connected spaces are contractible. When $n \geq 2$, the sphere of dimension n is not contractible, but we will see that it is simply connected: $\pi_1(S^n) = \{1\}$.

Proposition 7.9. *A space X is simply-connected if and only if there exists a unique homotopy class of paths connecting any two points in X .*

Proof. Assume X is simply connected, and f, g are two paths $x \rightarrow y$ in X . We have

$$[f] = [f \cdot \bar{g} \cdot g] = \underbrace{[f \cdot \bar{g}]}_{\in \pi_1(X)=\{1\}} [g] = [g].$$

Reciprocally, if there is only one homotopy class of paths connecting any two points, then all loops at x are homotopic to c_x , so X is simply connected. $\square$

Induced morphisms

Let $\varphi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map sending a point $x \in X$ to $y \in Y$ (we will usually write $\varphi : (X, x) \rightarrow (Y, y)$). If f is a loop in X based at x , $\varphi \circ f$ is a loop in Y based at y , leading to the following result:

Proposition 7.10. *The map $\varphi : (X, x) \rightarrow (Y, y)$ induces a group morphism*

$$\varphi_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y)$$

defined by $\varphi_([f]) = [\varphi \circ f]$.*

Proof. It is well-defined: a homotopy $(f_t)_{t \in I}$ of loops based at x yields a composed homotopy $(\varphi \circ f_t)_{t \in I}$ based at y satisfying $\varphi_*([f_0]) = [\varphi \circ f_0] = [\varphi \circ f_1] = \varphi_*([f_1])$. It is a group morphism since $\varphi \circ (f \cdot g) = (\varphi \circ f) \cdot (\varphi \circ g)$, and $\varphi \circ c_x = c_y$. $\square$

The existence of induced morphisms describe as above tells us that the association $(X, x) \mapsto \pi_1(X, x)$ defines in fact a *functor*

$$\pi_1(-) = \mathbf{Top}_* \rightarrow \mathbf{Gp}$$

from the category of pointed topological spaces $\mathbf{Top}_*$ to the category of groups $\mathbf{Gp}$.

Indeed, we have

- i) $\text{id}_{(X, x)} = \text{id}_{\pi_1(X, x)}$ (often written more synthetically $\mathbb{1}_* = \mathbb{1}$)
- ii) for composable maps $(X, x) \xrightarrow{\psi} (Y, y) \xrightarrow{\varphi} (Z, z)$, we have $(\varphi\psi)_* = \varphi_*\psi_*$.

Remark 7.11. We can easily see that if $\varphi : (X, x) \rightarrow (Y, y)$ is a homeomorphism with inverse ψ , then $\varphi_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y)$ is an isomorphism with inverse ψ_* .

Proposition 7.12. *If A is a deformation retract of X , with inclusion $\iota : A \hookrightarrow X$, then ι_* induces an isomorphism between $\pi_1(A, x)$ and $\pi_1(X, x)$, for all $x \in A$.*

Proof. Let $r : X \rightarrow A$ be a retraction such that $r \simeq \mathbb{1}_X$. There exists a homotopy $(r_t)_{t \in I} : X \rightarrow X$ such that $r_0 = \mathbb{1}_X$ and $r_1 = r$; so in particular $r_1(X) = A$. If f is a loop in X based at x , $(r_t f)_{t \in I}$ gives a homotopy between $r_0 f = f$ and $r_1 f$ which is a loop in A . We deduce that $\iota : \pi_1(A, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$ is surjective. We also have $r \iota = \mathbb{1}_A$, so $\mathbb{1} = (r \iota)_* = r_* \iota_*$, so ι_* should be injective, hence an isomorphism. $\square$

Homotopy invariance of the fundamental group:

We saw that the fundamental group is invariant (up to isomorphisms) by homeomorphisms. However, in algebraic topology, we often like to have a stronger invariance by homotopy equivalence. This is the case of singular homology, and as we explain here this is also satisfied by fundamental groups.

Proposition 7.13. *If $\varphi : X \rightarrow Y$ is a homotopy equivalence, then the induced morphism*

$$\varphi_* : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, \varphi(x))$$

is an isomorphism for all $x \in X$.

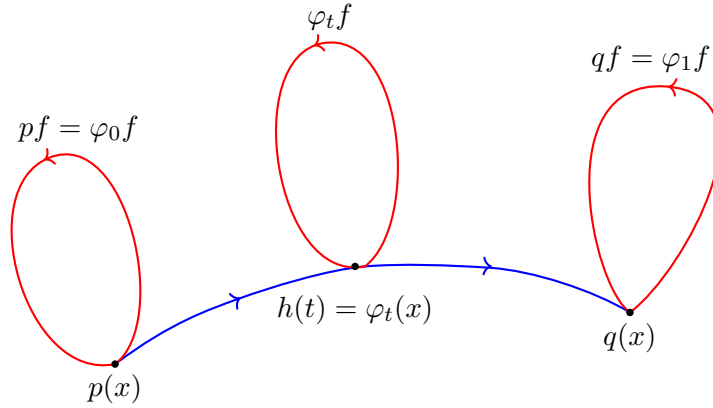
Before proving this homotopy invariance, we need the following lemma:

Lemma 7.14. *Let $p, q : X \rightarrow Y$ be two homotopic maps $X \rightarrow Y$ via some homotopy $(\varphi_t)_{t \in I}$ with $\varphi_0 = p$ and $\varphi_1 = q$. Take $x \in X$, and let $h : p(x) \rightarrow q(x)$ be the path in Y defined by $h(t) = \varphi_t(x)$. With the notation γ_h introduced in (Proposition 7.3), the following diagram is commutative:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \pi_1(X, x) & \\ p_* \swarrow & & \searrow q_* \\ \pi_1(Y, p(x)) & \xrightarrow{\gamma_h} & \pi_1(Y, q(x)) \end{array}$$

Proof. For each $t \in I$, consider the new path $h_t : p(x) \rightarrow \varphi_t(x)$ in Y defined by $h_t(s) = h(st) = \varphi_{st}(x)$. If f is a loop in X based at x , $\varphi_t f$ is a loop in Y based at $\varphi_t(x)$, so $\bar{h}_t \cdot \varphi_t f \cdot h_t$ is a loop in Y based at $p(x)$ (look at the picture below for clarity). When t varies in I , this defines a homotopy of loops in Y based at $p(x)$ between $p f$ ($t=0$) and $\bar{h} \cdot q f \cdot h$, so we have the equality $p_*([f]) = [\bar{h} \cdot q f \cdot h]$ in $\pi_1(Y, p(x))$. Applying γ_h to this equality, we get

$$\gamma_h(p_*([f])) = [h \cdot \bar{h} \cdot q f \cdot h \cdot \bar{h}] = [q f] = q_*([f]).$$



□

We are now ready to prove the homotopy invariance of the fundamental group:

Proof of Prop. 7.13. Let $\psi : Y \rightarrow X$ be a homotopy inverse of φ , so that $\psi\varphi \simeq \mathbb{1}_X$ and $\varphi\psi \simeq \mathbb{1}_Y$. Consider the sequence of morphisms:

$$\pi_1(X, x) \xrightarrow{\varphi_*} \pi_1(Y, \varphi(x)) \xrightarrow{\psi_*} \pi_1(X, \psi\varphi(x)) \xrightarrow{\varphi_*} \pi_1(Y, \varphi\psi\varphi(x)).$$

As $\psi\varphi \simeq \mathbb{1}_X$, the composition of the two first is an isomorphism since by the lemma above it is of the form γ_h for some path h in X . We deduce that the first φ_* is injective. The same reasoning with the two last two (the composition of which is an isomorphism as well) shows that ψ_* is injective. The composition of the two first morphisms is an isomorphism, and both of the are injective, which implies that the first φ_* is surjective, hence it is an isomorphism.

□

Fundamental group of a product:

Proposition 7.15. *If X and Y are path-connected, then we have an isomorphism:*

$$\pi_1(X \times Y) \simeq \pi_1(X) \times \pi_1(Y).$$

Proof. By definition of the product topology, for any topological space S , a function $f = (h, g) : S \rightarrow X \times Y$ is continuous if and only if h and g are continuous. Taking $S = I$, we obtain a bijection between loops in $X \times Y$ based at (x, y) and pairs of loops in X and Y based at x and y . Taking $S = I \times I$, we obtain a bijection between homotopies of loops in $X \times Y$ and pairs of homotopy of loops in X and in Y ... Hence the result.

□

Similarly, for any family $(X_\alpha)_{\alpha \in I}$ of path-connected topological spaces, when we endow the product of the X_α with the product topology, we have:

$$\pi_1 \left(\prod_{\alpha \in I} X_\alpha \right) = \prod_{\alpha \in I} \pi_1(X_\alpha).$$

7.2. Examples and applications.

An important example of fundamental group is the fundamental group of the sphere S^1 of dimension 1.

Define a map $p : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow S^1$ by $p(s) = e^{2i\pi s}$. It wraps each interval of the form $[n, n+1]$ once around S^1 .

Proposition 7.16. *We have an isomorphism:*

$$\pi_1(S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}.$$

Before giving the proof, we need some lemmas about lifting of paths and of homotopies.

Lemma 7.17 (Lifting of paths and homotopies).

- (i) *If $f : I \rightarrow S^1$ is a path with $f(0) = 1$, for each integer $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ there exists a unique path $\tilde{f}$ in $\mathbb{R}$ with $\tilde{f}(0) = n$ lifting f , ie. satisfying $f = p \circ \tilde{f}$.*
- (ii) *If $H : I \times I \rightarrow S^1$ is a homotopy between two paths f, g in S^1 satisfying $f(0) = 1$, then for each integer $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ there exists a unique lift $\tilde{H} : I \times I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ of H to $\mathbb{R}$ (so that $H = p \circ \tilde{H}$) satisfying $\tilde{H}(0, 0) = n$.*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & & \mathbb{R} \\ & \nearrow \tilde{f} & \downarrow p \\ I & \xrightarrow{f} & S^1 \end{array}$$

In fact we have (ii) implies (i), taking for H the trivial homotopy from f to itself. This lemma will be proved later in the bigger generality of *covering spaces*, so we postpone the proof for that moment. Let's just say here that these lifting properties are true because S^1 looks locally "like $\mathbb{R}$ " and because I and $I \times I$ are compact. The lifting properties are in fact one of the most important features of covering spaces.

Proof of Proposition 7.16. For each integer $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, define a loop f_n in S^1 by $f_n(s) = e^{2i\pi ns}$. It is easy to see that $[f_m][f_n] = [f_{m+n}]$, we have $f_0 = c_1$, so $n \mapsto [f_n]$ defines a morphism

$$i : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \pi_1(S^1, 1).$$

We want to see that it is an isomorphism.

If f is any loop in S^1 based at 1, by Lemma 7.17 (i) there exists a unique lift $\tilde{f}$ of f to $\mathbb{R}$ such that $\tilde{f}(0) = 0$. By Lemma 7.17 (ii), if $f \simeq g$ then $\tilde{f} \simeq \tilde{g}$, so $\tilde{f}(1) = \tilde{g}(1)$. Let's give more details: a homotopy $H : I \times I \rightarrow S^1$ between f and g lifts to a unique homotopy $\tilde{H} : I \times I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with $\tilde{H}(0, 0) = 0$. The path $\tilde{H}(0, t)$ has value 0 at 0 and $p \circ \tilde{H}(0, t) = H(0, t) = 1$, so by uniqueness of lift of paths it is the constant paths based at 0. By the same uniqueness, we have, for all $s \in I$, $\tilde{f}(s) = \tilde{H}(s, 0)$ and $\tilde{g}(s) = \tilde{H}(s, 1)$. The path $\tilde{H}(1, t)$ has initial point $\tilde{f}(1)$ and projects in S^1 on the same point 1, so again by uniqueness it is the constant path $\tilde{f}(1)$. So in fact $\tilde{H}$ is a homotopy between the paths $\tilde{f}$ and $\tilde{g}$, and $\tilde{f}(1) = \tilde{g}(1)$.

Consequently, we have a well-defined morphism

$$j : \pi_1(S^1, 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

defined by $j([f]) = \tilde{f}(1)$. Note that we always have $\tilde{f}(1) \in \mathbb{Z}$ since $p(\tilde{f}(1)) = 1$.

We have $j([f_n]) = n$, so $j \circ i = \text{id}_{\mathbb{Z}}$, i is injective and j is surjective. If f and g are two loops in S^1 based at 1 such that $j([f]) = j([g])$, then $\tilde{g}^{-1} \cdot \tilde{f}$ is a loop in $\mathbb{R}$ based at 0. But $\mathbb{R}$ is simply connected, so $[\tilde{g}^{-1} \cdot \tilde{f}] = [c_0] = 1$. Applying p_* to the above equality gives

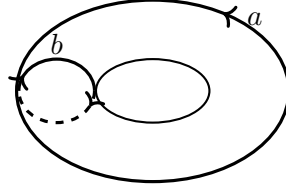
$$1 = p_*(1) = p_*([\tilde{g}^{-1} \cdot \tilde{f}]) = p_*([\tilde{g}])^{-1} \cdot p_*([\tilde{f}]) = [g]^{-1} \cdot [f],$$

so $[f] = [g]$ and j is injective, hence it is an isomorphism. From $j \circ i = \mathbb{1}_{\mathbb{Z}}$, we conclude that i is an isomorphism. $\square$

Direct application: We can now compute the fundamental group of the torus $T^2 = S^1 \times S^1$. By (Proposition 7.15), we have $\pi_1(T^2) = \pi_1(S^1) \times \pi_1(S^1)$, so we conclude that

$$\pi_1(T) = \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}$$

In fact $\pi_1(T^2) \simeq \mathbb{Z}^2$ is generated by the two loops a and b drawn here:



Definition 7.18. Let $\iota \in \pi_1(S^1, 1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ be a generator. The *degree* of a continuous map $f : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$, denoted $\deg(f)$, is defined by the composite

$$\pi_1(S^1, 1) \xrightarrow{f_*} \pi_1(S^1, f(1)) \xrightarrow{\gamma_h} \pi_1(S^1, 1)$$

sending ι to $\deg(f)\iota$, where h is any path $f(1) \rightarrow 1$ in S^1 . Note that γ_h is independent of h since $\pi_1(S^1, 1)$ is abelian (see Remark 7.6).

Exercise 7.19. Check that the degree defined above is the same as the mapping degree defined in Definition 4.19.

By the homotopy invariance diagram 7.14, if two maps $f, g : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ are homotopic, we have equality of degrees: $\deg(f) = \deg(g)$.

Note that $\deg(c_x) = 0$ if $x \in S^1$, and $\deg(f_n) = n$ if $f_n : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ is defined by $z \mapsto z^n$ (when S^1 is interpreted as the complex numbers of norm 1).

We will now see some interesting applications of the above description of $\pi_1(S^1)$.

Fundamental theorem of algebra:

The famous Fundamental theorem of algebra states any complex polynomial $P \in \mathbb{C}[X]$ has a complex root. This is equivalent to saying that P splits in $\mathbb{C}$ (has all its roots in $\mathbb{C}$). More conceptually, it is equivalent to saying that the field $\mathbb{C}$ is algebraically closed, or that $\mathbb{C}$ is an algebraic closure of $\mathbb{R}$. There are several proofs of this theorem. The most famous one uses compactness of the complex disk and Liouville theorem in complex analysis. There is also a more Galois-theoretical proof that uses Galois theory, Sylow theorem in group theory and the intermediate value theorem. Here we present an elegant algebraic-topological proof using the notion of degree of a map $S^1 \rightarrow S^1$.

Proposition 7.20. Let $P[X] = X^n + c_1X^{n-1} + \dots + c_n \in \mathbb{C}[X]$ be a complex polynomial, with $n > 0$. Then P has a root in $\mathbb{C}$.

Proof. Assume that P has no root in $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\hat{P} : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ be the continuous map defined by

$$\hat{P}(x) = \frac{P(x)}{|P(x)|}.$$

Let's investigate the degree of $\hat{P}$. Define the map $H : S^1 \times I \rightarrow S^1$ by

$$H(x, t) = \frac{P(tx)}{|P(tx)|},$$

this defines a homotopy from $c_{f(0)/|f(0)|}$ to $\hat{P}$. We deduce that $\deg(\hat{P}) = 0$.

Define now the map $H' : S^1 \times I \rightarrow S^1$ by

$$H'(x, t) = \frac{\tilde{P}(x, t)}{|\tilde{P}(x, t)|},$$

where

$$\tilde{P}(x, t) := t^n P(x/t) = x^n + t(c_1 x^{n-1} + t c_2 x^{n-2} + \dots + t^{n-1} c_n).$$

This is a homotopy from f_n (with $f_n(z) = z^n$) to $\hat{P}$, so we have $\deg(\hat{P}) = n \neq 0$. This leads to a contradiction, hence the existence of a root of P in $\mathbb{C}$. $\square$

Borsuk-Ulam theorem in dimension 2:

Theorem 7.21 (Borsuk-Ulam in dimension 2). *If $f : S^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ is a continuous map, there exists a pair of antipodal points $(x, -x)$ in S^2 with $f(x) = f(-x)$.*

This theorem is also true for any dimension $n \geq 2$. It can be proved with a similar flavor of the following proof, but using singular homology instead of the fundamental group.

Proof. Assume the statement is false some continuous map $f : S^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$. We can define a continuous map $g : S^2 \rightarrow S^1$ by

$$g(x) = \frac{f(x) - f(-x)}{|f(x) - f(-x)|}.$$

Let η be a loop circling around the equator of S^2 , namely $\eta(s) = (\cos(2\pi s), \sin(2\pi s), 0)$. Let h be the loop in S^1 defined by $h = g \circ \eta$. We have $g(x) = -g(-x)$, so for all $0 \leq t \leq 1/2$ we have $h(t) = -h(t + 1/2)$. Let $\tilde{h}$ be a lift $I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ of h to $\mathbb{R}$. There exist some odd integer q_t such that

$$\tilde{h}(t + 1/2) = \tilde{h}(t) + \frac{q_t}{2},$$

and this expression depends continuously on $t \in [0, 1/2]$. As q_t is an integer, it should be constant on $[0, 1/2]$. Write $q_t = q$. We have

$$\tilde{h}(1) = \tilde{h}(1/2) + \frac{q}{2} = \tilde{h}(0) + q.$$

We deduce that $[h] = q\iota$, where ι is a generator of $\pi_1(S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$. In particular, as q is odd, we have $[h] \neq 0$. But $[h] = g_*([\eta]) = 0$ since $[\eta] \in \pi_1(S^2)$ and S^2 is simply-connected (we will prove it very soon). This leads to a contradiction. $\square$

Remark 7.22. We obtain from this theorem that there does not exist any subset of $\mathbb{R}^2$ homeomorphic to S^2 .

Exercise 7.23. Whenever S^2 is expressed as the union of three closed subsets A_1, A_2 and A_3 , show that at least one of these must contain a pair of antipodal points $(x, -x)$.

Exercise 7.24. Let D_1, D_2 and D_3 three compact subsets of $\mathbb{R}^3$. Show that there exists one plane $P \subset \mathbb{R}^3$ that simultaneously divides each D_i into two pieces of equal measure.

Exercise 7.25. Does the Borsuk-Ulam theorem hold for the torus T^2 ? In other words, for a map $f : S^1 \times S^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$, must there exist $(x, y) \in S^1 \times S^1$ such that $f(x, y) = f(-x, -y)$?

7.3. Homotopy category and fundamental groupoid (just a few words). If one wants to study fundamental groups without having to deal with basepoints, an interesting notion is the *fundamental groupoid*. Without giving too much details of category theory, let's give here the main ideas.

Here are some categories that already appeared naturally:

- **Top**: the category of topological spaces, with continuous maps.
- **Top_{*}**: the category of pointed topological space (X, x) (with $x \in X$) and continuous maps preserving the basepoints.
- **Gp**: the category of groups with group morphisms

We already saw that $\pi_1(-)$ defines a functor: $\mathbf{Top}_\star \rightarrow \mathbf{Gp}$.

Definition 7.26. The *homotopy category* $\mathbf{hTop}$ is defined as having the same objects than $\mathbf{Top}$, but the maps between X and Y are homotopy classes of maps:

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbf{hTop}}(X, Y) = [X, Y].$$

We define in the same way the *pointed homotopy category* $\mathbf{hTop}_\star$ from $\mathbf{Top}_\star$, where the homotopies should preserve basepoints.

From (7.13), the fundamental group is a homotopy invariant functor, in the meaning that it factors:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{Top}_\star & \xrightarrow{\pi_1(-)} & \mathbf{Gp} \\ & \searrow & \nearrow \\ & \mathbf{hTop}_\star & \end{array}$$

As a functor $\mathbf{hTop}_\star \rightarrow \mathbf{Gp}$ we have $\pi_1(-) = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbf{hTop}_\star}((S^1, 1), -)$.

Definition 7.27. A *groupoid* is a category whose morphisms are all isomorphisms (for instance a group is always a groupoid over a single object). Write $\mathbf{Gpd}$ for the category of groupoids, with morphisms functors between categories.

An important example of groupoid appearing in our context is the following:

Definition 7.28. If X is a topological space, the *fundamental groupoid* of X is $\Pi(X) \in \mathbf{Gpd}$ whose object are the points of X , and the morphisms $x \rightarrow y$ are the homotopy classes of paths from x to y .

Check that we have, for any $x \in X$:

$$\pi_1(X, x) = \mathrm{End}_{\Pi(X)}(x).$$

One can view $\Pi(-)$ as a functor $\mathbf{Top} \rightarrow \mathbf{Gpd}$, or even as a functor $\mathbf{hTop} \rightarrow \mathbf{Gpd}$, where we do not need to deal with basepoints. The following propositions tells you that the fundamental group and the fundamental groupoid are equivalent as groupoids, even though they are not isomorphic since $\Pi(X)$ has much more points.

Proposition 7.29. *Let X be a path-connected space. If $x \in X$, consider the group $\pi_1(X, x)$ as a groupoid with only one object. For each, $x \in X$ the inclusion functor*

$$\pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \Pi(X)$$

is an equivalence of categories.

Exercise 7.30. Prove this equivalence of categories.

It is possible to study all the properties of the fundamental group via the more general study of the fundamental groupoid. This point of view is partially developed in [May99].

Supplement material 7.31. Recall that we define $\mathrm{Sing}(X)_\bullet$ before, and we say it is a Kan complex, which is an ∞ -groupoid, i.e. ∞ -categorical version of groupoid.

There exists a truncation construction $\mathrm{ho} : \mathrm{Cat}_\infty \rightarrow \mathrm{Cat}_1$, which maps ∞ -groupoid to usual groupoid. One can actually prove that $\mathrm{ho}(\mathrm{Sing}(X)_\bullet) \simeq \Pi(X)$ [Kerodon, Tag/0049]. So, sometime, we also write $\mathrm{Sing}(X)_\bullet$ as $\Pi_\infty(X)$ and write $\Pi(X)$ as $\Pi_{\leq 1}(X)$.

7.4. Fundamental group and homology: special case of Hurewicz theorem.

We are going to see that the fundamental group $\pi_1(X)$ and the first homology group $H_1(X)$ are closely related. This comes from the fact that a path $I \rightarrow X$ is the same as a 1-simplex. If f is a loop, it is a cycle when considered as a 1-simplex, since $\partial f = f(1) - f(0) = 0$ (see 2.16). We have the following comparison:

Theorem 7.32. *Let X be a space and $x \in X$. Considering loops as 1-simplices gives a morphism:*

$$h : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow H_1(X).$$

It is surjective when X is path-connected, and its kernel is the commutator subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$, which gives an isomorphism with the abelianization of the fundamental group:

$$H_1(X) \simeq \pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$$

Proof. If f and g are two paths in X , recall that we write $f \simeq g$ when f and g are homotopic, and we will write $f \sim g$ when f and g are homologous as 1-simplices (when $f - g$ is the boundary of 2-simplex). To check that h is a well-defined morphism, we need to check the following points:

- Any constant path c_x in X is homologous to 0: $c_x \sim 0$. We need to check that c_x is a boundary, and it is easy to see if σ denotes the constant 2-simplex at x :

$$\partial\sigma = \sigma|_{[v_1, v_2]} - \sigma|_{[v_0, v_2]} + \sigma|_{[v_0, v_1]} = c_x - c_x + c_x = c_x$$

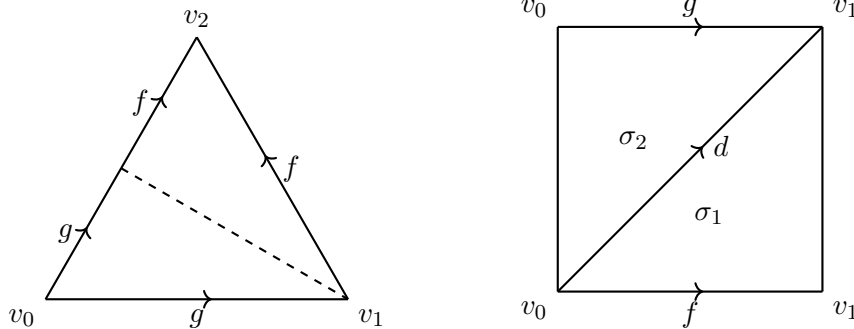
- $f \simeq g \implies f \sim g$: if $H : I \times I \rightarrow X$ is a homotopy between f and g , this gives a pair of 2-simplices σ_1 and σ_2 as in the picture below. The diagonal 1-simplex d cancels when we compute the boundary:

$$\partial(\sigma_1 - \sigma_2) = c_{f(1)} - d + f - g + d - c_{g(0)} = f - g + c_{f(1)} - c_{g(0)} \sim f - g$$

- $f \cdot g \sim f + g$: indeed any composable paths f and g give a 2-simplex σ given as below. Its boundary is

$$\partial\sigma = g - f \cdot g + f.$$

- $\bar{f} \sim -f$: from the point above we have $f + \bar{f} \sim \bar{f} \cdot f \sim c_{f(0)} \sim 0$



We conclude that the map $h : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow H_1(X)$ is well-defined and is a group morphism.

We want to show that h is surjective. Let $\sigma = \sum n_i \sigma_i$ be a 1-cycle representing a given element of $H_1(X)$. After allowing some repetitions and allowing to replace σ_i by $\bar{\sigma}_i$, one can assume that $\sigma = \sum \sigma_i$. If some σ_i is not a loop, the fact that $\partial\sigma = 0$ implies that there exists an index $j \neq i$ such that the composed path $\sigma_j \cdot \sigma_i$ is defined. We can replace σ_i and σ_j by the single term $\sigma_j \cdot \sigma_i$ (because $\sigma_i + \sigma_j = \sigma_j \cdot \sigma_i$), so we can assume that all the σ_i are loops. Since X is path-connected, for each i we can choose a path γ_i from x to $\sigma_i(0)$. We have $\bar{\gamma}_i \cdot \sigma_i \cdot \gamma_i \sim \sigma_i$, so we can assume that all the σ_i are loops based at x . Write ψ be the loop obtained by composing all (finite number) the loops σ_i , in any chosen order. We have $\psi \sim \sum \sigma_i = \sigma$, showing that h is surjective.

As $H_1(X)$ is abelian, h factors through $\pi_1(X, x)^{\text{ab}}$, in other words $D(\pi_1(X, x)) \subseteq \ker(h)$, where $D(\pi_1(X, x))$ is the commutator subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$, ie. the group generated by the commutators (the elements of the form $[\sigma, \eta] = \sigma\eta\sigma^{-1}\eta^{-1}$). What is left to check is reverse inclusion $\ker(h) \subseteq D(\pi_1(X, x))$. Let f be a loop in X based at x such that $h([f]) = 0$, so that $f \sim 0$. Then there exists a 2-simplex $\sigma = \sum_{i=1}^m m_i \sigma_i$ such that

$$(7.1) \quad f = \partial\sigma = \sum_{i=1}^m m_i (\sigma_i|_{[v_1, v_2]} - \sigma_i|_{[v_0, v_2]} + \sigma_i|_{[v_0, v_1]})$$

If v is any vertex of one of the σ_i , take a path γ_v in X from x to v . If e is an edge (from v to v') of one of the σ_i , write $\hat{e}$ for the loop $\overline{\gamma_{v'}} \cdot e \cdot \gamma_v$ based at x . For any $1 \leq i \leq m$, let $v_{i,0}$, $v_{i,1}$ and $v_{i,3}$ the vertices of σ_i , and $e_{i,0}, e_{i,1}$ and $e_{i,2}$ the corresponding edges, seen as paths in X . The loop $e_{i,2} \cdot \overline{e_{i,1}} \cdot e_{i,0}$ is homotopic to the constant loop at $v_{i,1}$, so the loop $e_{i,2} \cdot \overline{e_{i,1}} \cdot e_{i,0}$ is homotopic to the constant loop at x , so trivial in $\pi_1(X, x)$, hence in $\pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$ as well. In other words, in $\pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$ we have (in additive notation):

$$e_{i,2} - e_{i,1} + e_{i,0} = 0 \in \pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$$

In $\pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$, the equation 7.1 can be written:

$$\hat{f} = \sum_{i=1}^m m_i \underbrace{(e_{i,2} - e_{i,1} + e_{i,0})}_{=0} \in \pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}},$$

so we have $f = 0$ in $\pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$, hence f is in the commutator subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$. $\square$

Example 7.33. From the fundamental group $\pi_1(\Sigma_g)$ of the closed surface of genus g described slightly later in 8.14, we get directly that:

$$H_1(\Sigma_g) \simeq \mathbb{Z}^{2g}.$$

Remark 7.34. Here is another way to define the map $h : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow H_1(X)$. Take a generator α of $H_1(S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$. Let $[\gamma] \in \pi_1(X, x)$ represented by a loop $\gamma : S^1 \rightarrow X$ which induces on homology a morphism $f_* : H_1(S^1) \rightarrow H_1(X)$. We can define $h([\gamma]) := \gamma_*(\alpha)$. Check that this is a well-defined morphism which corresponds to the one we already defined.

Supplement material 7.35 (Higher homotopy groups). The above theorem 7.32 is a special case of a more general and difficult theorem known as the Hurewicz theorem, that we are going to explain. If $s_1 \in S^1$ is a fixed point, recall that $\pi_1(X, x)$ can be defined as the group $[(S^1, s_1), (X, x)]$ of homotopy classes of pointed maps.

Definition 7.36. If $n \geq 1$, fix $s_n \in S^n$. One can define in the same flavor the *higher homotopy group* $\pi_n(X, x)$ by

$$\pi_n(X, x) := [(S^n, s_n), (X, x)].$$

One can check that $\pi_n(X, x)$ has always a natural structure of group for which it is commutative for $n \geq 2$.

In fact, one can describe all the homotopy groups using iterated loop spaces.

Let (X, x) be a pointed space. The (based) loop space $\Omega_x X$ is defined as the set of continuous map $(S^1, \text{pt}) \rightarrow (X, x)$ equipping with the open-compact topology. If no further confusion, we often omit x in the notation, and denote it by ΩX . The based loop space

$$\Omega_x X$$

is based by the constant loop $c_x \in \Omega_x X$, and then we can consider iterated loop space $\Omega^n X := \Omega(\Omega^{n-1} X)$ for $n \geq 0$ (we set $X = \Omega^0 X$.)

Then one can show that for all $n \geq 0$, we have $\pi_n(X, x) \cong \pi_0(\Omega^n X)$ (in fact, we can regard as a definition of π_n), and then we have $\pi_n(X, x) \cong \pi_1(\Omega^{n-1} X)$ isomorphic as groups.

This observation provides one explanation why π_1 has a group structure and why π_n are commutative for $n \geq 2$: The loop concatenation, which we used to define the group structure of π_1 , defines a map $\Omega X \times \Omega X \rightarrow \Omega X$, and then ΩX is a so-called H-space, then one can define another monoid structure on $\pi_n(X, x) \cong \pi_1(\Omega^{n-1} X)$ using the H-space structure on $\Omega^{n-1} X$, which is a priori different with the group structure on π_1 , but have certain compatibility of two groups structures. However, one can show that, if one equips a monoid with another monoid structure in a compatible way, those two monoid structures are the same and both of them are commutative. This is the Eckmann–Hilton argument.

The story leads to two directions: 1) To see the associativity of the H-space structure on ΩX , one can find the construction we used to show associativity of π_1 can help us to construct infinite many operations on ΩX parameterized by the associahedra, which leads to the first homotopy

associativity structure, the A_∞ -space structure on ΩX . 2) The commutativity of π_2 essentially leads to the study of infinity loop space and then $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -structure (which shall appear again in our study for the cup product of singular cohomology).

Supplement material 7.37 (Hurewicz theorem in higher dimension).

Definition 7.38. Fix some integer $n \geq 2$. A topological space is called $(n-1)$ -connected if X is non-empty and path-connected ($\pi_0(X) = \{0\}$), and the homotopy groups $\pi_k(X)$ are trivial for $1 \leq k \leq n-1$. We say that it is 0-connected if it is path-connected. For instance the sphere S^n is $(n-1)$ -connected.

Note that the sphere S^n can be considered as a n -cycle, this observation gives rise to the Hurewicz morphism $\pi_n(X, x) \xrightarrow{h_n} H_n(X)$. To make it more precise, let $\alpha \in H_n(S^n, \mathbb{Z}) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ a fundamental class (a generator). An element $[f]$ of $\pi_n(X, x)$ is represented by a continuous map $f : S^n \rightarrow X$ inducing a morphism $f_* : H_n(S^n, \mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow H_n(X, \mathbb{Z})$ on homology. The Hurewicz morphism $h_n : \pi_n(X, x) \rightarrow H_n(x, \mathbb{Z})$ is defined by

$$h_n([f]) = f_*(\alpha).$$

The following Hurewicz theorem provides an important bridge between homotopy groups (often difficult to compute) and homology groups (usually more manageable):

Theorem 7.39. Assume that X is $(n-1)$ -connected for some integer $n \geq 1$. Then:

- (i) the Hurewicz morphism $\pi_n(X, x) \xrightarrow{h_n} H_n(X, \mathbb{Z})$ is an isomorphism if $n \geq 2$, and if $n = 1$ its abelianization $h_1^{\text{ab}} : \pi_1(X, x)^{\text{ab}} \rightarrow H_1(X, \mathbb{Z})$ is an isomorphism.
- (ii) the reduced singular homology groups $\tilde{H}_k(X)$ are trivial for all $0 \leq k \leq n-1$.

This shows for instance that $\pi_n(S^n) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ for any $n \geq 1$.

Supplement material 7.40 (Whitehead's theorem). What can we know from a space if we know its higher homotopy groups? Do they determine the homotopy type? Whitehead's theorem is a deep result stating that under some conditions the homotopy type is completely determined by the higher homotopy groups.

Definition 7.41. If $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a continuous map sending x to y , as in the case $n = 1$ we have an induced morphism $f_* : \pi_n(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_n(Y, y)$ at the level of higher homotopy groups for $n \geq 1$.

Here is the big theorem:

Theorem 7.42 (Whitehead's theorem). Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map between connected CW-complexes, sending x to y , such that for each $n \geq 1$, f induces an isomorphism

$$f_* : \pi_n(X, x) \xrightarrow{\sim} \pi_n(Y, y).$$

Then f is a homotopy equivalence.

It is important here to work with CW-complexes, as shown by the counter example of the Warsaw circle (9.7) which has the same higher homotopy groups as a point, but is not homotopic to it. It is also important that the isomorphisms of higher homotopy groups are realized by a map f , as shown in the counter-example with $S^2 \times \mathbb{R}P^3$ and $S^3 \times \mathbb{R}P^2$.

Using Hurewicz theorem, one can deduce a homology version of Whitehead's theorem:

Theorem 7.43 (Homology Whitehead's theorem). Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map between simply connected CW-complexes such that the induced map on homology

$$f_* : H_n(X, \mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow H_n(Y, \mathbb{Z})$$

is an isomorphism for each $n \geq 0$. Then f is a homotopy equivalence.

Counter-examples when the CW-spaces are not simply connected are given by the so-called *acyclic spaces*.

EXERCISES**Exercise 7.44 (Cancellation property for composition of paths).**

Show that the composition of paths satisfies the following cancellation property: if $g_0 \cdot f_0 \simeq g_1 \cdot f_1$ and $g_0 \simeq g_1$, then $f_0 \simeq f_1$.

Exercise 7.45 (Induced morphisms and change of basepoints). Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map, with a path $h : x_1 \rightarrow x_2$ in X . Write $y_1 = f(x_1)$ and $y_2 = f(x_2)$. Show that the following diagram is commutative:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \pi_1(X, x_1) & \xrightarrow{\gamma_h} & \pi_1(X, x_2) \\ f_* \downarrow & & \downarrow f_* \\ \pi_1(Y, y_1) & \xrightarrow{\gamma_{f \circ h}} & \pi_1(Y, y_2) \end{array}$$

Exercise 7.46 (Boundary of the filled torus).

Let $X = S^1 \times D^2$ be the solid (filled) torus, with boundary $\partial X = T = S^1 \times S^1$. Show that there does not exist any retraction $r : X \rightarrow T$ from X to its boundary.

Exercise 7.47 (Fundamental group of a topological group).

Let G be a topological group (meaning that it is a group and a topological space such that multiplication and taking the inverse are continuous) and take its identity element e as its base point. Define the pointwise product of loops α and β by $(\alpha \times \beta)(t) = \alpha(t)\beta(t)$. Prove that $\alpha \times \beta$ is homotopy equivalent to the composition of paths $\beta \cdot \alpha$. Deduce that $\pi_1(G, e)$ is abelian.

Exercise 7.48 (Loops representing an element of the center of the fundamental group).

Let $(f_t)_{t \in I}$ be a homotopy in X such that f_0 and f_1 are the identity map.

- (i) Show that for any $x \in X$, the loop $f_t(x)$ based at x represents an element of the center of $\pi_1(X, x)$.

In other words, a loop represents an element of the center of $\pi_1(X)$ if it extends to a loop of maps $X \rightarrow X$ based at the identity $\mathbb{1}_X$.

- (ii) If X is a topological group, show that any loop γ in X based at the identity element e is obtained as above for a certain homotopy of maps $(f_t : X \rightarrow X)_{t \in I}$ with f_0 and f_1 being the identity. You might need to use exercise 7.47

Supplement material 7.49 (Gottlieb groups).

The above Exercise 7.48 studies the property of the first *Gottlieb group* $G_1(X)$. The *Gottlieb groups* (also known as evaluation subgroups) were introduced by Daniel Henry Gottlieb in 1965. They capture the intricate relationship between the mapping space of self-homotopies and the classical homotopy groups of a topological space. Here are some definitions:

Definition 7.50. Define $\text{Map}(X, X)$ to be the space of continuous self maps of X endowed with the compact-open topology, and write $\text{Map}(X, X)_0$ for the connected component containing the identity $\mathbb{1}_X = \text{id}_X$. The evaluation map $\text{Map}(X, X)_0 \xrightarrow{\text{ev}} X$ defined by $f \mapsto f(x)$ defines for each $n \geq 1$ a morphism

$$\pi_n(\text{Map}(X, X)_0, \mathbb{1}_X) \xrightarrow{\text{ev}_*} \pi_n(X, x),$$

and we define the n^{th} -Gottlieb group of X as the image:

$$G_n(X) = \text{im}(\text{ev}_*) \subseteq \pi_n(X, x).$$

Equivalently, if e is a base point of S^n , an element $[\gamma] \in \pi_n(X, x)$ given by a map $f : S^n \rightarrow X$ is in $G_n(X)$ if and only if it can be extended to a map $H : S^n \times X \rightarrow X$ satisfying $H(-, x) = f$, and $H(e, -) = \mathbb{1}_X$.

The Gottlieb groups are always abelian, and Exercise 7.48 shows that $G_1(X) \subseteq \mathcal{Z}(\pi_1(X, x))$. If X is a H -space (a space with a continuous binary operation and identity up to homotopy), then $G_n(X) = \pi_n(X)$. Examples of H -spaces are topological groups (like $S^1, \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R}), \text{SO}_n(\mathbb{R}), \text{SU}_n, T^n, \dots$) also S^3, S^7 , loop spaces, also Eilenberg-MacLane spaces

$K(G, n)$ for G abelian. To the contrary of lots of constructions in algebraic topology, Gottlieb groups are not functorial.

These Gottlieb groups are related to the global geometry of finite CW -complexes:

Theorem 7.51. *If X is a finite connected CW -complex with non-zero Euler characteristic ($\chi(X) \neq 0$), then $G_1(X) = \{0\}$.*

Corollary 7.52. *If a group G admits a finite Eilenberg-MacLane complex $K(G, 1)$ with $\chi(K(G, 1)) \neq 0$, then its center is trivial.*

Gottlieb groups are related to the long exact sequence of a fibration. If $F \xrightarrow{i} E \xrightarrow{p} B$ is a fibration, the connected boundary homomorphism $\partial : \pi_{n+1}(B) \rightarrow \pi_n(F)$ always lands inside the Gottlieb group: $\text{im}(\partial) \subseteq G_n(F)$.

Using rational homotopy theory, Félix, Halperin and Thomas discovered some rigid finiteness constraint on the rational Gottlieb groups $G_n(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ (under some conditions of finiteness of the Lusternik-Schnirelmann category of X). Finally, Gottlieb groups (and their slight generalizations $J_n(X)$ called *Jiang groups*) play an important role in Nielsen fixed-point theory.

8. VAN-KAMPEN THEOREM

8.1. Colimits in groups.

Recall that the category of groups is cocomplete: it has all small colimits. Let's define here quickly what that means in case you don't know.

Definition 8.1. If J is a small category (it will be our index category), a diagram of groups is a functor

$$\mathcal{D} : J \rightarrow \mathbf{Gp}.$$

This functor associates a group $\mathcal{D}_j$ to each object $j \in J$, and a morphism $\mathcal{D}(f) : \mathcal{D}_i \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_j$ to each map $f : i \rightarrow j$ in J .

A *colimit* of the diagram $\mathcal{D}$ is a group G and a collection of morphisms $(\varphi_j : \mathcal{D}_j \rightarrow G)_{j \in J}$ such that $\varphi_j \circ \mathcal{D}(f) = \varphi_i$ for each map $f : i \rightarrow j$ in J , which satisfies the following universal property: If G' is another group with a collection of morphisms $(\varphi'_j : \mathcal{D}_j \rightarrow G')_{j \in J}$ such that $\varphi'_j \circ \mathcal{D}(f) = \varphi'_i$ for each map $f : i \rightarrow j$ in J , then there exists a unique group morphism $\psi : G \rightarrow G'$ such that for each $j \in J$ we have $\varphi'_j = \psi \circ \varphi_j$.

Colimits as above always exist in the category of groups, and they are unique up to (unique) isomorphism: if G_1 and G_2 are two colimits of the same diagram, then there exist a unique isomorphism $G_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} G_2$ compatible with the diagram. Here are a few examples to give you an idea of how colimits of groups are constructed.

- (i) For instance, the colimit of a discrete family of groups $(G_i)_i$ (the diagram consists just of the groups G_i without morphism between them) is the *free product*

$$\operatorname{colim}_i G_i = \ast_i G_i$$

consisting of the finite words with letters in the G_i 's and no other relations.

- (ii) If $\mathcal{D}$ is the following diagram of groups

its colimit is $\operatorname{colim} \mathcal{D} = (G_1 \ast G_2) / \tilde{N}$, where $\tilde{N}$ is the normal subgroup generated by the elements $i_1(x)i_2^{-1}(x)$ for $x \in N$. It is called the *push-out* of the diagram $\mathcal{D}$, and it is often denoted by $G_1 \ast_N G_2$.

Remark 8.2. A free product of groups might not be a free group. Indeed, consider $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \ast \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$. It consists of words in a, b with $a^2 = b^2 = 1$, like $e, a, b, ab, ba, aba, bab, \dots$

Let $\varepsilon : \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \ast \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ associating to each word its length modulo 2. The morphism ε is surjective, and we have $\ker(\varepsilon) = \langle ab \rangle \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ (because $ba = (ab)^{-1}$). It gives rise to the short exact sequence

$$1 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \ast \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow 1$$

As this short exact sequence admits some splitting, $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \ast \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ can be expressed as a semi-direct product

$$\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \ast \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \simeq \mathbb{Z} \rtimes \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}.$$

It is sometimes called the *infinite dihedral group* D_∞ . Note that it is not a free group.

8.2. Formulations of the theorem.

Let X be a topological space given with a cover $X = \bigcup_{\alpha} A_{\alpha}$ for a family of open path-connected subsets A_{α} of X all containing a point given point $x \in X$. Each inclusion $A_{\alpha} \hookrightarrow X$ induces a morphism $j_{\alpha} : \pi_1(A_{\alpha}, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$, so all together they give a morphism

$$\Phi : \bigstar_{\alpha} \pi_1(A_{\alpha}, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(X).$$

Let $i_{\alpha\beta} : \pi_1(A_{\alpha} \cap A_{\beta}, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(A_{\alpha}, x)$ be induced by the inclusions $A_{\alpha} \cap A_{\beta} \hookrightarrow A_{\alpha}$. We have $j_{\alpha} i_{\alpha\beta} = j_{\beta} i_{\beta\alpha}$ because they are both induced by $A_{\alpha} \cap A_{\beta} \hookrightarrow X$, so the elements of the form $i_{\alpha\beta}(\omega) i_{\beta\alpha}(\omega)^{-1}$ with $\omega \in \pi_1(A_{\alpha} \cap A_{\beta}, x)$ should be in the kernel of Φ . Van Kampen's theorem tell us that this is enough to compute the fundamental group of X :

Theorem 8.3 (Van Kampen's theorem).

In the setting above, if all the $A_{\alpha} \cap A_{\beta}$ are path connected, the morphism $\Phi : \bigstar_{\alpha} \pi_1(A_{\alpha}, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ is surjective.

If each triple intersection is path-connected and N is the normal subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$ generated by the elements of the form $i_{\alpha\beta}(\omega) i_{\beta\alpha}(\omega)^{-1}$, then $\ker(\Phi) = N$, so we have

$$\pi_1(X) \simeq \left(\bigstar_{\alpha} \pi_1(A_{\alpha}, x) \right) / N$$

Idea of the proof. We will show the surjectivity of Φ . Let $f = I \rightarrow X$ be a loop based at x . By compacity of I , there exist intermediate values $0 = s_0 < s_1 \dots < s_m = 1$ such that $f_i = f|_{[s_{i-1}, s_i]}$ is a path in A_{α_i} . We have $f = f_m \cdot \dots \cdot f_2 \cdot f_1$. Since $A_{\alpha_i} \cap A_{\alpha_{i+1}}$ is path-connected, one can choose a path g_i from x to $f(s_i)$ (see picture below).

The loop

$$(f_n \cdot g_{m-1}) \cdot \dots \cdot (\overline{g_2} \cdot f_2 \cdot g_1) \cdot (\overline{g_1} \cdot f_1)$$

is homotopic to f , and it is a composition of loops each lying in a single A_{α_i} . We deduce that $[f] \in \text{im}(\Phi)$, hence the surjectivity.

As for the second part, we always have $N \subseteq \ker(\Phi)$. We will not show here that $N = \ker(\Phi)$ when each triple intersection is path-connected, since it is a bit long and not particularly interesting. It relies on some *ad hoc* partitioning of $I \times I$ related to two different factorizations on some element $[f] \in \pi_1(X, x)$. See [Hat02], Section 1.2 for a complete proof. $\square$

Supplement material 8.4. In fact the theorem stated above is a consequence of the following more general version (which can be stated for $\pi_1(X)$ or $\Pi(X)$, we write it with the fundamental groupoid for broader generality).

Theorem 8.5. *Let X be path connected, and $\mathcal{U}$ a cover of X by path-connected open subsets, such that the intersection of finitely many is still in $\mathcal{U}$. Consider $\mathcal{U}$ as a category (with inclusion morphisms). The fundamental groupoid functor $\Pi(-)$ gives a diagram $\mathcal{D} : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow \mathbf{Gpd}$. The fundamental groupoid $\Pi(X)$ is the colimit of this diagram:*

$$\Pi(X) = \text{colim } \mathcal{D} = \text{colim}_{U \in \mathcal{U}} \Pi(U)$$

For a nice proof, see [May99]. In this reference, the author deduces the colimit version for $\pi_1(X, x)$ from this colimit version for $\Pi(X)$. This deduction uses only some “categorical nonsense”, in the meaning that it is only a categorical consequence that does not use any more topology.

Corollary 8.6. *Let $X = \bigvee_{\alpha \in I} X_{\alpha}$ be a space expressed as a wedge sum (recall the Definition 1.17) of path-connected pointed subspaces (X_{α}, x_{α}) , such that each X_{α} contains a contractible neighborhood U_{α} of x_{α} . We have*

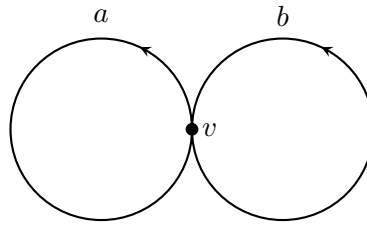
$$\pi_1(X) \simeq \bigstar_{\alpha} \pi_1(X_{\alpha}).$$

Proof. Take the cover $(A_\alpha)_{\alpha \in I}$ by the open subsets $A_\alpha = X_\alpha \bigvee_{\beta \in I \setminus \{\alpha\}} U_\beta$. Any finite intersection of the A_α 's is contractible, and we have $\pi_1(A_\alpha) = \pi_1(X_\alpha)$ because A_α deformation retracts on X_α . We conclude using van Kampen's theorem 8.3. $\square$

Example 8.7 (Wedge sum of two circles). We have

$$\pi_1(S^1 \vee S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z} * \mathbb{Z}$$

which is generated by the homotopy classes of the loops a and b as in the picture below.



Example 8.8. For $n \geq 2$, the sphere of dimension n is simply connected:

$$\pi_1(S^n) = \{0\}.$$

Indeed, take any point $x \in S^n$. We have an open cover $S^n = S^+ \cup S^-$, where $S^+ = S^n \setminus \{x\}$ and $S^- = S^n \setminus \{-x\}$ are path connected opens of S^n , whose intersection is path-connected. Both S^+ and S^- are homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^n$, which we already know as being simply connected. The result is a direct consequence van Kampen's theorem.

Exercise 8.9. Find the fundamental group of the complement in $\mathbb{R}^3$ of:

- (i) a circle,
- (ii) two unlinked circles,
- (iii) two linked circles.

Hint: Remember the Exercise 1.16.

Exercise 8.10 (Hawaiian earrings). The Hawaiian earrings is defined as a subset of $\mathbb{R}^2$ as

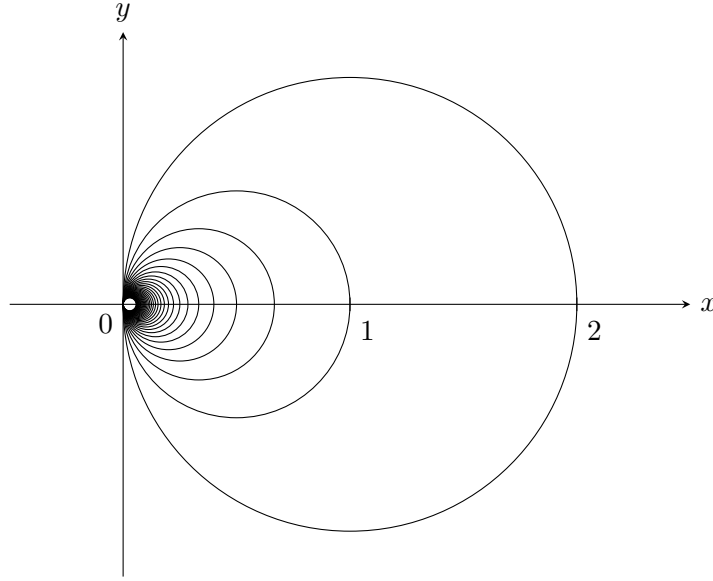
$$X = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} C(1/n, 1/n),$$

where $C(a, b)$ denotes the circle centered at $(a, 0)$ of radius b .

Show that there is a surjection

$$\pi_1(X) \twoheadrightarrow \prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathbb{Z}$$

Deduce that $\pi_1(X)$ is not countable, and X is not homotopy equivalent to the countable wedge sum of circles (recall that a countably generated group is countable).



Supplement material 8.11. Note that X is a compact metric space. The uncountability of its fundamental group can be understood via the following theorem proved by Shelah in 1988:

Theorem 8.12. *If X is a path-connected, locally path-connected compact metric space, its fundamental group $\pi_1(X)$ is finitely generated or uncountable.*

As a consequence, we get that $\mathbb{Q}$ cannot be realized as the fundamental group of such spaces.

Supplement material 8.13 (Hawaiian earrings group). Let G be the fundamental group of the Hawaiian earrings space, sometimes called the Hawaiian earrings group. It is an interesting group in group theory.

The group G can be embedded in the direct limit of free groups:

$$G \hookrightarrow \varinjlim_{n \geq 1} F_n.$$

However, it was proved that G is not free, even though each of its finitely generated subgroups is free (it is in a sense *locally free*). It is even more *essentially freely indecomposable*, meaning that any decomposition

$$G = G_1 * G_2$$

implies that either G_1 or G_2 must be a finitely generated free group. In other words, this big uncountable group G does not split into two large pieces.

8.3. Applications to cell-complexes.

We are now investigating the following question, which will lead to some interesting applications:

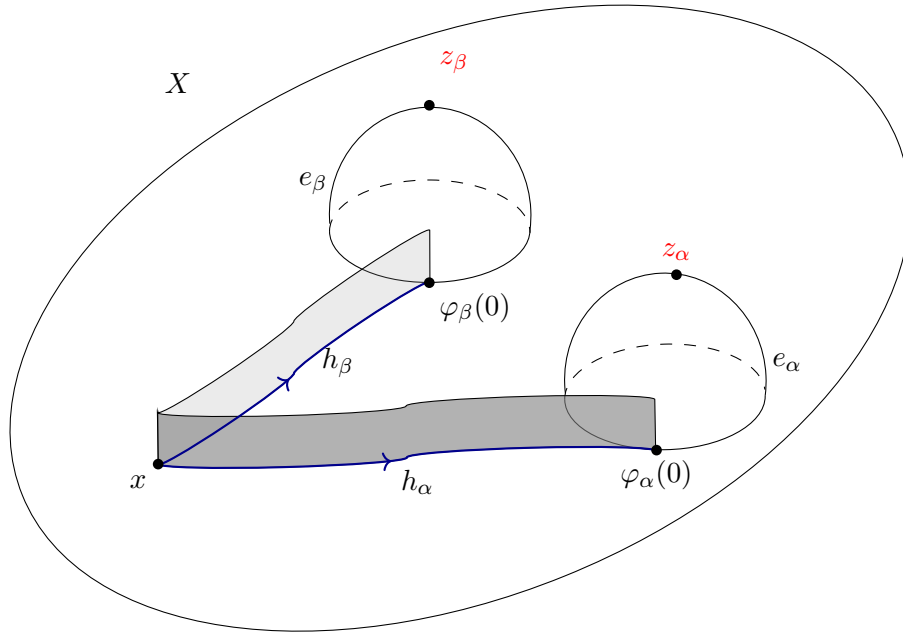
How is the fundamental group affected when one add some 2-cells to a space?

Let X be a path-connected space, and $x \in X$. We attach a collection of 2-cells $(e_\alpha)_{\alpha \in I}$ via maps $\varphi_\alpha : S^1 \rightarrow X$ (each e_α is homeomorphic to the disk D^2), producing a new space Y . If $s \in S^1$ is a basepoint of S^1 , φ_α defines a loop in X based at $\varphi_\alpha(s)$, which becomes nullhomotopic in Y . For each $\alpha \in I$, let h_α be a path from x to $\varphi_\alpha(s)$, such that $\bar{h}_\alpha \cdot \varphi_\alpha \cdot h_\alpha$ is a path on X based at x that is nullhomotopic in Y .

Theorem 8.14. *The inclusion $X \hookrightarrow Y$ induces a surjection $\pi_1(X, x) \twoheadrightarrow \pi_1(Y, x)$ whose kernel is the normal subgroup N generated by the classes of the loops $\bar{h}_\alpha \cdot \varphi_\alpha \cdot h_\alpha$ for $\alpha \in I$, so we have*

$$\pi_1(Y, x) = \pi_1(X, x)/N$$

Proof. To understand this result, it is enough to draw the following picture, assuming we attach only two 2-cells e_α and e_β along maps φ_α and φ_β : $S^1 \rightarrow X$. We add two vertical strips as in the picture, and take two points z_α and z_β in the interior of e_α and e_β . Let Z be the union of Y and the two strips. The space Z deformation retracts to Y , so $\pi_1(Z, x) \simeq \pi_1(Y, x)$. Define $A = Z \setminus \{z_\alpha, z_\beta\}$ and $B = Z \setminus X$. We have $\pi_1(B, x) = \{0\}$ because B is contractible, and $\pi_1(A, x) \simeq \pi_1(X, x)$ since A deformation retracts to X . By a direct application of Van Kampen's theorem, we have $\pi_1(Z, x) \simeq \pi_1(A, x)/N$ where N is the normal subgroup generated by the image of $\pi_1(A \cap B) \rightarrow \pi_1(A)$. We conclude by the fact that $\pi_1(A \cap B)$ is generated by loops homotopic to $\overline{h_\alpha} \cdot \varphi_\alpha \cdot h_\alpha$ and $\overline{h_\beta} \cdot \varphi_\beta \cdot h_\beta$.

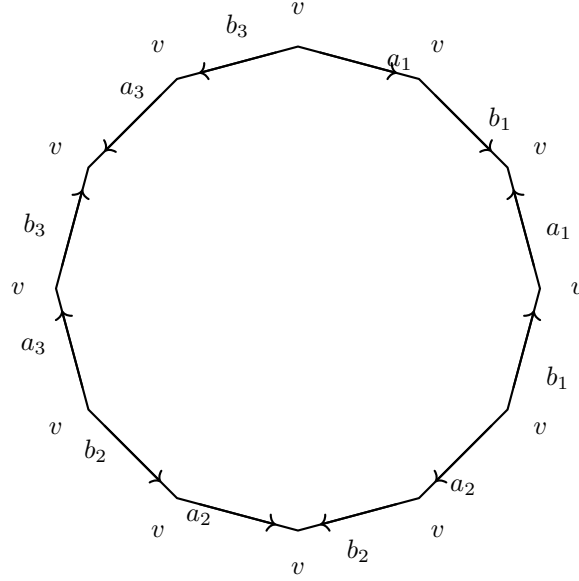


□

Here are a few applications:

Orientable surfaces:

Let Σ_g be the orientable surface of genus g (there is only one homotopy class of such surfaces). It is a CW-complex with one 0-cell v , $2g$ 1-cells denoted a_i, b_i for $1 \leq i \leq g$, and one 2-cell, as shown in the picture below for $g = 3$.



Its 1-skeleton is the wedge sum of $2g$ circles, so using Corollary 8.6, we know that its fundamental group is $\ast_{1 \leq i \leq 2g} \mathbb{Z} = F_{2g} = \langle a_i, b_i \mid 1 \leq i \leq g \rangle$.

The 2-cell is attached along the loop given by the product of commutators $[a_1, b_1] \dots [a_g, b_g]$. From Theorem 8.14, we have:

$$\pi_1(\Sigma_g) \simeq \langle a_1, b_1, \dots, a_g, b_g \mid \prod [a_i, b_i] = 0 \rangle.$$

Corollary 8.15. *The two surfaces Σ_g and Σ_h are not homotopy equivalent when $g \neq h$.*

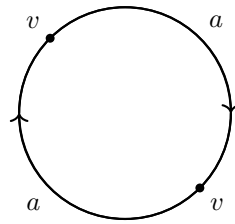
Indeed, the abelianizations $\pi_1(\Sigma_g)^{\text{ab}}$ and $\pi_1(\Sigma_h)^{\text{ab}}$ do not have the same number of generators, so the groups $\pi_1(\Sigma_g)$ and $\pi_1(\Sigma_h)$ are not isomorphic.

Projective plane:

The projective plane $\mathbb{R}P^2$ can be obtained from the disk D^2 by identifying the antipodal points x with $-x$. Therefore, as a CW -complex, it has one 0-cell v , one 1-cell a and one 2-cell which is attached via the loop given by a^2 (see picture below). As a consequence, we have

$$\pi_1(\mathbb{R}P^2) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}.$$

We will see soon that we have more generally $\pi_1(\mathbb{R}P^n) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ for any integer $n \geq 2$.



$\mathbb{R}P^2$

Every group is the fundamental group of a 2-dimensional CW-complex:

Proposition 8.16. *For every group G , there exists a 2-dimensional CW -complex X_G with $\pi_1(X_G) \simeq G$.*

Proof. The group G is always a quotient of a free group (generated by some elements g_α) by some relations r_β , so that G has the presentation $G = \langle g_\alpha \mid r_\beta \rangle$. We can construct X_G from the “1-skeleton” $\bigvee_\alpha S^1$, then attaching 2-cells e_β^2 via the loops specified by the relations r_β . $\square$

EXERCISES

Exercise 8.17 (Complement of a finite set of points in $\mathbb{R}^n$).

Show that the complement of a finite set of points in $\mathbb{R}^n$ is simply-connected if $n \geq 3$.

Exercise 8.18 (Complement of a finite bouquet of lines).

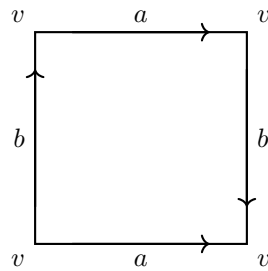
Let $X \subset \mathbb{R}^3$ be the union of n lines passing through the origin. Compute $\pi_1(\mathbb{R}^3 \setminus X)$.

Exercise 8.19 (Sphere after identifying south and north poles).

Let X be the quotient space of S^2 obtained by identifying the north and south poles to a single point. Put a cell structure on X and compute $\pi_1(X)$.

Exercise 8.20 (Klein bottle, fundamental group and first homology).

Let K be the Klein bottle defined by the following (where the square is filled by a 2-cell):



Describe the fundamental group $\pi_1(K)$ of the Klein bottle K . Is it abelian? From this (and not from any other method), deduce the first homology group $H_1(K)$.

Exercise 8.21 (Example of an uncountable fundamental group).

Show that the topological space $\mathbb{R}^2 \setminus \mathbb{Q}^2$ is path-connected, and show that its fundamental group $\pi_1(\mathbb{R}^2 \setminus \mathbb{Q}^2)$ is uncountable.

Exercise 8.22 (Hawaiian spheres).

Let $\mathcal{S} \subset \mathbb{R}^3$ defined as the union of the spheres of radius $1/n$ centered at the points $(1/n, 0, 0)$ for $n \geq 1$. Determine $\pi_1(\mathcal{S}, e_0)$, where e_0 is the origin of $\mathbb{R}^3$.

Exercise 8.23 (Configuration space of two points and pure braid group).

Define

$$F_2(\mathbb{C}) = \{(z_1, z_2) \in \mathbb{C}^2 \mid z_1 \neq z_2\}$$

to be the configuration space of two distinct ordered points in the complex plane. Compute its fundamental group $\pi_1(F_2(\mathbb{C}))$.

Exercise 8.24 (Fundamental group of $\mathrm{SO}_3(\mathbb{R})$).

Compute the fundamental group $\pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_3(\mathbb{R}))$ of the group of vectorial rotations of $\mathbb{R}^3$.

(*Hint:* Show that $\mathrm{SO}_3(\mathbb{R})$ is homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}P^3$)

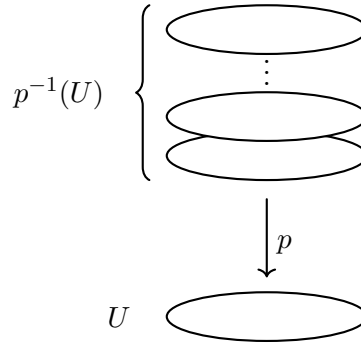
9. COVERING SPACES

We will see in this section the important notion of *covering spaces* of a space X . We will see that algebraic features of the fundamental group can be translated into the more geometric language of covering spaces.

9.1. Definitions and lifting properties.

Definition 9.1. If X is a topological space, a *covering space* (sometimes just called *covering*) of X is another space E with a map $p : E \rightarrow X$ satisfying: *There exists an open cover $\{U_\alpha\}_\alpha$ of X such that for each α , $p^{-1}(U_\alpha)$ is a disjoint union of open sets in E , each of which is mapped by p homeomorphically onto U_α .*

This is equivalent to saying that each point $x \in X$ has an open neighborhood U such that $p^{-1}(U)$ is a disjoint union of open sets in E , each of which is mapped by p homeomorphically onto U . Such opens are called *elementary opens* for the covering space $p : E \rightarrow X$. We also say that U is *evenly covered* by p .



The cardinality of each fiber $F_x := p^{-1}(x)$ is locally constant, so it is constant over X when X is connected. It is called the number of *sheets* of the covering p .

Examples 9.2. Here are a few simple examples of covering spaces:

- $p : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow S^1$ defined by $p(s) = (\cos(2\pi s), \sin(2\pi s)) = e^{2i\pi s}$, that we have already used in (Proposition 7.16) to prove that $\pi_1(S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$,
- $f_n : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ defined by $z \mapsto z^n$: the sphere wrapping n times around itself,
- $p : S^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}P^n$ defined by the identification of antipodal points.

From the point of view of algebraic topology, one of the most distinctive features of covering spaces is their behavior with respect to lifting of maps, as we already had a glimpse in the proof of Proposition 7.16:

Proposition 9.3 (Homotopy lifting property). *Let $p : E \rightarrow X$ be a covering of X , and $f_t : Y \rightarrow X$ (for $t \in I$) a homotopy. If $\tilde{f}_0 : Y \rightarrow E$ is a map lifting f_0 , there exists a unique homotopy $\tilde{f}_t : Y \rightarrow E$ lifting f_t (so that $p \circ \tilde{f}_t = f_t$ for all $t \in I$) and that coincide with $\tilde{f}_0$ at $t = 0$.*

Remark 9.4. Taking $Y = \{\text{point}\}$, we get the **path lifting property**, for each path $f : I \rightarrow X$ and $e_0 \in p^{-1}(f(0))$, there exists a unique path $\tilde{f} : I \rightarrow E$ lifting f and starting at e_0 .

Proof. We give here a quick proof when $Y = I$. The homotopy f_t is given by a map $h : I \times I \rightarrow X$. By continuity of h and compactity of the square $I \times I$, one can find a finite open cover $(U_\alpha)_{\alpha \in I}$ of $I \times I$ such that each open U_α maps via h in some elementary open of the covering space $E \rightarrow X$. We see (by a construction step by step), using the property of elementary opens, that there exists a unique lift $H : I \times I \rightarrow E$ of h such that $H(-, 0) = \tilde{f}_0$. Finally, write $\tilde{f}_t = H(-, t)$.

For a general Y , the idea is the same: using the fact that $\{y\} \times I$ is compact for each $y \in Y$, we can find an open cover $(U_\alpha)_\alpha$ (that might not be finite, but is finite "vertically") such that each open U_α maps in some elementary open of the covering space $E \rightarrow X$. $\square$

Proposition 9.5. *Let $p : E \rightarrow X$ be a covering space, with $e \in E$ above $x \in X$.*

- (i) The morphism $p_* : \pi_1(E, e) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$ is injective.
- (ii) The subgroup $p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$ consists of homotopy classes of loops in X based at x whose lift to E starting at e are loops.
- (iii) If X and E are path-connected, the number of sheets of p equals the index of the subgroup $p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$ in $\pi_1(X, x)$, ie. $[\pi_1(X, x) : p_*(\pi_1(E, e))]$.

Proof. (i) An element of the kernel of p_* is represented by a loop $\tilde{f}$ based at e with a homotopy h_t from $f = p \circ \tilde{f}$ to the constant loop c_x . By the homotopy lifting property, there exists a lifted homotopy of loops in E between $\tilde{f}$ and c_e , hence $[\tilde{f}] = 0$ in $\pi_1(E, e)$ and p_* is injective.

(ii) Let $H \subseteq \pi_1(X, x)$ be the subset of homotopy classes of loops based in X whose lift to E beginning at e is a loop. It is clear that we have $H \subseteq p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$. To see the reverse inclusion, observe that if $[f] \in p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$, f is homotopic to a loop having a lift in E starting at e which is a loop. Then the homotopy lifting property implies that the lift of f to E starting at e is a loop as well.

(iii) For any loop f at X based at x , write $\tilde{f}$ for its unique lift to E starting at e . A product $f \cdot g$ with $g \in p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$ has lift $\tilde{f} \cdot \tilde{g}$ ending at $\tilde{f}(1)$, since $\tilde{g}$ is a loop. Write $H = p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$, this gives a well-defined map

$$\pi_1(X, x)/H \xrightarrow{\Phi} F_x = p^{-1}(x)$$

defined by $[f]H \mapsto \tilde{f}(1)$. If $y \in F_x$, by the path-connectedness of E there exists a path $e \rightarrow y$ in E , projecting to a loop f in X based at x such that $\tilde{f}(1) = y$, so Φ is surjective.

To show that Φ is injective, assume that $\Phi([f_1]H) = \Phi([f_2]H)$. We have $\tilde{f}_1(1) = \tilde{f}_2(1)$, so $\tilde{f}_2 \cdot f_1$ lifts to a loop in E based at e (which is $\tilde{f}_2^{-1} \cdot \tilde{f}_1$). Therefore, from (ii), $[f_2]^{-1}[f_1] \in H$, so $[f_1]H = [f_2]H$. Finally, Φ is a bijection. $\square$

The following property is a powerful and more general lifting property from X to E , when one does not restrict to homotopies:

Proposition 9.6 (Lifting criterion). *Let $p : E \rightarrow X$ be a covering space with $p(e) = x$, and $f : Y \rightarrow X$ sending $y \in Y$ to x , with Y path-connected and locally path-connected. There exists a lift $\tilde{f} : (Y, y) \rightarrow (E, e)$ of f to E if and only if*

$$f_*(\pi_1(Y, y)) \subseteq p_*(\pi_1(E, e)).$$

Proof. If such lift $\tilde{f}$ exists, then from the equality $f = p \circ \tilde{f}$ we get

$$f_*(\pi_1(Y, y)) = p_*(\tilde{f}_*(\pi_1(Y, y))) \subseteq p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$$

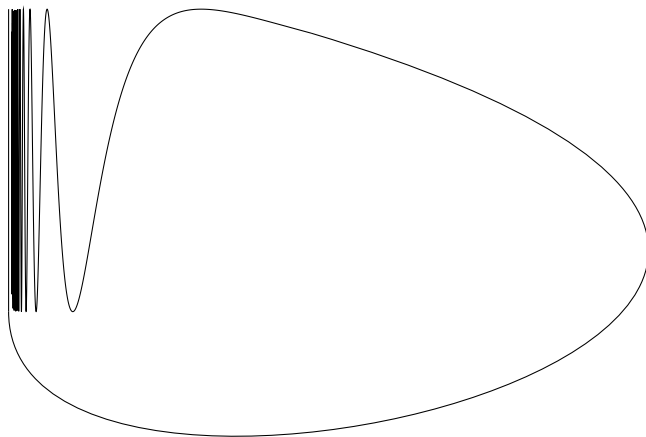
because $\tilde{f}_*(\pi_1(Y, y)) \subseteq \pi_1(E, e)$.

Assume now $f_*(\pi_1(Y, y)) \subseteq p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$. If h is a loop in Y based at y , $f_*([h]) = [f \circ h] \in p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$, so the loop fh in X has a lift in E starting at e which is a loop. Let $y' \in Y$, choose a path $\gamma : y \rightarrow y'$ in Y (Y is path-connected). From the path lifting property, the path $f\gamma$ in X has a unique lift $\tilde{f}\gamma$ in E starting at e . Define $\tilde{f}(y') = \tilde{f}\gamma(1)$. We first need to show that it is well-defined. Let γ' be another path from y to y' in Y . The path $\overline{\gamma'} \cdot \gamma$ is a loop at y , so the loop $h := f \circ (\overline{\gamma'} \cdot \gamma) = \overline{f\gamma'} \cdot f\gamma$ has a unique lift $\tilde{h}$ in E starting at e , and it is loop. By uniqueness of lifted paths, the first part of $\tilde{h}$ is $\tilde{f}\gamma$, and the second part is $\tilde{f}\gamma'$ backward, so $\tilde{f}\gamma(1) = \tilde{f}\gamma'(1)$, and $\tilde{f} : Y \rightarrow E$ is well defined.

We need now to show that $\tilde{f}$ is continuous. Let $z \in Y$, and $U \subseteq X$ an elementary neighborhood (for the covering p) of $f(z)$: there exists an open neighborhood $\tilde{U}$ of $\tilde{f}(z)$ such that $p : \tilde{U} \rightarrow U$ is a homeomorphism. As Y is locally path-connected, we can choose a path-connected neighborhood $V \subseteq Y$ of z in Y with $f(V) \subseteq U$. Let $z' \in V$. Take a path $\gamma : y \rightarrow z$ in Y and a path $\eta : z \rightarrow z'$ in V . Then $\eta\gamma$ is a path from y to z' in Y , with $\tilde{f}(z') = f \circ \eta\gamma(1)$ (by definition of $\tilde{f}$). But we also have $f \circ \eta\gamma = \tilde{f}\eta \cdot \tilde{f}\gamma$, where $\tilde{f}\eta = p_0^{-1}f\eta$ with $p_0^{-1} : U \rightarrow \tilde{U}$ homeomorphism. So we have $\tilde{f}(z') = p_0^{-1}f(z')$. In particular, $\tilde{V} \subseteq \tilde{U}$ and $\tilde{f}|_{\tilde{V}} = p_0^{-1}f$, so f is continuous. $\square$

Pay attention to the fact local path-connectedness of Y is necessary for the lift to be continuous. For a counter-example that shows the necessity of local path-connectedness, see the following exercise:

Exercise 9.7 (Warsaw circle). The Warsaw circle $\mathcal{C}$, drawn below, is defined as a closed subspace of $\mathbb{R}^2$, as a portion of the graph of $y = \sin(1/x)$ on some interval of the type $(0, \alpha)$ for some $\alpha > 0$, the vertical interval $[-1, 1]$ attached to the graph at $x = 0$, and an arc connecting these two pieces.



Show that $\mathcal{C}$ is not locally path-connected and that it is simply-connected: $\pi_1(\mathcal{C}) = \{0\}$. Show that there is a continuous quotient map $f : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow S^1$, but f does not lift to the covering space $\mathbb{R} \rightarrow S^1$.

We finish this subsection by a useful property of uniqueness of lifts when the value at any single point is prescribed.

Proposition 9.8. *Let $p : E \rightarrow X$ be a covering space, and $f : Y \rightarrow X$ a continuous map with two lifts $\tilde{f}_1$ and $\tilde{f}_2$ to E that agree at one point $y_0 \in Y$. If Y is connected, then $\tilde{f}_1 = \tilde{f}_2$.*

Proof. We want to show that the subset $Z \subseteq Y$ defined by $Z = \{y \in Y, \tilde{f}_1(y) = \tilde{f}_2(y)\}$ is open and closed. Let $y \in Y$, and $U \subseteq X$ an open neighborhood of $f(y)$ such that $p^{-1}(U)$ is the disjoint union of some opens $(U_\alpha)_\alpha$ of E all homeomorphic via p to U . For $i \in \{1, 2\}$, let U_{α_i} such that $\tilde{f}_i(y) \in U_{\alpha_i}$. By continuity, there exists some open neighborhood V of y in Y such that $\tilde{f}_i(V) \subseteq U_{\alpha_i}$.

Closed: If $y \notin Z$, then $U_{\alpha_1} \neq U_{\alpha_2}$ are disjoint, so the open V does not intersect Z .

Open: If $y \in Z$, then $U_{\alpha_1} = U_{\alpha_2}$. We have $p\tilde{f}_1 = p\tilde{f}_2 (= f)$ and p is injective on $U_{\alpha_1} = U_{\alpha_2}$, so $\overline{V} \subseteq Z$. $\square$

9.2. Universal covering. We will show that under some mild topological conditions, any space has a unique “universal” covering space which is simply connected. This fact will be useful later when we speak about the classification of covering spaces in terms of the fundamental group.

We begin by a few definitions:

Definition 9.9. A space X is *semi-locally simply-connected* (we will abbreviate by SLSC) if each point has a neighborhood U such that the induced map $\pi_1(U, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$ is trivial.

The CW -complexes are examples of SLSC spaces, since they are locally contractible.

Remark 9.10. This notion is different from *locally simply-connected* (abbreviated by LSC), which means that every point has a neighborhood which is simply-connected. In other words, LSC means that any loop in any small neighborhood U can be deformed to the constant loop while *staying inside* U , whereas for SLSC the deformation to the constant loop exists for sure in X , but might not be possible staying in U . We always have $\text{LSC} \implies \text{SLSC}$ but the converse is not true.

Exercise 9.11. The Hawaiian earrings (see Exercise 8.10) $X \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$ is not SLSC. Its cone, $CX = X \times I / X \times \{0\}$, is SLSC, but it is not LSC.

Definition 9.12. An isomorphism between covering spaces $p_1 : E_1 \rightarrow X$ and $p_2 : E_2 \rightarrow X$ is a homeomorphism $f : E_1 \rightarrow E_2$ above X , meaning that $p_1 = p_2 \circ f$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E_1 & \xrightarrow{f} & E_2 \\ & \searrow p_1 & \swarrow p_2 \\ & X & \end{array}$$

This defines an equivalence relation on covering spaces.

As shown by the next proposition, isomorphism of coverings can be detected by the fundamental group:

Proposition 9.13. *If X is path-connected and locally path-connected, two connected covering $p_1 : E_1 \rightarrow X$ and $p_2 : E_2 \rightarrow X$ are isomorphic via an isomorphism $f : E_1 \rightarrow E_2$ sending $e_1 \in E_1$ to $e_2 \in E_2$ if and only if*

$$p_{1*}(\pi_1(E_1, e_1)) = p_{2*}(\pi_1(E_2, e_2)).$$

Proof. If such isomorphism f exists, we get $p_{1*}(\pi_1(E_1, e_1)) \subseteq p_{2*}(\pi_1(E_2, e_2))$ from the relation $p_1 = p_2 \circ f$, and we get the other inclusion from the relation $p_2 = p_1 \circ f^{-1}$, hence the equality.

Assume that $p_{1*}(\pi_1(E_1, e_1)) = p_{2*}(\pi_1(E_2, e_2))$. By the lifting criterion Proposition 9.6, we can lift p_1 to $\tilde{p}_1 : (E_1, e_1) \rightarrow (E_2, e_2)$ such that $p_1 = p_2 \tilde{p}_1$. Symmetrically, we have $\tilde{p}_2 : (E_2, e_2) \rightarrow (E_1, e_1)$ satisfying $p_2 = p_1 \tilde{p}_2$. Note now that id_{E_1} and $\tilde{p}_2 \tilde{p}_1$ are two lifts of $E_1 \rightarrow X$ to $E_1 \rightarrow X$ fixing e_1 , so by (Proposition 9.8) we have $\tilde{p}_2 \tilde{p}_1 = \text{id}_{E_1}$. Symmetrically, we have $\tilde{p}_1 \tilde{p}_2 = \text{id}_{E_2}$, showing that $\tilde{p}_1$ and $\tilde{p}_2$ are inverse isomorphisms. $\square$

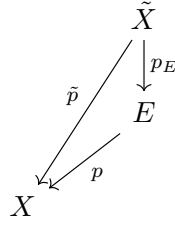
Here is the important result about the existence and unicity (up to isomorphisms) of a simply-connected covering space of X , as soon as X satisfies some mild topological properties.

Theorem 9.14. *If X is path-connected, locally path-connected and SLSC, it admits a simply-connected covering space $p : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$, unique up to isomorphisms of covering spaces. We call it the universal covering of X .*

Note that we already know some examples of universal coverings:

- $p : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow S^1$ defined by $p(s) = (\cos(2\pi s), \sin(2\pi s)) = e^{2i\pi s}$ is the universal covering of S^1 since $\pi_1(\mathbb{R}) = \{0\}$,
- $p : S^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}P^n$ defined by the identification of antipodal points when $n \geq 2$, because we have seen in Example 8.8 that $\pi_1(S^n) = \{0\}$ when $n \geq 2$.

Remark 9.15. If X is path-connected and locally path-connected and if $\tilde{p} : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ is a simply-connected covering space, a consequence of the lifting criterion Proposition 9.6 is that $\tilde{X}$ is a covering space of any other path-connected covering space $p : E \rightarrow X$ of X : there exists a unique covering $p_E : \tilde{X} \rightarrow E$ such that $\tilde{p} = p \circ p_E$.



The adjective “universal” to qualify such simply-connected covering comes from this universal property of domination of any path-connected covering space of X .

Here is a little heuristic before proving the existence of the universal covering. Imagine that a simply connected covering $p : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ exists. Take $x \in X$ and $\tilde{x} \in F_x$. As $\tilde{X}$ is simply connected, for each $y \in \tilde{X}$ there exists a unique homotopy class of paths joining $\tilde{x}$ to y by (Proposition 7.9). Thus, we can see points of $\tilde{X}$ as homotopy classes of paths in $\tilde{X}$ starting at $\tilde{x}$. But by the homotopy lifting property, this is the same as homotopy classes of paths in X starting at x .

Construction of a simply-connected covering. Note that in Theorem 9.14 the uniqueness up to isomorphisms of simply connected coverings is a direct consequence of (Proposition 9.13), since the image of any simply connected covering space of X is trivial in $\pi_1(X, x)$. So this is the existence that we need to prove.

Choose a point $x \in X$. From the heuristic above, let's define:

$$\tilde{X} = \{[\gamma] \mid \gamma \text{ path in } X \text{ starting at } x\},$$

where homotopy class is understood as always fixing the endpoints $\gamma(0)$ and $\gamma(1)$.

Define $p : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ by $[\gamma] \mapsto \gamma(1)$. The path-connectedness of X implies that p is surjective.

Define $\mathcal{U}$ as the collection of path-connected open subsets $U \subseteq X$ such that the induced morphism $\pi_1(U) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ is trivial. If $U \in \mathcal{U}$ and $V \subseteq U$ is open and path-connected, it is easy to see that $V \in \mathcal{U}$. We claim that $\mathcal{U}$ is a basis of opens for the topology of X . This is not difficult to see, from the fact that X is locally path-connected and SLSC.

If $U \in \mathcal{U}$ and γ is a path in X from x to a point in U , define:

$$U_{[\gamma]} := \{[\eta \cdot \gamma] \mid \eta \text{ path in } U \text{ with } \eta(0) = \gamma(1)\} \subseteq \tilde{X}$$

We now list several facts, with proofs when necessary, that lead to the fact that $p : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ is a covering space of X . Let $U \in \mathcal{U}$.

- (1) $U_{[\gamma]}$ depends only on $[\gamma]$ (easy by definition of $\tilde{X}$).
- (2) $p : U_{[\gamma]} \rightarrow U$ is surjective because U is path-connected.
- (3) $p : U_{[\gamma]} \rightarrow U$ is injective: if $\eta, \eta' : \gamma(1) \rightarrow y$ are paths in U , then $[\bar{\eta} \cdot \eta'] \in \text{im}(\pi_1(U) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)) = \{0\}$, so η and η' are homotopic in X .
- (4) $U_{[\gamma]} = U_{[\gamma']}$ if $[\gamma'] \in U_{[\gamma]}$: easy to check because U is path-connected.
- (5) The subsets of the forms $U_{[\gamma]}$ with $U \in \mathcal{U}$ form a basis for a topology on $\tilde{X}$. We need for that to verify two things:
 - (i) $\tilde{X} = \bigcup_{u \in \mathcal{U}, \gamma} U_{[\gamma]}$: this is satisfied because if $[\gamma] \in \tilde{X}$, if you take any neighborhood $U \in \mathcal{U}$ of $\gamma(1)$, then $[\gamma] \in U_{[\gamma]}$.
 - (ii) Consider two subsets $U_{[\gamma]}$ and $V_{[\gamma']}$ with $U, V \in \mathcal{U}$, and take $[\gamma''] \in U_{[\gamma]} \cap V_{[\gamma']}$. From (4), we have $U_{[\gamma]} = U_{[\gamma']}$ and $V_{[\gamma]} = V_{[\gamma']}$. Take some $W \in \mathcal{U}$ with $W \subseteq U \cap V$ and $\gamma''(1) \in W$ (it is possible because $\mathcal{U}$ is a basis of opens for the topology in X). Then we have $[\gamma''] \in W_{[\gamma']}$.
- (6) The bijection $p : U_{[\gamma]} \rightarrow U$ is a homeomorphism:
 - (i) if $V_{[\gamma']} \subseteq U_{[\gamma]}$ with $V \in \mathcal{U}$, then $p(V_{[\gamma']}) = V \in \mathcal{U}$,
 - (ii) if $V \in \mathcal{U}$ with $V \subseteq U$, then $p^{-1}(V) \cap U_{[\gamma]} = V_{[\gamma']}$ for any $[\gamma'] \in U_{[\gamma]}$ with endpoint in V , since $V_{[\gamma']} \subseteq U_{[\gamma']} = U_{[\gamma]}$ and $V_{[\gamma']} \rightarrow V$ is surjective.

- (7) The map $p : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ is continuous (because of (6)) and is a covering space: indeed, if $U \in \mathcal{U}$,

$$p^{-1}(U) = \bigsqcup U_{[\gamma]},$$

the union being disjoint because if $[\gamma''] \in U_{[\gamma]} \cap U_{[\gamma']}$, then $U_{[\gamma'']} = U_{[\gamma']} = U_{[\gamma]}$.

We need now to show that $\tilde{X}$ is simply-connected. Consider as a basepoint $[x] = [c_x]$. The space $\tilde{X}$ is path-connected because any $[\gamma] \in \tilde{X}$ can be joined to $[x]$ by restricting γ to the interval $[0, t]$.

Let $\beta : I \rightarrow \tilde{X}$ be a loop in $\tilde{X}$ based at $[x]$. Then $\gamma := p \circ \beta$ is a loop in X based at x , so β is the unique lift of γ starting at $[x]$. Let γ_t be the path in X obtained by restriction of γ to the interval $[0, t]$. Then $([\gamma_t])_{t \in I}$ forms a lift of γ in $\tilde{X}$ starting at $[x]$, so by uniqueness of lift we it equals β . In particular, for each $t \in I$, we have $[\gamma_t] = \beta_t$. Taking $t = 1$, we get $[\gamma_1] = [\gamma] = \beta(1) = [x]$. In other words, $[\gamma] = p_*[\beta] = 0 \in \pi_1(X, x)$. Recall (Proposition 9.5) that $p_* : \pi_1(\tilde{X}, [x]) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$ is injective, so $[\beta] = 0$ and $\pi_1(\tilde{X}, [x]) = \{0\}$: $\tilde{X}$ is simply-connected. $\square$

9.3. Classification of covering spaces and deck transformations.

We are going to see that when X is path connected, locally path-connected and SLSC, we have a correspondence between the subgroups of $\pi_1(X)$ and the isomorphism classes of path-connected covering spaces of X . It is very reminiscent of what is happening in Galois theory, for this reason it is often called the *Galois correspondence* of covering spaces.

Before stating and proving the Galois correspondence, we need one lemma:

Lemma 9.16. *Assume X is path-connected, locally path-connected, and SLSC. Take $x \in X$, then for any subgroup $H \subseteq \pi_1(X, x)$, there exists a covering space $p : (X_H, y) \rightarrow (X, x)$ such that $p_*(\pi_1(X_H, y)) = H$.*

Note that for a fixed subgroup H of $\pi_1(X, x)$, the covering spaces of X satisfying the property of the above lemma are all isomorphic by (Proposition 9.13).

Proof. Let's define an equivalence relation $\sim_H$ on $\tilde{X}$ defined by $[\gamma] \sim_H [\gamma']$ if and only if $\gamma(1) = \gamma'(1)$ and $[\gamma'] \cdot \gamma \in H$. Define $X_H = \tilde{X} / \sim_H$ as a topological space with the quotient topology. Let $U \in \mathcal{U}$ (we use the same notation $\mathcal{U}$ as in the construction of universal coverings) containing $\gamma(1)$, and η be a path in U from $\gamma(1)$ to a point in U . We have $[\gamma] \sim_H [\gamma']$ if and only if $[\eta \cdot \gamma] \simeq_H [\eta \cdot \gamma']$. In other words, $U_{[\gamma]}$ and $U_{[\gamma']}$ are identified in X_H as soon as $U_{[\gamma]}$ contains a point identified to a point in $U_{[\gamma']}$. It is then easy to check that the map $X_H \rightarrow X$ defined by $[\gamma] \mapsto \gamma(1)$ is a covering space. Write y for the class of $[c_x]$ in X_H . Let γ be a loop in X based at x . We know (see the proof that the universal covering we constructed is simply-connected) that the unique lift of γ in $\tilde{X}$ starting at $[c_x]$ ends at $[\gamma]$, so it defines a loop in X_H if and only if $[\gamma] \sim_H [c_x]$, which is equivalent to $[\gamma] \in H$. By (Proposition 9.5), we conclude that $p_*(\pi_1(X_H, y)) = H$. $\square$

We are now ready for the ‘‘Galois correspondence’’ between covering spaces and subgroups and the fundamental group:

Theorem 9.17. *Let X be a path-connected, locally path-connected and SLSC space, and $x \in X$. The map that associates to a covering space $p : (E, e) \rightarrow (X, x)$ the subgroup $p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$ of $\pi_1(X, x)$ defines a bijection:*

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{basepoint preserving isomorphism classes} \\ \text{of path-connected coverings of } (X, x) \end{array} \right\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \{ \text{subgroups of } \pi_1(X, x) \}$$

If basepoints are ignored, then it gives a bijection:

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{isomorphism classes of path-connected} \\ \text{coverings of } X \end{array} \right\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{conjugacy classes of} \\ \text{subgroups of } \pi_1(X, x) \end{array} \right\}$$

Proof. The reverse map is defined by associating X_H (see Lemma 9.16) to a subgroup H . Let H be a subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$, and $p : (E, e) \rightarrow (X, x)$ a path-connected covering space. We need to check two points:

- $X_{p_*(\pi_1(E, e))}$ is isomorphic to E as a covering space of X : this is true because of Proposition 9.13 since they correspond to the same subgroups of $\pi_1(X, x)$.
- if $p_H : (X_H, y) \rightarrow (X, x)$ is the covering corresponding to H constructed in Lemma 9.16, we have $p_{H*}(\pi_1(X_H, y)) = H$: this is from Lemma 9.16.

For the version without basepoints, check the following:

Exercise 9.18. For a path-connected covering $p : (E, e) \rightarrow (X, x)$, show that changing the basepoint e to e' inside $p^{-1}(x)$ corresponds exactly to changing $p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$ by one of its conjugates inside $\pi_1(X, x)$.

□

Recall that in Galois theory, the Galois group corresponding to a field extension is defined as the automorphism group of the big field fixing the smaller field. In our context of covering spaces, the groups are constructed as homotopy classes of loops. Can we have a description of the groups in terms of automorphisms of coverings, to be closer in spirit to the Galois theory of fields?

Definition 9.19. For a covering $p : E \rightarrow X$, define $\text{Aut}(E/X)$ to be the group of automorphisms $E \rightarrow E$ of covering spaces over X . Such an isomorphism is called a *deck transformation* of the covering E of X .

By the uniqueness of lifting given by (Proposition 9.8), a deck transformation is completely determined by where it sends a single point.

Examples 9.20.

- if $p : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow S^1$ is the covering given by $p(s) = e^{2i\pi s}$, then $\text{Aut}(\mathbb{R}/S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ (translation given by integers)
- if $f_n : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ is given by $z \mapsto z^n$ (n -sheeted covering), then $\text{Aut}(S^1/S^1) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ (generated by the rotation of angle $2\pi/n$).

Definition 9.21. A covering $p : E \rightarrow X$ is *normal*, or *regular*, if for each $x \in X$ and elements e, e' in the fiber F_x , there exists a deck transformation $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(E/X)$ sending e to e' .

The two coverings given in the 9.20 are normal.

Normal coverings are the coverings with the maximal symmetry. There are the analogous, in our context, to normal extensions of fields. The following important result confirms this analogy:

Proposition 9.22. Let X be path-connected, locally path-connected, and $p : E \rightarrow X$ a path-connected covering sending a point $e \in E$ to $x \in X$. Let $H = p_*(\pi_1(E, e))$:

- (i) $p : E \rightarrow X$ is normal if and only if H is a normal subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$,
- (ii) $\text{Aut}(E/X) \simeq N(H)/H$, where $N(H)$ is the normalizer of H in $\pi_1(X, x)$.

In particular, if p is normal, we have

$$\text{Aut}(E/X) \simeq \pi_1(X, x)/H.$$

If X is SLSC and $\tilde{X}$ is its universal covering, then

$$\text{Aut}(\tilde{X}/X) \simeq \pi_1(X, x).$$

Proof. (i) We know (by Exercise 9.18) that changing the basepoint from e to e' in F_x corresponds to conjugating H by $[\gamma]$ where γ lifts to a path $e \rightarrow e'$ in E . So we have

$$\begin{aligned} [\gamma] \in N(H) &\iff p_*(\pi_1(E, e)) = p_*(\pi_1(E, e')) \\ &\iff \exists \sigma \in \text{Aut}(E/X), \sigma(e) = e' \text{ (by the lifting criterion Proposition 9.6)} \end{aligned}$$

This implies that $E \rightarrow X$ is normal if and only if H is a normal subgroup of $\pi_1(X, x)$.

(ii) Define a morphism $\varphi : N(H) \rightarrow \text{Aut}(E/X)$ by $[\gamma] \mapsto \tau^{-1}$, where τ is the unique deck transformation satisfying $\tau(e) = \tilde{\gamma}(1)$, where $\tilde{\gamma}$ is the unique lift of γ in E starting at e . We need the power -1 to make it a morphism. Indeed, if $[\gamma'] \in N(H)$ with corresponding τ' , the loop $\gamma' \cdot \gamma$ lifts to $\tau(\tilde{\gamma}') \cdot \tilde{\gamma}$ which is a path from e to $\tau(\tilde{\gamma}'(1)) = \tau\tau'(e)$. It is surjective by the proof of (i), and its kernel consists of classes of loops lifting to loops in E , so $\ker(\varphi) = H$. $\square$

Supplement material 9.23. Compare to Proposition 8.16, we have a stronger result: For every group G , there exists a CW-complex $K(G, 1)$ such that $\pi_1(K(G, 1)) \cong G$ and its universal covering exists and is contractible. Such a space $K(G, 1)$ is unique as a homotopy type [Hat02, Theorem 1B.8], and is called an Eilenberg-MacLane space. However, the price for having a contractible universal covering space is that $K(G, 1)$ normally has infinite many cells compare to X_G in Proposition 8.16. Some reason can be seen from the construction of X_G : we construct X_G by gluing some 2-cells, but they may be some cells that contribute non-trivially to the homotopy type of the universal covering space. Therefore, to cancel those abnormal, we should glue more higher dimensional cells. For example, using Remark 9.27, we can show that $K(\mathbb{Z}/m, 1) \simeq S^\infty/(\mathbb{Z}/m)$, where $\mathbb{Z}/m$ acts on S^∞ by multiplication by the m -th root of unit.

9.4. Group actions inducing a covering.

To continue the analogy with Galois theory, recall the Artin's lemma: if G is a group of automorphisms of a field K and K^G denotes the subfield of fixed elements, the extension K/K^G is Galois with Galois group $\text{Gal}(K/K^G) = G$. So having a group of automorphisms induces a Galois extension with Galois group this group of automorphisms. The goal here is to show some analogous result in our context of covering spaces with an action of a group by homeomorphisms, where the analogous of a Galois extension is a normal covering space.

Definition 9.24. If Y is a topological space and G a group, an action (on the left) of G on Y by homeomorphisms is the same as a morphism $G \rightarrow \text{Homeo}(Y)$, where $\text{Homeo}(Y)$ denotes the group of homeomorphisms from Y to itself.

Such an action is said to be *even* (terminology due to Fulton, some authors might use another terminology) if for each $y \in Y$, there exists an open neighborhood U of y such that the images $g(U)$ for $g \in G$ are all disjoint: $g_1(U) \cap g_2(U) \neq \emptyset \implies g_1 = g_2$.

If G is acting on Y , let $Y^G = G \backslash Y$ be the quotient space, or orbit space: its underlying set is the set of orbits, and the topology is defined as making the projection $Y \rightarrow G \backslash Y$ continuous. The notation Y^G is not very standard, I choose it here for the analogy with Galois theory. Be careful that this notation does not mean the fixed-points of the action (if a non-trivial group G acts evenly on Y , there are no fixed points).

Exercise 9.25. If $p : E \rightarrow X$ is a covering space, show that the natural action of $\text{Aut}(E/X)$ on E is even. What is $E^{\text{Aut}(E/X)}$ when the covering is normal?

Proposition 9.26 (Topological Artin's lemma). *Let G be a group acting evenly on a space Y :*

- (i) *The quotient map $p : Y \rightarrow Y^G$ defined by $y \mapsto Gy$ is a normal covering space.*
- (ii) *If Y is path-connected, $G = \text{Aut}(Y/Y^G)$.*
- (iii) *If Y is path-connected and locally path-connected: $G \simeq \pi_1(Y^G, y_G)/p_\star(\pi_1(Y, y))$ (with choice of compatible basepoints).*

Proof. (i) The fact that the action is even implies (check it, actually it is the minimal requirement to make it work) that $Y \rightarrow Y^G$ is a covering space. We have $G \subseteq \text{Aut}(Y/Y^G)$ and p is normal since it acts transitively on the fibers (which are the orbits) of any point in Y^G .

(ii) Assume Y to be path-connected, and take $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(Y/Y^G)$. If $y \in Y$, $\sigma(y)$ and y are in the same orbit, so there exists $g \in G$ such that $g \cdot y = \sigma(y)$. But deck transformations of a path-connected covering space are uniquely determined by the image of a single point, so $g = \sigma \in \text{Aut}(Y/Y^G)$, so finally $G = \text{Aut}(Y/Y^G)$.

(iii) is a direct consequence of (ii) and Proposition 9.22. $\square$

Remark 9.27. If a group G acts evenly on a space Y which is path-connected, locally path-connected and simply connected, then by the above proposition we have $G \simeq \pi_1(Y^G)$.

Example 9.28. Recall that the sphere S^n is simply-connected when $n \geq 2$. The group $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ acts evenly on S^n by $z \mapsto -z$, and the quotient is the projective space $(S^n)^{\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}} = \mathbb{R}P^n$. Therefore, when $n \geq 2$, we have

$$\pi_1(\mathbb{R}P^n) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}.$$

Exercise 9.29. Recall that Σ_g stands for the compact orientable surface of genus g .

- (i) By an appropriate action on the surface, use (Proposition 9.26) to show that $\pi_1(\Sigma_3)$ contains $\pi_1(\Sigma_{11})$ as a normal subgroup of index 5, with $\pi_1(\Sigma_3)/\pi_1(\Sigma_{11}) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z}$.
- (ii) For any positive integer n, m , construct a covering space $\Sigma_{mn+1} \rightarrow \Sigma_{m+1}$, identifying giving $\pi_1(\Sigma_{mn+1})$ as normal subgroup of $\pi_1(\Sigma_{m+1})$ of index n .
- (iii) Show that if $\Sigma_g \rightarrow \Sigma_h$ is a covering space, there exists some positive integers m and n such that $h = m + 1$ and $n = mn + 1$. (*Hint:* think about the Euler characteristic).

Supplement material 9.30 (Finite free actions on the sphere). When a the group G is finite, for an action of G on a Hausdorff space Y , being free is the same as being even. Apart from $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ (giving the covering $S^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}P^n$), one can wonder is there are other finite groups acting freely on S^n .

- One can show (try it!) using relative singular homology, that $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ is the only such group when n is even.
- When n is odd, it is easy to construct a free action of any cyclic group $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ on S^n , and quotient spaces are called *Lens spaces*.
- In the general case, the answer is much more difficult, and was solved by Milnor (1957), Madsen/Thomas/Wall (1976) and Davis/Milgram (1985):

Theorem 9.31. *The finite groups G acting freely on S^n for some $n \geq 1$ are those satisfying:*

- (i) *Every abelian subgroup of G is cyclic.*
- (ii) *G contains at most one element of order 2.*

These groups were completely classified by Brown in 1982.

9.5. Monodromy action and equivalence of categories.

Let $p : E \rightarrow X$ be a covering space, denote F_x the fiber over any point $x \in X$.

Definition 9.32. We have a left action of $\pi_1(X, x)$ on F_x by defining the action of $[\gamma]$ on e by $[\gamma] \cdot e = \tilde{\gamma}(1)$ where $\tilde{\gamma}$ is the unique lift of γ in E starting at e . It is a left action (with our convention for multiplication of paths): $([\gamma] \cdot [\eta]) \cdot e = [\gamma] \cdot ([\eta] \cdot e)$. This is called the *monodromy action* on the fiber F_x . This gives a functor Fib_x called the *fiber functor*:

$$\{\text{covering spaces of } X\} \rightarrow \{\pi_1(X, x)\text{-sets}\},$$

associating to $p : E \rightarrow X$ the fiber F_x endowed with the (left) monodromy action. Here, $\{\pi_1(X, x)\text{-sets}\}$ stands for the category of sets endowed with a left action of $\pi_1(X, x)$, with morphisms compatible with the group actions.

The following important result tells that under some mild conditions (the same required for the existence of the universal covering), this defines an equivalence of categories.

Theorem 9.33. *If X is path-connected, locally path-connected, SLSC, and $x \in X$, the fiber functor Fib_x induces an equivalence of categories between covering spaces of X and $\pi_1(X, x)$ -sets. It restricts to some equivalence of categories:*

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{connected covering} \\ \text{spaces of } X \end{array} \right\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \{\text{transitive } \pi_1(X, x)\text{-sets}\}$$

Under this equivalence, normal connected coverings correspond to coset spaces of normal subgroups.

Remark 9.34. If $p : E \rightarrow X$, is a path-connected covering of X corresponding to the subgroup H of $\pi_1(X, x)$ via the Galois correspondence (9.17), then the corresponding $\pi_1(X, x)$ -set given by theorem 9.33 above is the coset $\pi_1(X, x)/H$ with left multiplication of $\pi_1(X, x)$.

In particular, the universal cover $p : \tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ corresponds to the set $\pi_1(X, x)$ with the action on itself by left translation.

Careful: With our convention for multiplication of paths, $\pi_1(X, x)$ acts on the left on the fibers of covering spaces. However, the natural action of $\text{Aut}(\tilde{X}/X)$ of $\tilde{X}$ is a *right* action. Indeed, this comes from what is explained in the proof of 9.22 (ii), that is why we had to take the artificial power “ -1 ” to construct a morphism $N(H) \rightarrow \text{Aut}(E/X)$. In fact, it would be more natural to express the isomorphism $\pi_1(X, x) \simeq \text{Aut}(\tilde{X}/X)$ (coming from 9.22) as: $\pi_1(X, x) \simeq \text{Aut}(\tilde{X}/X)^{\text{op}}$.

Construction of a quasi-inverse. We give here the construction of a quasi-inverse: given a left action ρ of $\pi_1(X, x)$ on a set S , we want to construct a covering space E_S with $F_x \simeq S$, where the monodromy action on F_x corresponds exactly to ρ .

Let $\tilde{X}$ be the universal covering space of X as we constructed in 9.14: its points are homotopy classes of paths in X from x . Define $\tilde{X}_S = \tilde{X} \times S$, with the product topology where the topology on S is the discrete one. We define an equivalence relation $\sim$ on $\tilde{X}_S$ by

$$(yg, s) \sim (y, gs)$$

for all $y \in \tilde{X}$, $s \in S$ and $g \in \pi_1(X, x)$, where we write gs for $\rho(g)(s)$, and yg is the result of the right action of $g \in \pi_1(X, x) \simeq \text{Aut}(\tilde{X}/X)^{\text{op}}$ on $\tilde{X}$. Define $E_S = \tilde{X}_S / \sim$ as the quotient, with the quotient topology.

Projection map and fiber: Define $p_S : E_S \rightarrow X$ by $p_S(y, s) = p(y)$. Let $F_{S,x} = p_S^{-1}(x)$ be the fiber over x . Fix $\tilde{x} \in p^{-1}(x)$, we have:

$$F_{S,x} = \{(\tilde{x}, s), s \in S\} \simeq S$$

Indeed, if $(y, s) \in F_{S,x}$, then there exists $g \in \pi_1(X, x)$ with $y = \tilde{x}g$, so $(y, s) = (\tilde{x}, gx)$. We can easily check that p_S is continuous, and that E_S is a covering space of X .

Monodromy action: Let $(\tilde{x}, s) \in F_{S,x}$ and $g = [\gamma] \in \pi_1(X, x)$. Let $\tilde{\gamma}$ be the lift of γ in $\tilde{X}$ starting at $\tilde{x}$. If $\tilde{x}$ is the homotopy class of a loop η based at x , then $\tilde{\gamma}(1) = [\gamma \cdot \eta] \in \tilde{X}$ (think a moment). But we have also $\tilde{\gamma}(1) = \tilde{x}[\gamma]$, by definition of the right action of $\pi_1(X, x) \simeq \text{Aut}(\tilde{X}/X)^{\text{op}}$ on $\tilde{X}$. The lift $\tilde{\gamma}^S$ of γ in E_S starting at $(\tilde{x}, s)$ is $\tilde{\gamma}^S(t) = (\gamma(t), s)$. The action of $\pi_1(X, x)$ on $F_{S,x}$ is given by:

$$g \cdot (\tilde{x}, s) = \tilde{\gamma}^S(1) = (\tilde{\gamma}(1), s) = (\tilde{x}g, s) = (\tilde{x}, gs),$$

so the monodromy corresponds to the action ρ of $\pi_1(X, x)$ on S .

Exercise 9.35. Having in mind the above construction, finish the proof of 9.33. What is left is to show that if $p : E \rightarrow X$ is a covering space with fiber F_x endowed with the monodromy action, then E and E_{F_x} are isomorphic as coverings.

□

Supplement material 9.36 (Locally constant sheaves and local systems).

If $p : Y \rightarrow X$ is a continuous map and $U \subseteq X$ is an open subset, recall that a *section* of p over U is a continuous map $s : U \rightarrow Y$ satisfying $p \circ s = \text{id}_U$. Associating to U the set $\mathcal{F}_Y(U)$ of sections of p over U defines a sheaf (prove it), called the *sheaf of sections*. If $p : E \rightarrow X$ is a covering space, then the sheaf $\mathcal{F}_E$ is locally constant. The rule $E \mapsto \mathcal{F}_E$ is a functor from the category of covering spaces of X and the category of locally constant sheaves. It defines in fact some equivalence of categories (see for instance [Sza09] for a proof):

Theorem 9.37. *The functor $E \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_E$ defines an equivalence of categories between the category of covering spaces of X and that of locally constant sheaves on X .*

We may combine it with theorem 9.33:

Theorem 9.38. *Let X be a path-connected, locally path-connected and SLSC space, and $x \in X$ a point. We have an equivalence of categories:*

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{locally constant} \\ \text{sheaves on } X \end{array} \right\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \{\pi_1(X, x)\text{-sets}\}$$

This equivalence is induced by the functor mapping a sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ to its stalk $\mathcal{F}_x$ endowed with the monodromy action coming from the corresponding (via 9.37) covering space.

One can consider sheaves with values in sets with additional structures, like modules over a commutative ring. This gives the following equivalence:

Theorem 9.39. *Let X be a path-connected, locally path-connected and SLSC space, $x \in X$ a point, and R a commutative ring. We have an equivalence of categories:*

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{locally constant sheaves} \\ \text{of } R\text{-modules on } X \end{array} \right\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \{R[\pi_1(X, x)]\text{-(left) modules}\}$$

If K is a field, a local system is a locally constant sheaf of finite K -vector spaces, we have an equivalence of categories:

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{local systems} \\ \text{over } K \text{ on } X \end{array} \right\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \left\{ \begin{array}{c} \text{finite dimensional left representations} \\ \text{of } \pi_1(X, x) \text{ over } K \end{array} \right\}$$

In particular, to give a local system of dimension n on X over K is the same as giving a group morphism $\pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_n(K)$, called the *monodromy representation*.

Local systems appear often in nature when studying differential equations. For instance, if $D \subseteq \mathbb{C}$ is a connected open subset, the “local solutions” over D of a given homogeneous linear differential equation of order n is a complex local system of dimension n on D .

Supplement material 9.40 (Riemann-Hilbert correspondence).

The category of complex local systems can be also understood through the notion of *connections* via the so-called Riemann-Hilbert correspondence. We state it here in the simple context of an open subset $D \subseteq \mathbb{C}$, even if this holds much more generally for complex-manifolds (where we need to speak about *flatness* or *integrability*).

Definition 9.41. A *holomorphic connection* on $D \subseteq \mathbb{C}$ is a pair $(\mathcal{E}, \nabla)$, where $\mathcal{E}$ is a locally free (holomorphic) sheaf on D , and $\nabla : \mathcal{E} \rightarrow \mathcal{E} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}} \Omega_D^1$ is a morphism of sheaves of $\mathbb{C}$ -vector spaces satisfying the Leibniz rule:

$$\nabla(fs) = df \otimes s + f\nabla(s)$$

for all open $U \subseteq D$, $f \in \mathcal{O}(U)$ and $s \in \mathcal{E}(U)$.

A section $s \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ of a connection $(\mathcal{E}, \nabla)$ is called *horizontal* if it satisfies $\nabla(s) = 0$. Horizontal sections form a subsheaf of $\mathbb{C}$ -vector spaces $\mathcal{E}^\nabla \subset \mathcal{E}$.

Theorem 9.42. *The functor $(\mathcal{E}, \nabla) \mapsto \mathcal{E}^\nabla$ induces an equivalence of categories between the category of holomorphic connections on D and that of complex local systems on D .*

For some explanations and details about the proof, see for instance [Sza09].

This version of Riemann-Hilbert correspondence has some vast generalizations due to Deligne (see [Del06]), or generalizations to D -modules, but I do not want to explain them here.

9.6. Graphs and free groups.

We have seen that every group can be realized as the fundamental group of a topological space. Moreover, when the space has a universal topological covering, the Galois correspondence (9.17) tells us that subgroups of the fundamental group and connected coverings spaces are the same

thing. Therefore, this opens the way to study properties of groups via topology and covering spaces. Here is an illustration of this principle, where the topology of graphs has some interesting consequences about free groups.

Definition 9.43. We define a *graph* as a 1-dimensional *CW-complex* X : a space obtained from a discrete set X^0 (its elements are the *vertices* of X) by attaching a collection of 1-cells e_α called the *edges* of X . In other words, X is obtained from the disjoint union of X^0 and the closed intervals I_α by identifying the two endpoints of I_α with points in X^0 .

A graph is *finite* if it has only finitely many vertices and edges or, equivalently, if it is a compact space. A graph is *locally finite* if each vertex is a boundary point of only finitely many edges. A *subgraph* A of X is a graph $A \subseteq X$ with $A^0 \subseteq X^0$. Note that a graph is always locally contractible, so in particular a connected graph has a universal covering. A *tree* is a contractible graph. A subtree of a graph is *maximal* if it is not contained in any strictly larger subtree.

Lemma 9.44. *If a tree T is a subgraph of a graph X , then T is contained in a maximal tree. If X is connected, then a tree in X is maximal if and only if it contains all vertices of X .*

Proof. Since the union of an increasing family of trees in X is a tree, the first statement holds by Zorn's lemma. If X is connected, then a tree containing all vertices is maximal since addition of an edge would result in a subgraph that contains a non-trivial loop. Conversely, a tree T that does not contain all vertices is not maximal since a vertex not in T can be connected to a vertex in T without creating any loop. $\square$

Define the Euler characteristic $\chi(X)$ of a finite graph X to be $V - E$, where V is the number of vertices of X and E is the number of edges. By induction on the number of edges, $\chi(X) = 1$ for any finite tree.

Exercise 9.45. Show that this definition of the Euler characteristic for graphs is consistent with the definition given in 3.21.

The following proposition is not difficult to prove (think about lifting of paths):

Proposition 9.46. *Let X be a connected graph, and $p : E \rightarrow X$ a connected covering space. Then E is also a connected graph. If X is finite and p is a finite n -sheeted covering, then $\chi(E) = n\chi(X)$.*

If T is a maximal tree in a graph X and a base vertex $x \in X$, any edge e_α of $X \setminus T$ determines a loop f_α in X that goes from x to one endpoint of e_α by a path in T , then across e_α , then back to x by a path in T . This observation leads to the following description of the fundamental group of X :

Proposition 9.47. *If X is a connected graph with maximal tree T , $\pi_1(X)$ is a free group with number of generators the number of edges of $X \setminus T$. It is generated by the classes $[f_\alpha]$ corresponding to the edges e_α of $X \setminus T$.*

If X is finite, $\pi_1(X)$ is free on $1 - \chi(X)$ generators. In particular, $\chi(X) \leq 1$ with equality if and only if X is a tree.

Proof. We only prove the first part of the statement, since the second part is an easy consequence of the first. One way to prove it is to use Van Kampen's theorem. If $(e_\alpha)_{\alpha \in I}$ is the collection of edges of $X \setminus T$, consider the open cover

$$X = \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} U_\alpha,$$

where U_α is a small neighborhood of $T \cup e_\alpha$ in X that contracts to $T \cup e_\alpha$. Each U_α is homotopy equivalent to S^1 , so $\pi_1(U_\alpha) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$. We can directly apply Van Kampen theorem, since the double or triple intersections of these opens are path-connected and contractible.

Another proof would be to note that the quotient map $X \rightarrow X/T$ is a homotopy equivalence because T is contractible and the pair (X, T) satisfies the homotopy extension property (see [Hat02], 0.17). But the quotient X/T is a graph with only one vertex (because a maximal tree

contains all the vertices), so it is a wedge sum of circles, with one circle corresponding to each edge e_α in $X \setminus T$. $\square$

Here is an important group-theoretical consequence:

Theorem 9.48. *Every subgroup of a free group is a free group. If G is a free subgroup on k generators and H is a subgroup of finite index n , then H is a free group on $1 - n + nk$ generators.*

Proof. One can realize G as $\pi_1(X, x)$ for a certain connected graph X and $x \in X$, namely the graph with only one vertex x , and one closed edge for any generator of G in a given free basis. If H is a subgroup of $G \simeq \pi_1(X)$, by 9.17 there exists a connected covering space $p : E \rightarrow X$ and $e \in E$ above x with $p_*(\pi_1(E, e)) = H$. We know by 9.46 that E is a graph, so by 9.47 and the fact that p_* is injective, we get that H is a free group. If G is free on k generator, then X is a finite graph and $\chi(X) = 1 - k$ (by 9.47). If $[G : H] = n$, then the covering space $p : E \rightarrow X$ is n -sheeted, so $\chi(E) = n\chi(X) = n - nk$. Finally, we know that H is free on $1 - \chi(E) = 1 - n + nk$ generators. $\square$

EXERCISES

Exercise 9.49 (Aspherical spaces and null-homotopy). A continuous map between topological spaces is *null-homotopic* if it is homotopic to a constant map. A space is *aspherical* if it has a contractible universal covering.

- (i) If X is an aspherical space, show that a map $Y \rightarrow X$ is null-homotopic if and only if the induced map $f_* : \pi_1(Y) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ is trivial.
- (ii) If $n \geq 2$, show that any map $S^n \rightarrow T$ to the torus is null-homotopic.

Exercise 9.50 (When the fundamental group is finite).

Assume that X is path-connected and locally path-connected space with $\pi_1(X)$ finite. Show that every map $X \rightarrow S^1$ is nullhomotopic.

Exercise 9.51 (A space without any simply-connected covering).

Let X be the subspace of $\mathbb{R}^2$ consisting of the four sides of the square $[0, 1] \times [0, 1]$ together with the segment of the vertical lines $x = 1/2, 1/3, 1/4, \dots$ inside the square. Show that for any covering space $E \rightarrow X$, there exists some neighborhood of the left edge of X that lifts homeomorphically to E . Deduce that X does not have any simply-connected covering space.

Exercise 9.52 (Covering spaces and composition).

- (i) Is the composition of two covering spaces a covering space?
- (ii) Given some maps $X \rightarrow Y \rightarrow Z$ such that both $Y \rightarrow Z$ and the composition $X \rightarrow Z$ are covering spaces, show that $X \rightarrow Y$ is a covering space if Z is locally path-connected. When it is the case, show that $X \rightarrow Y$ is normal as soon as $X \rightarrow Z$ is normal.

Exercise 9.53 (Covering spaces versus local homeomorphisms).

Let X and Y be connected, locally path connected, and Hausdorff. A map $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is said to be a *local homeomorphism* if every point of X has an open neighborhood that maps homeomorphically onto an open set of Y .

- (1) Give an example of a surjective local homeomorphism that is not a covering.
- (2) Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a local homeomorphism, where X is compact. Prove that f is surjective, and that it is a covering space with finite fibers.

Exercise 9.54 (Subgroups in action).

Let G be a group acting evenly on a path-connected, locally path-connected space X . Any subgroup $H \subseteq G$ determines a composition of covering spaces $X \rightarrow X^H \rightarrow X^G$. Show that:

- (i) Every path-connected covering space between X and X^G is isomorphic to X^H for some subgroup H .

- (ii) Two such covering spaces X^{H_1} and X^{H_2} of X^G are isomorphic if and only if H_1 and H_2 are conjugate subgroups of G .
- (iii) The covering space $X^H \rightarrow X^G$ is normal if and only if H is a normal subgroup of G . Show in this case the isomorphism $\text{Aut}(X^H/X^G) \simeq G/H$.

Exercise 9.55 (Is a covering space of a group a group?).

Let G be a connected and locally path connected topological group with identity element e , let $p : H \rightarrow G$ be a connected covering, and fix $f \in H$ such that $p(f) = e$.

- (1) Show that H has a unique continuous product $H \times H \rightarrow H$ with identity element f such that p is a homomorphism.
- (2) Show that H is a topological group under this product, and H is abelian if G is.
- (3) Show that the kernel K of p is a discrete normal subgroup of H .
- (4) In general, show that any discrete normal subgroup K of a connected topological group H is contained in the center $\mathcal{Z}(H)$ of H .
- (5) For $k \in K$, define $t(k) : H \rightarrow H$ by $t(k)(h) = kh$. Show that $k \rightarrow t(k)$ specifies an isomorphism between K and the group of deck transformations $\text{Aut}(H/G)$ of the covering $p : H \rightarrow G$.

Exercise 9.56 (Subgroups of index two of F_2 : two points of view).

How many subgroups of index 2 are in the free group F_2 of two generator a and b ? Answer this question in two ways: the first one with group theory, the second one with algebraic topology. Specify generators and relations for each of these groups.

Exercise 9.57 (Commutator subgroup of a free group).

Let F be the free group on two generators, and F' its commutator subgroup. Find a set of free generators of F' by considering an appropriate covering space of the graph $S^1 \vee S^1$.

Exercise 9.58 (Normal subgroup of infinite index in a free group).

Show that a non-trivial normal subgroup of infinite index of a finitely generated free group cannot be finitely generated.

Exercise 9.59 (Finiteness of subgroups of a given finite index). Show that a finitely generated group has only a finite number of subgroups of a given finite index (*Hint*: Do first the case of free groups using covering spaces).

10. COHOMOLOGY AND CUP PRODUCT

Now, we study cohomology theory. Superficially, cohomology gains no knowledge compared to homology as groups. However, we will see later that we can equip a ring structure on cohomology, which makes it essentially better than homology!

For example, we shall know that T^2 and $S^2 \vee S^1 \vee S^1$ are not homotopy equivalent (now you should know that both of them have the homology groups $H_0 = \mathbb{Z}, H_1 = \mathbb{Z}^2, H_2 = \mathbb{Z}$, and you will see that the cohomology groups are the same as well) by showing their ring structure are different.

10.1. Singular cohomology. We define singular cohomology and explain the cohomological versions of many theorems we have previously proved. **Notice:** this section could also be a review sheet for what we have learned so far (parallel to the homology version.)

Recall: For two abelian groups A, M , we have the dual pairing

$$\langle -, - \rangle : \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(A, M) \times A \rightarrow M, \langle \alpha, a \rangle := \alpha(a).$$

For a homomorphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ between abelian groups and an abelian group M , we can define its dual $f^\vee : \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(B, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(A, M)$ as following, for $\beta \in \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(B, M)$

$$f^\vee(\beta)(a) = \beta(f(a)),$$

equivalently, we can write it using the pairing

$$\langle f^\vee(\beta), a \rangle = \langle \beta, f(a) \rangle$$

for all $(\beta, a) \in \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(B, M) \times A$.

Exercise 10.1. Here, we put the algebraic result as an exercise. Consider the short exact sequence of abelian groups

$$0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow 0,$$

and we may take its dual exact sequence

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(A, M) \leftarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(B, M) \leftarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(C, M) \leftarrow 0,$$

which is generally not extended to a exact sequence at $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(A, M)$.

Show that if C is free, then the dual exact sequence can be extended to SES

$$0 \leftarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(A, M) \leftarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(B, M) \leftarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(C, M) \leftarrow 0.$$

You may prove that if C is free, then the SES $0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow 0$ is isomorphic to $0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow A \oplus C \rightarrow C \rightarrow 0$ (i.e. the SES split), and then can show that split SES are mapped to SES after taking dual $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(-, M)$. From the argument, you also learn that this is a result about the dual of split SES, and C free is just a sufficient condition for splitting the SES.

Definition 10.2. For a space X and an abelian group M , we set

$$S^q(X; M) := \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_q(X), M), \quad \delta^q := \partial_{q+1}^\vee : S^q(X; M) \rightarrow S^{q+1}(X; M).$$

Then we call the cochain complex $S^*(X; M) = (S^p(X; M), \delta^p)$ the *singular cochain complex* of X , and we set abelian groups

$$B^q(X; M) := \text{im}(\delta_{q-1}) \subset \ker(\delta_q) =: Z^q(X; M)$$

and define the q -th **singular cohomology** group as the quotient

$$H^q(X; M) := Z^q(X; M) / B^q(X; M).$$

We call cochains in $Z^q(X; M)$ *cocycles* and cochains in $B^q(X; M)$ *coboundaries*.

If $M = \mathbb{Z}$, we omit M from the notation: For example, $S^*(X)$, $H^q(X)$ and so on.

Remark 10.3. By definition, a cochain $c \in S^q(X; M)$ is a $\mathbb{Z}$ -linear function⁵

$$c : S_q(X) \rightarrow M.$$

And c is a cocycle means that the restriction of c on the group of boundary chains $B_q(X)$ is 0.

Now, let us give theorems, and to give you some key point for their proof. We only state them for $\mathbb{Z}$ for simplicity.

Theorem 10.4. *For a map $f : X \rightarrow Y$, we have induced cochain map $S^*(f) = f^\#$ and its cohomology $H^q(f) = f^q$*

$$f^\# : S^*(Y) \rightarrow S^*(X), \quad f^q : H^q(Y) \rightarrow H^q(X),$$

which are compatible with composition.

When $f \simeq g$, we have $f^\# \simeq g^\#$ (as cochain maps), and then $f^q = g^q$.

Consequently, cohomology groups are homotopy invariants.

Proof. The cochain map $f^\# = S^*(f)$ is simply $(S_*(f))^\vee$, and then $H^q(f) = f^q$ are cohomology of $S^*(f)$. Then the homotopy invariance also follows from the result for chains (it is clear that a dual of a chain homotopy is also a cochain homotopy). $\square$

Remark 10.5. Important! The main significant difference between (singular) cohomology and homology is: the direction of $S^*(f) = f^\#$ and $H^q(f) = f^q$, which is opposite to $f_\#$ and f_q . It means that cohomologies are contravariant functors while homologies are covariant functors.

The difference is so tiny, but so important in many applications. Especially, the product structure on cohomology follows from this reason! (But also, sometimes it is a bad thing to have a contravariant functor, you may learn the defect for cohomology in your life sometime.)

In principle, no need to write a small cochain theorem. We will only write their corollary, i.e. the Mayer-Vietoris sequence and the excision.

Theorem 10.6. *We have the Mayer-Vietoris long exact sequences: If $\{X_1, X_2\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo, then there exists a long exact sequence*

$$\cdots \rightarrow H^q(X_1 \cup X_2) \xrightarrow{a_q} H^q(X_1) \oplus H^q(X_2) \xrightarrow{s_q} H^q(X_1 \cap X_2) \xrightarrow{d} H^{q+1}(X_1 \cup X_2) \rightarrow \cdots$$

And the sequence is natural with respect to maps between Mayer-Vietoris duos.

Proof. Compare to the proof of Theorem 4.6, we only need to show that the sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2), \mathbb{Z}) \xrightarrow{a^\#} S^*(X_1) \oplus S^*(X_2) \xrightarrow{s^\#} S^*(X_1 \cap X_2) \rightarrow 0$$

is exact and $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X_1) + S_*(X_2), \mathbb{Z}) \simeq S^*(X_1 \cup X_2)$.

The former follows from the fact that the small chain theorem gives a chain homotopy, so after taking dual $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(-, \mathbb{Z})$, we have a cochain homotopy. For the latter, we use the following fact that $S_*(X_1) \oplus S_*(X_2)$ is a degree-wise free chain complex, and then apply Exercise 10.1! $\square$

Corollary 10.7. *Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map, then there exists a long exact sequence*

$$\cdots \rightarrow H^q(C(f)) \xrightarrow{e^q} H^q(Y) \xrightarrow{f^q} H^q(X) \xrightarrow{d} H^{q+1}(C(f)) \rightarrow \cdots,$$

where $e : Y \rightarrow C(f)$ is the inclusion map.

Next, we consider the cellular cohomology

Definition 10.8. For a CW complex X , we define its cellular cochain complex by

$$C^*(X; M) = (\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(C_q(X), M), d_q^\vee).$$

Its cohomology groups are called the cellular cohomology of X , denoted by $H_{CW}^q(X, M)$.

Theorem 10.9. *We have $H_{CW}^q(X) \simeq H^q(X)$ for a CW complex X .*

⁵You can imagine you put some color on different pieces of your space, the intuition is an early motivation for cohomology theory.

Notice that we do not have $C^*(X; M) \simeq S^*(X; M)$ here, but you can run the same argument for Theorem 5.17 to prove the theorem.

Exercise 10.10. On the computational results, we list them all here as exercise:

- (1) For a contractible space X , we have

$$H^q(X) \cong 0, \forall q \geq 1, \quad H^0(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}.$$

- (2) We have $H^q(\bigsqcup_i X_i) \cong \prod_i H^q(X_i)$; $H^q(X) \cong \tilde{H}^q(X), \forall q \geq 1, \quad H^0(X) \cong \tilde{H}^0(X) \oplus \mathbb{Z}$; and $\tilde{H}^*(\vee_i^d X_i) = \prod_i \tilde{H}^*(X_i)$.⁶

- (3) The space X is path connected if and only if $H^0(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}$.

- (4) For sphere, $n \geq 1$,

$$\tilde{H}^q(S^n) \cong 0, \forall q \neq n, \quad H^n(S^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$$

- (5) For the genus g surface Σ , we have $H^2(\Sigma) \cong \mathbb{Z}$, $H^1(\Sigma) \cong \mathbb{Z}^{2g}$, $H^0(\Sigma) \cong \mathbb{Z}$.

- (6) $H^q(\mathbb{C}P^n) = \mathbb{Z}$ for $q = 0, 2, \dots, 2n$ and trivial otherwise.

Hint: You may repeat our argument for homology. But a shortcut is using the universal coefficient theorem below.

At the end, we present another universal coefficient theorem, which enables you to compute the cohomology groups from homology groups. We start with a warm-up exercise.

Exercise 10.11. The chain level dual pairing $S^p(X; M) \otimes S_p(X) \rightarrow M, \langle c, \sigma \rangle = c(\sigma)$ descend to $\kappa : H^p(X; M) \otimes H_p(X) \rightarrow M$. (Noticed that the (co)homology level pairing is not perfect, so we do NOT have $H^p(X) \cong H_p(X)$ in general.)

Consequently, we have a homomorphism between abelian groups

$$\text{ev}_H : H^q(X; M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(H_q(X), M).$$

Theorem 10.12 (Universal coefficient theorem for cohomology). *Let M be an abelian group and X be a space, for each q , we have the following short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(H_{q-1}(X), M) \rightarrow H^q(X; M) \xrightarrow{\text{ev}_H} \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(H_q(X), M) \rightarrow 0.$$

Proof. Noticed that $S_*(X)$ is a free chain complex, then you can apply the algebraic universal coefficient theorem for cohomology, i.e. Theorem A.18 to $S^*(X; M)$. $\square$

Remark 10.13. Similar to Remark 2.29, if you don't know $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1$, you may use it directly based on the following information:

- 1) $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1$ converts direct sums in the first variable into direct product:

$$\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i, B\right) \simeq \prod_{i \in I} \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A_i, B)$$

and it preserves direct product in the second variable:

$$\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, \prod_{j \in J} B_j) \simeq \prod_{j \in J} \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, B_j),$$

in particular $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1$ commutes with finite direct sum on both variables.

- 2) $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, B) = 0$ for any B if A is projective, for example when it is free like $A = \mathbb{Z}$.
 3) $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, B) = 0$ for any A if B is injective. It is the case when B is divisible like $B = \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{Q}$, or $\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$.
 4) $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}, B) = B/nB$, in particular $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Z}/m) \cong \mathbb{Z}/\text{gcd}(m, n)$,

Since $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, \mathbb{Z})$ is the torsion subgroup of A and $\text{Hom}(A, \mathbb{Z})$ is isomorphic to the free part of A if A is finitely generated, we have the following consequence:

⁶Be careful here, for homology, we get direct sum, but for cohomology we get direct product. Surely they are the same if there are finitely many factors, but different in general.

Corollary 10.14. *If the homology groups $H_n(X)$ and $H_{n-1}(X)$ are finitely generated, with torsion groups $T_n \subseteq H_n(X)$ and $T_{n-1} \subseteq H_{n-1}(X)$, then the n^{th} cohomology group is $H^n(X) = (H_n(X)/T_n) \oplus T_{n-1}$.*

Corollary 10.15. *If a map $f : X \rightarrow Y$ induces an isomorphism on all homology groups, it induces an isomorphism on all cohomology groups with coefficient in any abelian group M .*

Exercise 10.16. You can also define $b^q(X)$ as $\text{rank}_{\mathbb{Q}} H^q(X)$ when $H^q(X)$ is finitely generated.

Show that $H^q(X)$ is finitely generated $\forall q$ if and only if $H_q(X)$ is finitely generated $\forall q$, and $b^q(X) = b_q(X) \forall q$. So it doesn't matter whether you are defining the Betti number using homology or cohomology.

Remark 10.17. (i) When $q = 0$ there is no $\text{Ext}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}$ term, so we always have $H^0(X; M) \simeq \text{Hom}(H_0(X), M)$, both groups can be interpreted as the functions from the path connected components of X to M .

(ii) As $H_0(X)$ is always a free group, we have $H^1(X; M) \simeq \text{Hom}(H_1(X), M)$. The group M is abelian, and we saw in Theorem 7.32 that $H_1(X) = \pi_1(X)^{\text{ab}}$, so we have: $H^1(X; M) \simeq \text{Hom}(\pi_1(X), M)$.

10.2. Products on cohomology. Now, we introduce the ring structure on cohomology.

Definition 10.18. Let R to be a commutative ring, and we denote $m : R \otimes R \rightarrow R, (x, y) \mapsto xy$ the ring multiplication.

Let X, Y be a spaces, we define the chain level cross-product as the composition

$$\begin{aligned} \times : S^*(X; R) \otimes S^*(Y; R) &= \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X), R) \otimes \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(Y), R) \\ &\xrightarrow{\otimes} \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y), R \otimes R) \\ &\xrightarrow{m} \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X) \otimes S_*(Y), R) \\ &\xrightarrow{AW^{\vee}} \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X \times Y), R) = S^*(X \times Y; R), \end{aligned}$$

where $AW^{\vee}$ is the dual of the Alexander-Whitney map.

If $X = Y$, we define the chain level cup-product as

$$\smile : S^*(X; R) \otimes S^*(X; R) \xrightarrow{\times} S^*(X \times X; R) \xrightarrow{\Delta^{\#}} S^*(X; R),$$

where $\Delta : X \rightarrow X \times X, x \mapsto (x, x)$ is the diagonal map.

Remark 10.19. Now, since we need to use multiplication to define the product, we need to take the coefficient not just an abelian group, but also a commutative ring. It is clear that both the cross product and the cup product are R -bilinear. In below, we use $R = \mathbb{Z}$ to simplify notation.

Exercise 10.20. Let us keep track of the process, and show the following formula for cup product. Let $c \in S^p(X)$, $d \in S^q(X)$ and $\sigma \in S_{p+q}(X)$, we have (recall Definition 6.1)

$$(c \smile d)(\sigma) = c(p\sigma) \cdot d(\sigma_q).$$

Hint: Use the explicit formula for AW and notice that $p_i \Delta = \text{id}_X$ for $i = 1, 2$.

Notice If you don't want to know what the Alexander-Whitney map is, the formula could be regarded as the definition of cup product.

Exercise 10.21. Show that we can compute the cross product using cup product, for $c \in S^q(X)$, $d \in S^p(Y)$, we have

$$c \times d = p_X^{\#} c \smile p_Y^{\#} d,$$

where $p_X : X \times Y \rightarrow X$ and $p_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$ are the two canonical projections.

Proposition 10.22. *The chain level cross/cup product satisfies the Leibnitz rule: $c \in S^p(X)$, $d \in S^q(Y)$ ($X = Y$ when discussing $\smile$), then we have*

$$\delta(c \times d) = \delta c \times d + (-1)^p c \times \delta d, \quad \delta(c \smile d) = \delta c \smile d + (-1)^p c \smile \delta d.$$

Proof. For the cross product, the result essentially follows from the fact that AW is a chain map, and the Leibnitz rule for graded tensor product. We present the details here.

We denote the composition of m and $\otimes$ as $\otimes_m$, then

$$(c \times d)(\psi) = (c \otimes_m d)(AW(\psi)), \quad \psi \in S_{p+q}(X \times Y).$$

Since AW is a chain map, for $\psi \in S_{p+q+1}(X \times Y)$ we have

$$(\delta(c \times d))(\psi) = (c \times d)(\partial\psi) = (c \otimes_m d)(AW(\partial\psi)) = (c \otimes_m d)(\partial AW(\psi)) = (\delta(c \otimes_m d))(AW(\psi)).$$

On the tensor product cochain complex,

$$\delta(c \otimes_m d) = \delta c \otimes_m d + (-1)^p c \otimes_m \delta d.$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} (\delta(c \times d))(\psi) &= (\delta c \otimes_m d + (-1)^p c \otimes_m \delta d)(AW(\psi)) \\ &= (\delta c \times d + (-1)^p c \times \delta d)(\psi). \end{aligned}$$

Hence

$$\delta(c \times d) = \delta c \times d + (-1)^p c \times \delta d.$$

Next, for the cup product, we have

$$\delta(c \smile d) = \delta \Delta^\#(c \times d) = \Delta^\# \delta(c \times d) = \Delta^\#(\delta c \times d + (-1)^p c \times \delta d) = \delta c \smile d + (-1)^p c \smile \delta d. \quad \square$$

Therefore, both the cross product and cup product descend to cohomology.

Definition 10.23. Let X be a space, we define the cohomology level cross-product and cup-product

$$\begin{aligned} \times : H^*(X) \otimes H^*(Y) &\rightarrow H^*(X \times Y), \quad [c] \times [d] \mapsto [c \times d] \\ \smile : H^*(X) \otimes H^*(X) &\rightarrow H^*(X), \quad [c] \smile [d] \mapsto [c \smile d]. \end{aligned}$$

Exercise 10.24. Prove that the cohomology level cross-product and cup-product are well-defined using the Leibniz rule. Moreover, we have $\Delta^*([c] \times [d]) = [c] \smile [d]$ and $[c] \times [d] = p_X^*[c] \smile p_Y^*[d]$.

Now, we give the first example.

Example 10.25. On $H^*(S^n)$, let x be a generator of $H^n(S^n)$, then by degree reason

$$x \smile x = 0.$$

Then we have $H^*(S^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^2)$ where $|x| = n$.

We can use the cross product to give a Künneth formula for cohomology.

Theorem 10.26. For X, Y be two spaces, and if $H_q(Y)$ are finitely generated for all q (for example Y finite-type CW complex), we have a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=r} H^p(X) \otimes H^q(Y) \xrightarrow{\times} H^r(X \times Y) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=r+1} \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_p(X), H_q(Y)) \rightarrow 0;$$

Or over a field $\mathbb{F}$ (but still need finiteness), we have

$$\bigoplus_{p+q=r} H^p(X; \mathbb{F}) \otimes_{\mathbb{F}} H^q(Y; \mathbb{F}) \cong H^r(X \times Y; \mathbb{F}).$$

Remark 10.27. It is a little weird to require a finiteness condition for the cohomological Künneth formula. This is because the cohomology theory is a dual! We often need finiteness to make dual behavior not too bad anyway.

Example 10.28. Here, we use Theorem 10.26 to compute the cup product on $H^*(T^2)$. The only non-trivial product is $H^1(T^2) \otimes H^1(T^2) \rightarrow H^2(T^2)$ (except the degree reason, we still have $H^0(T^2) \otimes H^*(T^2) \rightarrow H^*(T^2)$, but you will see that this is clear by the fact that the cup product is unital).

In fact, by the Künneth formula theorem, we have that

$$H^1(S_1^1) \otimes H^1(S_2^1) \xrightarrow{\cong} H^2(T^2),$$

where you see that the cross product gives the homomorphism. Then we have that the generator b of $H^2(T^2)$ is given by $b = a_1 \times a_2$ for $H^*(S_i^1) = \mathbb{Z}a_i$.

But, by geometric construction, two generators of $H^1(T^2)$ are $u_i = p_i^* a_i$. Then $u_1 \smile u_2 = a_1 \times a_2 = b$ by Exercise 10.21. In summary, we have $H^*(T^2) = \mathbb{Z}[x, y]/(x^2, y^2)$ pour $|x| = |y| = 1$ as graded rings.

In this way, we see inductively that the isomorphism of graded commutative algebras $H^*(T^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x_1, \dots, x_n]/(x_i^2 \mid i = 1, \dots, n)$ the exterior algebra generated by n many degree 1 elements.

At the end, we introduce the cap product, which is useful for the study of manifolds. Now, I believe you can finish the construction as an exercise.

Exercise 10.29. We define the cap product

$$\frown: S^p(X) \otimes S_n(X) \rightarrow S_{n-p}(X),$$

on singular simplex σ by

$$c \frown \sigma = c(p\sigma) \cdot \sigma_{n-p},$$

and we extend it linearly to all singular chains σ .

Show the following

(1) The chain level boundary formula: for $c \in S^p$, we have

$$\partial(c \frown \sigma) = (-1)^p(\delta c \frown \sigma - c \frown \partial\sigma).$$

Therefore, $\frown$ descends to a cap product on (co)homology.

$$\frown: H^q(X) \otimes H_n(X) \rightarrow H_{n-q}(X).$$

(2) On the chain level, we have the formula

$$\langle c \smile d, \sigma \rangle = \langle c, d \frown \sigma \rangle.$$

Then show the same formula descends to (co)homology level.

Warning: For the terms (3), (4) below, I suggest you do it after reading the next section. We put it here to keep the structure of the notes compact.

(3) Let $e \in S^0(X)$ be the chain level cup product unit, i.e. the singular cochain constantly equals 1 on $S_0(X)$. Then we have $e \frown \sigma = \sigma$ for $\sigma \in S_*(X)$.

(4) Let $f: X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map, we have the projection formula for the cap product:

$$f_{\#}(f^{\#}c \frown \sigma) = c \frown f_{\#}\sigma.$$

Everything works R -linearly.

10.3. Cup product forms a ring. Now, let us explain some properties of the cup product. I would suggest you skip the proof in your first reading.

Theorem 10.30. *Let X be a space, we have that the chain level cup-product is unital, associative, in particular, $(S^*(X), \smile)$ is a unital ring. If $f: X \rightarrow Y$ is a map, then $f^{\#}$ is a ring homomorphism.*

It descends to cohomology, and then also has that $(H^(X), \smile)$ is a unital ring, and $f^*: H^*(Y) \rightarrow H^*(X)$ is a ring homomorphism.*

Proof. We only prove the chain level result. All those laws descend to cohomology.

Recall the formula for cup product (Exercise 10.20)

$$(c \smile d)(\sigma) = c(p\sigma) d(q\sigma), \quad c \in S^p(X), \quad d \in S^q(X), \quad \sigma \in S_{p+q}(X).$$

We first show associativity. Let $a \in S^p(X)$, $b \in S^q(X)$ and $c \in S^r(X)$, and let $\sigma \in S_{p+q+r}(X)$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} ((a \smile b) \smile c)(\sigma) &= (a \smile b)_{(p+q)\sigma} c(\sigma_r) \\ &= a_{(p(p+q\sigma))} b_{((p+q\sigma)_q)} c(\sigma_r). \end{aligned}$$

On the other hand,

$$\begin{aligned} (a \smile (b \smile c))(\sigma) &= a_{(p\sigma)} (b \smile c)_{((\sigma)_{q+r})} \\ &= a_{(p\sigma)} b_{(q((\sigma)_{q+r}))} c_{(((\sigma)_{q+r})_r)}. \end{aligned}$$

Now the relevant faces are the same simplex:

$$p(p+q\sigma) = p\sigma, \quad (p+q\sigma)_q = q((\sigma)_{q+r}), \quad ((\sigma)_{q+r})_r = \sigma_r.$$

Hence

$$((a \smile b) \smile c)(\sigma) = (a \smile (b \smile c))(\sigma),$$

so $\smile$ is associative.

Next, let $e \in S^0(X)$ be the constant 0-cochain sending every singular 0-simplex to $1 \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then for $c \in S^p(X)$ and $\sigma \in S_p(X)$,

$$(e \smile c)(\sigma) = e(\sigma_0)c(\sigma_p) = c(\sigma), \quad (c \smile e)(\sigma) = c(\sigma_p)e(\sigma_0) = c(\sigma).$$

Thus e is a two-sided unit, and $S^*(X)$ is a unital graded ring.

If $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is continuous, then for $c \in S^p(Y)$, $d \in S^q(Y)$ and $\sigma \in S_{p+q}(X)$,

$$\begin{aligned} f^\#(c \smile d)(\sigma) &= (c \smile d)(f_\# \sigma) \\ &= c(p(f_\# \sigma)) d((f_\# \sigma)_q) \\ &= c(f_\#(\sigma_p)) d(f_\#(\sigma_q)) \\ &= (f^\# c)(\sigma_p) (f^\# d)(\sigma_q) \\ &= ((f^\# c) \smile (f^\# d))(\sigma). \end{aligned}$$

So $f^\#$ is a ring homomorphism. □

Remark 10.31. Here, we mention that $H^*(X)$ is not simply some abelian groups, and we should think it as $H^*(X) = \bigoplus_q H^q(X)$, a graded abelian group. The cup product respects the degree, so $H^*(X)$ is a graded ring. And f^* preserves the degree, so f^* is a homomorphism between graded rings. Also, $(S^*(X), \smile)$ is a differential graded algebra.

Notice that all of the operations are R -linear if R -coefficients show up.

Exercise 10.32. Similarly, show that the chain level cross product is also associative.

Theorem 10.33. *The cohomology ring $(H^*(X), \smile)$ is graded commutative, i.e. for $a \in H^p(X)$, $b \in H^q(X)$, we have*

$$a \smile b = (-1)^{pq} b \smile a.$$

Proof. To prove the theorem, we give a more precise result on the chain level.

For $c \in S^p(X)$ and $d \in S^q(X)$, we define the cup-1 product

$$c \smile_1 d \in S^{p+q-1}(X)$$

is defined by

$$(c \smile_1 d)(\sigma) = \sum_{j=0}^{p-1} (-1)^{(p-j)(q+1)} d(\sigma| [v_0, \dots, v_j, v_{j+q}, \dots, v_{p+q-1}]) d(\sigma| [v_j, \dots, v_{j+q}]),$$

for every singular simplex $\sigma : \Delta^{p+q-1} \rightarrow X$. Here $[\dots]$ means the sub-simplex spanned by the given vertices in Δ^{p+q-1} .

The cup-1 product as the bilinear map

$$\smile_1 : S^p(X) \otimes S^q(X) \rightarrow S^{p+q-1}(X)$$

satisfying the relation (its proof is similar to many differential formulas we given before, but computation more involved, left it as an exercise)

$$\delta(c \smile_1 d) = \delta c \smile_1 d + (-1)^p c \smile_1 \delta d + (-1)^p c \smile d - (-1)^{pq+q} d \smile c.$$

Rearranging the identity gives

$$c \smile d - (-1)^{pq} d \smile c = \delta(c \smile_1 d) - \delta c \smile_1 d - (-1)^p c \smile_1 \delta d.$$

Now assume that c, d are cocycles. Then $\delta c = \delta d = 0$, so the above identity reduces to

$$c \smile d - (-1)^{pq} d \smile c = \delta(c \smile_1 d).$$

Thus $c \smile d$ and $(-1)^{pq}d \smile c$ differ by a coboundary, hence define the same cohomology class. $\square$

Exercise 10.34. * Prove the identity

$$\delta(c \smile_1 d) = \delta c \smile_1 d + (-1)^p c \smile_1 \delta d + (-1)^p c \smile d - (-1)^{pq+q} d \smile c.$$

This computation is similar to proving AW is a chain map. But a little long.

Notice that, in the proof of the equation, we need the coefficient ring to be commutative!

Supplement material 10.35. In many textbooks, the graded commutativity is proven by introducing a certain chain homotopy.

Here, we present the proof using the cup-1 product, which is conceptually hard (especially, I cannot explain what forces you to write down the formula), but somehow the computation is more straightforward.

The reason for using this approach is that we want to present that the graded commutativity actually comes from the fact

$$S^*(X) \text{ is a } \mathbb{E}_\infty \text{ algebra.}$$

In fact, we can define higher cup products $\smile_i: S^*(X) \otimes S^*(X) \rightarrow S^*(X)[i]$ for all $i \geq 0$ from the combinatorial structure of simplexes (where $\smile_0 = \smile$), and they are organized in a way that failure of $\smile_i$ product on chain level is measured by $\smile_{i+1}$ products. Another interesting application is that the famous Steenrod square is computed by $Sq^i([x]) = [x \smile_{q-i} x]$ for $[x] \in H^q(X; \mathbb{F}_2)$.

They further indicate fruitful structures on $S^*(X)$: ALL their composition and differential formulas (and their multi-entries versions) are organized in “the” $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ operad. And then we say $S^*(X)$ is an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ algebra [MS03].

I hope the proof motivates you to view the concept of an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -algebra as a generalization of commutative algebra in the homotopy-coherent sense.

In practice, it is hard to convince many people why $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ algebra is a meaningful notion. Here, I would like to slightly convince you by this proof.

Supplement material 10.36. You might have heard the de Rham theorem: For a smooth manifold M , we have

$$H_{dR}^q(M) \cong H^q(M; \mathbb{R}).$$

Here are some interesting things.

1) First, let me explain its proof. [Bre93, Chapter 3]

By some smooth approximation theorem, you can show the inclusion is a quasi-isomorphism

$$S_*^\infty(M) \rightarrow S_*(M),$$

where $S_*^\infty(M)$ is the sub-chain generated by smooth simplexes $\sigma: \Delta^p \rightarrow M$.

Therefore, we have that $S_\infty^\infty(M) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{R}}(S_*^\infty(M), \mathbb{R})$ is quasi-isomorphic to $S^*(M)$.

The point for $S_*^\infty(M)$ is that we can integral

$$I: \Omega^p(M) \rightarrow S_\infty^p(M), \quad \omega \mapsto I(\omega) = [\sigma \mapsto \int_{\Delta^p} \sigma^* \omega].$$

The Stokes theorem tells you that: I is a chain map! And then descend to a map on cohomology, say $H^q(I)$.

You can easily prove that I is a quasi-isomorphism for open convex sets (with respect to a Riemannian metric) since convex sets are contractible.

Then you can take a covering of M by open convex sets, and then conclude using the Mayer-Vietoris sequences for both H_{dR}^* and H^* and the 5-lemma.

2) You can prove that $H^*(I)$ is a ring homomorphism, which is helpful for you to compute the cup product. However, this is not completely obvious as I is NOT a ring homomorphism on the *chain level*. We have to work on the cohomology level: by the Fubini theorem, you can see that $H^*(I)$ is compatible with the cross product on the cohomology level; and $H^*(I)$ commutes with Δ^* on both the de Rham side and the singular side. Then we conclude by Exercise 10.24.

10.4. Applications and more computations. So far, we have constructed the cup product, but we haven’t explained why it is more useful. Now, let’s try to give you some clues.

Example 10.37. We show that T^2 and $S^2 \vee S^1 \vee S^1$ are not homotopy equivalent. Then we know that both of them have the following cohomology groups.

$$H^0 = \mathbb{Z}, \quad H^1 = \mathbb{Z}^2, \quad H^2 = \mathbb{Z}.$$

However, we show that they are not homotopy equivalent by showing that their cup products do not coincide.

Here, it remains to see the cup product of $S^2 \vee S^1 \vee S^1$.

Let

$$i_{S^2} : S^2 \rightarrow X, \quad i_1 : S^1 \rightarrow X, \quad i_2 : S^1 \rightarrow X$$

be the inclusions of the three wedge summands, and let

$$p_{S^2} : X \rightarrow S^2, \quad p_1 : X \rightarrow S^1, \quad p_2 : X \rightarrow S^1$$

be the maps collapsing all other summands to the wedge point. The main idea is that all i^*, p^* are ring homomorphisms, so cup products are concentrated on each wedge summand.

Now, we explain it in detail.

Let $u \in H^2(S^2) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ be a generator, and let $a, b \in H^1(S^1) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ be generators for the two circle factors. Then

$$\alpha := p_1^*(a), \quad \beta := p_2^*(b), \quad \gamma := p_{S^2}^*(u)$$

generate

$$H^1(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}\alpha \oplus \mathbb{Z}\beta, \quad H^2(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}\gamma.$$

Now we claim that every cup product of two positive-degree classes in $H^*(X)$ is zero.

First, since $H^2(S^1) = 0$, we have

$$\alpha \smile \alpha = p_1^*(a) \smile p_1^*(a) = p_1^*(a \smile a) = 0, \quad \beta \smile \beta = p_2^*(b) \smile p_2^*(b) = p_2^*(b \smile b) = 0.$$

Next, consider $\alpha \smile \beta \in H^2(X)$. Since $H^2(X)$ is generated by γ , it is enough to check its restriction to each wedge summand. On the S^2 -summand, both α and β restrict to zero, because they come from the two S^1 -summands. Hence

$$i_{S^2}^*(\alpha \smile \beta) = i_{S^2}^*(\alpha) \smile i_{S^2}^*(\beta) = 0.$$

On the first S^1 -summand, we have $i_1^*(\beta) = i_1^*p_2^*(b) = (p_2i)^*(b) = 0$ since $p_2i : S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ is a constant map, so

$$i_1^*(\alpha \smile \beta) = i_1^*(\alpha) \smile i_1^*(\beta) = 0.$$

Similarly,

$$i_2^*(\alpha \smile \beta) = 0.$$

Thus $\alpha \smile \beta = 0$. By graded commutativity,

$$\beta \smile \alpha = -\alpha \smile \beta = 0.$$

Also, any product involving γ is automatically zero for degree reasons:

$$\alpha \smile \gamma = \beta \smile \gamma = \gamma \smile \alpha = \gamma \smile \beta = \gamma \smile \gamma = 0,$$

since $H^k(X) = 0$ for $k \geq 3$ and $H^4(X) = 0$.

Therefore, for $X = S^2 \vee S^1 \vee S^1$, all cup products of positive-degree classes vanish. In other words, the ring structure is trivial in positive degrees.

We can write directly that for $|\alpha| = 1, |\beta| = 1, |\gamma| = 2$

$$H^*(X) \cong \mathbb{Z}[\alpha, \beta, \gamma] / (\alpha^2, \beta^2, \gamma^2, \alpha\beta, \beta\gamma, \alpha\gamma).$$

Exercise 10.38. In fact, the trick we use here gives the following statement: Let X_k be finitely many path-connected spaces, and $X = \vee_k X_k$. We set i_k as wedge component inclusions, and p_k as wedge component projections. Let $H^+ = \bigoplus_{q>0} H^q$ as the (non-unital) subring of H^* (it has enough information since H^0 record units), then show that i_k^*, p_k^* induces a ring isomorphism $H^+(X) \cong \prod_k H^+(X_k)$.

Supplement material 10.39. Here, we see that cohomology ring still cannot determine a space. However, we have the following corollary of the (highly non-trivial) theorem of Mandell [Man06]:

Let X and Y be two finite CW complexes without 1-cells, suppose $S^*(X)$ and $S^*(Y)$ are isomorphic as $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -algebras, then $X \simeq Y$.
 It is out of surprise that under some not very ridiculous conditions, the $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -structure of $S^*(X)$ determines the homotopy type of X .

Example 10.40. Here, we explain how to compute the cup product on higher genus curves.

Let Σ is of genus g . Then $H^0 \cong \mathbb{Z}, H^1 \cong \mathbb{Z}^{2g}, H^2 \cong \mathbb{Z}$. We claim that there exists generators

$$\alpha_1, \beta_1, \dots, \alpha_g, \beta_g \in H^1(\Sigma)$$

and a generator $\omega \in H^2(\Sigma)$, such that

$$\alpha_i \smile \beta_j = \delta_{ij} \omega, \quad \beta_i \smile \alpha_j = -\delta_{ij} \omega,$$

for all $i = 1, \dots, g$, and for all $i, j = 1, \dots, g$,

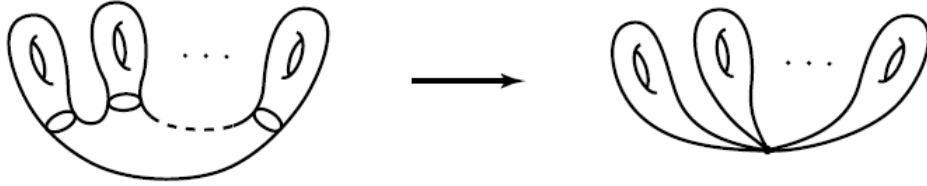
$$\alpha_i \smile \alpha_j = \beta_i \smile \beta_j = 0.$$

Let

$$X = T_1 \vee \dots \vee T_g$$

be a wedge sum of g copies of the torus $T_i \cong S^1 \times S^1$. By collapsing the complement of the g handles of Σ to the wedge point, we obtain a quotient map

$$q : \Sigma \rightarrow X, \quad p_i : X \rightarrow T_i.$$



Genus g surface collapsing into wedge of torus. Picture from Hatcher.

For each i , let $H^1(T_i) = \mathbb{Z}x_i \oplus \mathbb{Z}y_i$ be the generators, and let $u_i \in H^2(T_i)$ be the generator such that

$$x_i \smile y_i = u_i, \quad y_i \smile x_i = -u_i, \quad x_i \smile x_i = y_i \smile y_i = 0.$$

We also regard these classes as classes on X via the inclusions

$$p_i^* : H^*(T_i) \hookrightarrow H^*(X).$$

Since X is a wedge sum, all cup products between positive-degree classes coming from different wedge summands vanish. Hence for $i \neq j$ we have

$$x_i \smile x_j = 0, \quad y_i \smile y_j = 0, \quad x_i \smile y_j = 0.$$

Now define

$$\alpha_i := q^*(x_i), \quad \beta_i := q^*(y_i) \in H^1(\Sigma).$$

Since q identifies the 1-skeleton of Σ with the wedge of the $2g$ circles underlying the g tori, the classes $\alpha_1, \beta_1, \dots, \alpha_g, \beta_g$ form a basis of $H^1(\Sigma)$.

Next, let $[\Sigma] \in H_2(\Sigma)$ be a generator. Under the map q_* , we have

$$q_*[\Sigma] = \pm u_1 + \dots + \pm u_g \in H_2(X) \cong \bigoplus H_2(T_i).$$

By rearrange the sign of x_i, y_i, u_i , we may assume that for every i ,

$$\langle q^* u_i, [\Sigma] \rangle = \langle u_i, q_*[\Sigma] \rangle = 1,$$

i.e. $q_*[\Sigma] = u_1 + \dots + u_g$. Since $H^2(\Sigma; \mathbb{Z}) \cong \mathbb{Z}$, it follows that all $q^* u_i$ are equal to the same generator $\omega \in H^2(\Sigma; \mathbb{Z})$.

Hence

$$\alpha_i \smile \beta_i = q^*(x_i \smile y_i) = q^*(u_i) = \omega, \quad \beta_i \smile \alpha_i = q^*(y_i \smile x_i) = -q^*(u_i) = -\omega,$$

and for $i \neq j$, $\alpha_i \smile \beta_j = 0$.

Similarly,

$$\alpha_i \smile \alpha_j = q^*(x_i \smile x_j) = 0, \quad \alpha_i \smile \alpha_i = \beta_i \smile \beta_j = \beta_i \smile \beta_i = 0.$$

The following discussion will assume you know differential forms and de Rham theorem; feel free to skip it.

Example 10.41. Here, in terms of de Rham theorem (though we didn't completely prove it), we compute $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n; \mathbb{R}) \simeq H_{dR}^*(\mathbb{C}P^n)$. We refer to [Bre93, Section 3.9] for more details.

There exists a differential 2-form called the Fubini-Study form ω , which is closed and non-exact since it is a Volume form on the compact manifold $\mathbb{C}P^1$ (you can do this by direct computation). In general, $\omega^{\wedge k}$ are also closed and non-exact since they are a volume form on $\mathbb{C}P^k$ (in that case, you can do it by Calibration theory). Then all of $[\omega]^k$ generates $H_{dR}^{2k} \mathbb{C}P^n$ for $k = 0, 1, \dots, n$. Moreover, by degree reason, we have $[\omega]^{n+1} = 0$.

Therefore, we have $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n; \mathbb{R}) \cong H_{dR}^*(\mathbb{C}P^n) \cong \mathbb{R}[x]/(x^{n+1})$ for $x = [\omega]$.

Remark 10.42. We also have $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{n+1})$. The main non-trivial ingredient here is to show that x^k are generators for the generator x of $H^2(\mathbb{C}P^n)$ (where we use some non-trivial integral computation in the de Rham theory). We will give a proof using the Poincaré duality Example 11.40.

Exercise 10.43. * Show that if M is a compact symplectic manifold, then $H^{2k}(M)$ are non-trivial for $k = 0, 1, \dots, \dim M$.

11. MANIFOLD AND POINCARÉ DUALITY

In this section, we study topological manifolds. Importantly, we explain the Poincaré duality.

11.1. Poincaré duality.

Definition 11.1. A Hausdorff and second countable topological space M is called a topological n -manifold if for every $x \in M$, there exists an open neighborhood $U \subset M$ of x and a homeomorphism

$$\varphi : U \xrightarrow{\sim} V$$

onto an open subset $V \subset \mathbb{R}^n$.

Such a pair (U, φ) is called a chart around x .

Remark 11.2. We only consider manifolds without boundary here. You may consult for references for the definition of manifolds with boundary (or with corner in general).

Example 11.3. The spaces $\mathbb{R}^n$, S^n , and every open subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$ are topological n -manifolds. Closed surface is a topological 2-manifold (in fact, this is the actual definition for surfaces).

Recall that in Remark 4.41, we already saw that local homology should be useful for manifolds. Now we prove it.

Proposition 11.4. Let M be a topological n -manifold and $x \in M$, and a commutative ring R . Let $j_x : M \setminus \{x\} \hookrightarrow M$ be the open inclusion, then

$$H_n(C(j_x); R) \cong R, \quad H_q(C(j_x); R) \cong 0, \quad \forall q \neq n.$$

Proof. After picking a chart $\varphi : U \xrightarrow{\sim} V \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ with $x \in U$. By shrinking U if necessary, we may assume that there exists an open ball $B \subset V$ centered at $\varphi(x)$ such that $\overline{B} \subset V$. Set

$$D := \varphi^{-1}(\overline{B}) \subset U.$$

Then $D \cong D^n$ and $x \in \text{Int}(D)$.

Then all the rest follows from the same excision argument as Proposition 4.40. $\square$

Supplement material 11.5. Topological spaces that satisfy the conclusion of Proposition 11.4 are called homology manifolds, and then the proposition can be interpreted by: Topological manifolds are homology manifolds.

However, there exist homology manifolds that are not topological manifolds: Take P to be the homology n -sphere (it is misleading that a homology n -sphere is a topological manifold), which is a topological manifold that satisfies $H_q(P) \cong H_q(S^n)$. Then its suspension ΣP is a homology manifold. But, ΣP is not a topological manifold except $P = S^n$.

There indeed exists a homology n -sphere P that is not S^n , the most famous examples come from Poincaré. The Poincaré duality exactly comes from his study of those homology spheres. The study eventually leads to the Poincaré conjecture, which was solved by Perelman, which claims that a homology 3-sphere P is literally a sphere when $\pi_1(P)$ is trivial.

However, another interesting side of the story is that the double suspension theorem of Edwards–Cannon tells $\Sigma^2 P \cong S^{n+2}$, which is a topological manifold.

Exercise 11.6. * Show that if P is a homology n -sphere, i.e. is a topological manifold that satisfies $H_q(P) \cong H_q(S^n)$, then for $M = \Sigma P$, the conclusion of Proposition 11.4 is true. I.e. ΣP is a homology manifold.

On the other hand, show that $M = \Sigma P$ is a topological manifold if $P \cong S^n$, and if $M = \Sigma P$ is a topological manifold, then $P \cong S^n$ (here, you may want to conclude $P \cong S^n$, this is the content of the generalized Poincaré conjecture, which is true, but more difficult to prove).

Definition 11.7. M be a topological n -manifold and $x \in M$. A generator

$$\mu_x \in H_n(C(j_x); R) \cong R$$

is called a local R -orientation of M at x .

Remark 11.8. By Proposition 11.4, at each point there are exactly two choices of local $\mathbb{Z}$ -orientations, namely μ_x and $-\mu_x$. If R is of characteristic 2, then only one choice of local R -orientation.

Now, we ask whether one can choose local orientations coherently.

Definition 11.9. Let M be a topological n -manifold and R be a unital commutative ring. An R -orientation of M is a map

$$M \rightarrow \bigsqcup_{x \in M} H_n(C(j_x); R), \quad x \mapsto \mu_x,$$

such that each μ_x is a local R -orientation at x , and this is coherent in the sense: for every $x \in M$, there exists an open neighborhood $j_U : U \rightarrow M$ of x and a class

$$\mu_U \in H_n(C(j_U); R)$$

whose image under

$$H_n(C(j_U); R) \rightarrow H_n(C(j_y); R)$$

is μ_y for every $y \in U$.

If M admits an R -orientation, then we call M R -orientable. We simply say orientable/orientation if $R = \mathbb{Z}$.

Remark 11.10. The notion is compatible with the notion of orientation for smooth manifold. However, we need more effort to prove the coincidence. Let's omit it here.

Example 11.11. The space $\mathbb{R}^n$ is orientable. For every x , we define the translation map $T_x(v) = v + x$.

We pick $\mu \in H_n(C(j_0)) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ a generator, and then define

$$\mu_x := (T_x)_n(\mu) \in H_n(C(j_x)),$$

which is a generator since T_x are homeomorphisms for all x .

To show the compatibility, at $0 \in \mathbb{R}^n$, we pick $E = E^n$ be an open ball of radius 1 centered at 0, then $H_n(C(j_E)) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ and by naturality of excision we can pick a generator μ_E such that the image of μ_E under

$$H_n(C(j_E)) \rightarrow H_n(C(j_0))$$

is μ_0 .

We set $U_0 = E$, $U_x = T_x(U_0)$, and

$$\mu_{U_x} = (T_x)_n(\mu_E) : H_n(C(j_{U_0})) \xrightarrow{\cong} H_n(C(j_{U_x})).$$

Exercise 11.12. Check the every $y \in U_x$, the image of μ_{U_x} under

$$H_n(C(j_{U_x})) \rightarrow H_n(C(j_y))$$

is exactly μ_y . And then conclude that $\mathbb{R}^n$ is $\mathbb{Z}$ -orientable.

Exercise 11.13. Show that S^n is $\mathbb{Z}$ -orientable.

Remark 11.14. If M is connected and orientable, then M has exactly two $\mathbb{Z}$ -orientations.

Exercise 11.15. Using the universal coefficient theorem Theorem 10.12 (in fact, the pair version, which is still true following the original argument) to show that if M is $\mathbb{Z}$ -orientable, then M is R -orientable for every commutative ring R .

Exercise 11.16. For commutative ring R is characteristic 2, for example $\mathbb{F}_2$, show that any manifolds are R -orientable. Hint: point here is $\mu_x = -\mu_x$, you have no choice for local-orientation.

Remark 11.17. Every manifold M has an orientable two-sheeted covering space $\tilde{M}$. For instance $\mathbb{R}P^2$ is not orientable (see 11.21), but it is covered by the orientable S^2 . The general construction is:

$$\tilde{M} = \{\mu_x \in H_n(C(j_x)) \mid x \in M \text{ and } \mu_x \text{ is a local orientation of } M \text{ at } x\}.$$

The assignment $\mu_x \mapsto x$ gives a map $\tilde{M} \rightarrow M$. Let's topologize $\tilde{M}$: if $U \subseteq X$ is an open subset homeomorphic to an open ball of $\mathbb{R}^n$ (with inclusion map $j_U : U \hookrightarrow X$), choose a generator μ_U of $H_n(C(j_U)) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$, and let $U(\mu_U)$ be the set of all $\mu_x \in \tilde{M}$ such that $x \in U$ and μ_x is the image of μ_U under the map $H_n(C(j_U)) \rightarrow H_n(C(j_x))$. One can check that the $U(\mu_U)$ form a basis of a topology on $\tilde{M}$ such that the projection $\tilde{M} \rightarrow M$ is a two-sheeted covering space. If j_{μ_x} is the embedding $\tilde{M} \setminus \{\mu_x\} \hookrightarrow \tilde{M}$, check that we have the natural isomorphism $H_n(C(j_{\mu_x})) \simeq H_n(C(j_x))$, under which each point $\mu_x \in \tilde{M}$ has a canonical local orientation $\tilde{\mu}_x$ corresponding to μ_x via this isomorphism, and this makes $\tilde{M}$ orientable.

As a consequence, we have the following result:

Proposition 11.18. *If M is connected, M is orientable if and only if $\tilde{M}$ has two connected components. In particular, any simply connected manifold is orientable. More generally, if M is connected and $\pi_1(M)$ has no subgroup of index 2, then it is orientable.*

The following theorem is pretty fundamental:

Theorem 11.19. *Let M be a connected compact topological n -manifold.*

- (1) *If M is R -orientable, then $H_n(M; R) \rightarrow H_n(C(j_x); R) \cong R$ is an isomorphism for every $x \in M$.*
- (2) *If M is not R -orientable, then $H_n(M; R) \rightarrow H_n(C(j_x); R) \cong R$ is injective with image $\{r \mid 2r = 0\}$ for every $x \in M$.*
- (3) *$H_q(M; R) = 0$ for $q > n$.*

In other words, the condition $H_n(M; R) \cong R$ is equivalent to M being R -orientable, and a choice of a generator for $H_n(M; R) \cong R$ is equivalent to giving an R -orientation of M .

Remark 11.20. Its proof is long enough. As we will omit many proofs in this section, it is fine to start from this one. You may consult [Hat02, Theorem 3.26]. Notice that in Hatcher, the author actually states and proves the result for $H_n(M, M \setminus \{x\}; R)$ instead of $H_n(C(j_x), R)$. If you know what relative homology is, you shall know that they are in fact naturally isomorphic (see 12.16).

Example 11.21. By this theorem, we know that the genus g surface Σ as well as the complex projective space $\mathbb{C}P^n$ are orientable. Moreover, the real projective space $\mathbb{R}P^n$ is orientable if and only if n is odd.

Definition 11.22. Let M be a connected R -oriented (here, it means that we fix one orientation already) compact n -manifold. Then the class

$$[M] \in H_n(M; R),$$

whose image in $H_n(C(j_{U_x}); R)$ is μ_x , is called the fundamental class of M (of the given orientation.)

Exercise 11.23. Let M be a connected compact n -manifold that is R -orientable. Show that if $[M]$ is a fundamental class of one orientation, then $-[M]$ is the fundamental class of another orientation (call the opposite orientation).

For compact manifolds, we have the following technical result that is very useful.

Theorem 11.24. *A compact topological manifold X of dimension not equals to 4 is homotopy equivalent to a finite CW complex. Consequently, $H_q(X)$ and $H^q(X)$ are finitely generated abelian groups for all q . So $b_q(X)$ are well-defined for compact manifolds.*

Exercise 11.25. Show that if $\dim X = 4$, then $H_q(X)$ and $H^q(X)$ are finitely generated abelian groups for all q . Hint: Consider $X \times S^1$, and show it is a compact topological manifold of dimension 5. Then you can use the Künneth formula.

Supplement material 11.26. There are some subtlety here. When X is a non-compact manifold, then X is homotopy equivalent to a CW complex that has at most countable q -cells for every $q \leq \dim X$. So, the only unknown case will be compact topological manifold of $\dim = 4$ (anyway, we know finiteness for (co)homology by the exercise). In this case, the good story is that if X is compact smooth manifold, then we know X is homotopy equivalent to a finite CW complex. It is more subtle to ask Δ -complex structure (triangulation), it is proven by Manolescu using Seiberg-Witten theory that there exists for every $n \geq 5$ an topological n -manifold that do not have a Δ -complex structure. Meanwhile, all smooth manifolds admit a Δ -complex structure.

Exercise 11.27. If M is a connected compact topological n -manifold such that M is orientable, then $H_{n-1}(M)$ (as a finitely generated abelian group) is free, and if M is not orientable, then $H_{n-1}(M) \cong \mathbb{Z}^r \oplus \mathbb{Z}/2$. Hint: use the universal coefficient theorem Theorem 2.28.

Consequently, by the universal coefficient theorem Theorem 10.12, we have $H^n(M) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ when M is orientable and $H^n(M) \cong \mathbb{Z}/2$ when M is non-orientable. Then M is orientable if and only if $H^n(M) \cong \mathbb{Z}$, and when M is orientable, there exists a unique element in $H^n(M)$ corresponding $[M] \in H_n(M)$, which is still denoted by $[M] \in H^n(M)$ sometime, and we call it (cohomological) fundamental class.

Exercise 11.28. Previously, we constructed an explicit generator for $H_n(S^n)$, say $[\sigma_{S^n}]$, see Exercise 4.18. Show that it is the fundamental class for an orientation of S^n .

Supplement material 11.29. In the example for sphere, where we put a Δ -complex structure, we see that its fundamental class can be computed by a suitable sum of all top dimension singular simplexes of the Δ -complex structure.

The construction works in general: Suppose a compact oriented topological n -manifold M has a Δ -complex structure (then it must be finite), we can construct the following n -chain

$$\sigma_M = \sum_{\alpha} \varepsilon_{\alpha} \varphi_{\alpha}^n,$$

where $\varepsilon_{\alpha} = \pm 1$ is determined in the following way: we take $\varepsilon_{\alpha} = 1$ (resp. -1) if for some $x \in \varphi_{\alpha}^n(\text{Int}(\Delta^n))$ we have that $[\varphi_{\alpha}^n] \in H_n(C(j_x))$ coincides (resp. opposite) with the local orientation μ_x determined by the orientation of M .

Then one can check that $\partial \sigma_M = 0$ and $[\sigma_M] = [M]$ for the given orientation.

It explains the strange sign in Exercise 2.18, and you may also see from this construction why any manifold that is equipped with a Δ -complex structure is $\mathbb{F}_2$ -oriented. Another similar example can be found in Example 11.36.

This combinatorial approach is closer to the original approach of Poincaré on his duality theorem.

Supplement material 11.30. Fundamental class also provides fruitful examples of homology class in manifolds: If $i : Y \rightarrow M$ is a submanifold of a manifold M , and Y is compact oriented, $i_*[Y] \in H_{\dim Y}(M)$ is a homology class in M , and it is often non-trivial. It is interesting to know if every homology class in $H_q(M)$ can be realized by a submanifold class in this way, which is known to be false in general (some examples are given by Thom using the Steenrod square [Tho54]).

There are many further discussions here: 1) It is proven by Thom [Tho54] that for all homology classes z , there exists $l \in \mathbb{N}$ such that lz is realized by a submanifold $i_*[Y] = lz$. 2) For every homology class, Zinger [Zin08] proves that one can realize it by a pseudo-cycle, which has application in differential geometry definition for the virtual fundamental class of Gromov-Witten invariant. 3) In the case of projective varieties, a similar question about algebraic cycles is known as the Hodge conjecture, which is still widely open.

Recall the results in Exercise 10.29, which we combine with Definition 11.22 to formula the following theorem

Theorem 11.31 (Poincaré duality). *Let M be a connected closed R -oriented topological n -manifold. Then cap product with the fundamental class induces an isomorphism*

$$PD : H^q(M; R) \xrightarrow{\sim} H_{n-q}(M; R), \quad PD(c) := c \frown [M]$$

for every q .

Idea of the proof. Again, we will not prove it. See [Hat02, Section 3.3].

The idea for the proof is that both sides of the equivalence form cosheaves on M ; and to check they are isomorphic cosheaves, you only need to compare their costalks, which can be easily seen from homology/cohomology of small balls.

Also notice that in Hatcher, he proves the result using $H_n(M, M \setminus K; R)$ where $K \subset M$ is compact, you can safely run his argument for $H_n(C(M \setminus K \hookrightarrow M))$. $\square$

Supplement material 11.32. The modern form of Poincaré duality is much much far from the result. One version is the Verdier duality, which you might learn in the sheaf theory. Another one is Lurie's covariant Verdier duality, which states an equivalence between the sheaf category and the cosheaf category under mild conditions.

Exercise 11.33. * If M is a compact oriented manifold with a Δ -complex structure, and we take the fundamental cycle σ_M constructed in Supplement material 11.29. We set $[f_{i_0}, \dots, f_{i_k}]_\alpha : \Delta^k \xrightarrow{[v_{i_0}, \dots, v_{i_k}]} \Delta^n \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha^n} X$, then show that

$$PD([c]) = [c] \cap [\sigma_M] = \sum_{\alpha} c([f_0, \dots, f_q]_\alpha) [f_q, \dots, f_n]_\alpha.$$

We will see a precise example for the computation in Example 11.36.

You may draw some picture to see the relation of the formula and dual graph (in the graph theory sense).

11.2. Examples and applications.

Exercise 11.34. Let M be a connected closed oriented n -manifold. Recall that we can define the Betti number $b_q(X) = b^q(X)$ as the rank of the corresponding homology or cohomology (See Theorem 11.24, Exercise 10.16).

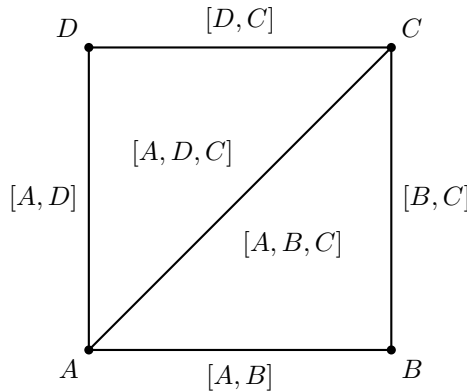
Show that 1) $b_q(M) = b_{n-q}(M)$ for all q ; 2) If M is odd dimension, then $\chi(M) = 0$.

One interesting application is that you can use Poincaré duality to distinguish manifolds.

Exercise 11.35. Show that $S^2 \vee S^2$ is not a manifold. Hint: Use $\mathbb{F}_2$ -coefficient and apply the Poincaré duality.

Example 11.36. Here, let us compute the $PD : H^1(T^2) \rightarrow H_1(T^2)$.

As in Example 4.34, we think T^2 as the quotient of $[0, 1]^2$ by identify certain edges, we denote $q : [0, 1]^2 \rightarrow T^2$:



We set $p_1, p_2 : T^2 = S^1 \times S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ projections. Let $u \in H^1(S^1)$ be a generator, and set

$$\alpha := p_1^*(u), \quad \beta := p_2^*(u) \in H^1(T^2).$$

We know they are generators of $H^1(T^2)$.

Let $i_1 : S^1 \rightarrow T^2, t \mapsto (t, 0)$, $i_2 : S^1 \rightarrow T^2, t \mapsto (0, t)$, and a $[S^1]$ be the fundamental class of S^1 , then

$$a = (i_1)_*([S^1]) = [S^1 \times \{*\}], \quad b = (i_2)_*([S^1]) = [\{*\} \times S^1] \in H_1(T^2),$$

then, after choosing the fundamental class $[T^2] \in H_2(T^2)$ as below, we will show that

$$\alpha \frown [T^2] = b, \quad \beta \frown [T^2] = -a.$$

We compute directly from the chain-level definition of cap product given in Exercise 10.29, especially, the compatibility

$$\langle c \smile d, \sigma \rangle = \langle c, d \frown \sigma \rangle.$$

Write

$$A = (0, 0), \quad B = (1, 0), \quad C = (1, 1), \quad D = (0, 1).$$

Consider the two singular 2-simplexes

$$\sigma_U := q \circ [A, B, C], \quad \sigma_L := q \circ [A, D, C],$$

and define

$$z := \sigma_U - \sigma_L \in S_2(T^2).$$

We claim that z is a 2-cycle by direct computation.

Indeed,

$$\partial \sigma_U = q_{\#}([B, C] - [A, C] + [A, B]), \quad \partial \sigma_L = q_{\#}([D, C] - [A, C] + [A, D])$$

Hence

$$\partial z = q_{\#}([B, C] - [D, C] + [A, B] - [A, D]).$$

But in the quotient T^2 we have

$$q_{\#}[B, C] = q_{\#}[A, D], \quad q_{\#}[D, C] = q_{\#}[A, B],$$

so $\partial z = 0$. Moreover, the cycle represent the 2-cell I^2 , then we know $[z] \in H_2(T^2)$ is a generator, and we can find an orientation to make it a fundamental class $[z] = [T^2]$.

Now define 1-cycles

$$a := q_{\#}[A, B], \quad b := q_{\#}[A, D].$$

These represent the two generators of $H_1(T^2)$ coming from the two S^1 -factors.

Next we evaluate α and β on the relevant edges. Since

$$\alpha = p_1^*(u), \quad \beta = p_2^*(u),$$

we have

$$\alpha([A, B]) = 1, \quad \alpha([A, D]) = 0, \quad \alpha([A, C]) = 1,$$

and

$$\beta([A, B]) = 0, \quad \beta([A, D]) = 1, \quad \beta([A, C]) = 1.$$

Geometrically, α measures winding in the first factor, while β measures winding in the second factor.

We now compute the cap products. Since $\alpha, \beta \in S^1(T^2)$ and $z \in S_2(T^2)$, for a singular 2-simplex σ we have

$$c \frown \sigma = c(1\sigma) \sigma_1.$$

First, for α :

$$1\sigma_U = [A, B], \quad (\sigma_U)_1 = [B, C],$$

hence

$$\alpha \frown \sigma_U = \alpha([A, B])[B, C] = [B, C].$$

Also,

$$1\sigma_L = [A, D], \quad (\sigma_L)_1 = [D, C],$$

so

$$\alpha \frown \sigma_L = \alpha([A, D])[D, C] = 0.$$

Therefore

$$\alpha \frown z = [B, C].$$

In T^2 , the right vertical edge $[B, C]$ is identified with the left vertical edge $[A, D]$, so

$$[\alpha \frown z] = b.$$

Thus

$$\alpha \frown [z] = b.$$

Next, for β : similarly, we have

$$\beta \frown z = 0 - [D, C].$$

Since the top horizontal edge $[D, C]$ is identified with the bottom horizontal edge $[A, B]$, we get

$$[\beta \frown z] = -a.$$

Thus

$$\beta \frown [z] = -a.$$

So, with the orientation represented by the cycle $z = \sigma_U - \sigma_L$, we obtain

$$\alpha \frown [T^2] = b, \quad \beta \frown [T^2] = -a.$$

Exercise 11.37. Compare to Example 10.40, compute $PD : H^1(\Sigma) \rightarrow H_1(\Sigma)$ for genus g surface using above computation Example 11.36: For the generator α_i, β_i of $H^1(\Sigma)$, we have $PD(\alpha_i) = b_i$ and $PD(\beta_i) = -a_i$, where a_i, b_i represent corresponding cycles in the gluing diagram in Exercise 4.36. You may also need Exercise 10.29-(4).

Our computation motivates the following definition.

Exercise 11.38. Let M be an compact oriented topological n -manifold. We define the following pairing, which is still denoted by $\smile$,

$$\smile : H^{n-p}(M) \times H^p(M) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad (a, b) \mapsto \langle a \smile b, [M] \rangle.$$

On the other hand, in Exercise 10.11, we have that the dual pairing

$$\kappa : H^p(X) \otimes H_p(X) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z},$$

which is generally not perfect due to the universal coefficient theorem.

(1) Show that we have the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H^p(M) \times H^{n-p}(M) & \xrightarrow{\smile} & \mathbb{Z} \\ \downarrow \text{id} \otimes PD & & \downarrow \\ H^p(M) \times H_p(M) & \xrightarrow{\kappa} & \mathbb{Z} \end{array}$$

(2) Show the pairing $\smile$ induces a perfect pairing

$$H^p(M)_{\text{free}} \times H^{n-p}(M)_{\text{free}} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad (a, b) \mapsto \langle a \smile b, [M] \rangle,$$

and then where A_{free} means the free part of the finitely generated abelian group A .

Similarly, we have for a field $\mathbb{F}$

$$H^p(M; \mathbb{F}) \times H^{n-p}(M; \mathbb{F}) \rightarrow \mathbb{F}, \quad (a, b) \mapsto \langle a \smile b, [M] \rangle$$

is perfect.

Hint: Use the universal coefficient theorem Theorem 10.12 and Exercise 10.29-(3).

(3) Show that for a $2n$ -dimensional manifold M , we have $\smile : H^n(M) \times H^n(M) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is symmetric if $2n = 4k$ and anti-symmetric if $2n = 4k + 2$.

For example, for the genus g curve, the matrix of the pairing under the bases we constructed in Example 10.40 is $\begin{pmatrix} 0 & I_g \\ -I_g & 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

(4) * For a $2n = 4k + 2$ dimensional compact oriented manifold M , we have $\chi(M)$ is even. Notice that this is NOT true for non-oriented manifolds, for example $\chi(\mathbb{R}P^2) = 1$.

Supplement material 11.39. To certain manifolds, the pairing $\smile$ is crucial. For example, Freedman shows that for simply connected 4-dimensional topological manifolds (simply connected implies orientability), their homeomorphism class is determined by the pairing $\smile$.

Example 11.40. We already know that $\mathbb{C}P^n$ is a $2n$ -dimension manifold, and $H_{2n}(\mathbb{C}P^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ shows that $\mathbb{C}P^n$ is orientable, so we can use Poincaré duality for it.

Here, we show the cohomology ring of $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n)$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{n+1})$ using the Poincaré duality, and moreover we can pick x such that have $PD(x^n) = [\text{pt}]$. We will actually compute the Poincaré duality $PD(x^k)$ for $k = 0, \dots, n$.

We prove it by induction. When $n = 1$, we know $\mathbb{C}P^1 \cong S^2$, and then $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^1) = H^*(S^2) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^2)$ for $|x| = 2$ by Example 10.25 and we pick orientation of S^2 such that $PD(x) = [p]$.

Now, consider the higher dimension.

As the induction hypothesis, we assume $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{n+1})$ with $PD(x^n) = x^n \frown [\mathbb{C}P^n] = [\text{pt}]$.

We consider the (hyperplane) embedding

$$i : \mathbb{C}P^n \rightarrow \mathbb{C}P^{n+1}, \quad [z_0, \dots, z_n] \rightarrow [z_0, \dots, z_n, 0].$$

Then we have a ring homomorphism

$$i^* : H^*(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}) \rightarrow H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n),$$

and by the cellular homology computation, or the dual version of mapping cone sequence computation, we know that i^q is a group isomorphism for $0 \leq q \leq 2n$. In particular, we may write $H^{2k}(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}) = \mathbb{Z}[y^k]$ for $0 \leq k \leq n$ for $x^k = i^*(y^k)$, since x^k is a generator of $H^{2k}(\mathbb{C}P^n)$ by the induction hypothesis.

Now, by Exercise 10.29-(2), we have

$$\langle y^{n+1}, [\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}] \rangle = \langle y^n, y \frown [\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}] \rangle = \langle y^n, PD(y) \rangle.$$

(The non trivial place:) In this formula, we have that $PD(y) \in H_{2n}(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1})$ is a generator since $PD : H^2 \rightarrow H_{2n}$ is an isomorphism between abelian groups.

On the other hand, we know y^n is a generator of $H^{2n}(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1})$. Therefore, by Exercise 11.38-(2), the pairing

$$\langle y^{n+1}, [\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}] \rangle = \langle y^n, PD(y) \rangle = \pm 1,$$

and then we have y^{n+1} is a generator of $H^{2n+2}(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1})$. Moreover, we can always assume it equals 1 by taking a suitable orientation $[\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}]$.

Consequently, we have

$$H^*(\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}) \cong \mathbb{Z}[y]/(y^{n+2}), \quad \langle 1, y^{n+1} \frown [\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}] \rangle = \langle y^{n+1}, [\mathbb{C}P^{n+1}] \rangle = 1$$

which finish the induction.

Now, we compute the Poincaré duality (go back to $\mathbb{C}P^n$ and $\mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{n+1})$).

Similar to the previous i , we set the subspace embedding to be $i_k : \mathbb{C}P^{n-k} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}P^n$, $[z_0, \dots, z_{n-k}] \rightarrow [z_0, \dots, z_{n-k}, \dots, 0]$. We claim that $PD(x^k) = (i_k)_*[\mathbb{C}P^{n-k}]$.

Indeed, both classes lie in $H_{2n-2k}(\mathbb{C}P^n) \cong \mathbb{Z}$, so it is enough show their pairing with the generator $x^{n-k} \in H^{2n-2k}(\mathbb{C}P^n)$ are both 1: On one hand, we have

$$\langle x^{n-k}, PD(x^k) \rangle = \langle x^{n-k}, x^k \frown [\mathbb{C}P^n] \rangle = \langle x^n, [\mathbb{C}P^n] \rangle = 1,$$

on the other hand, we have

$$\langle x^{n-k}, (i_k)_*[\mathbb{C}P^{n-k}] \rangle = \langle i_k^*(x^{n-k}), [\mathbb{C}P^{n-k}] \rangle = \langle x^{n-k}, [\mathbb{C}P^{n-k}] \rangle = 1.$$

Therefore, we have

$$PD(x^k) = (i_k)_*[\mathbb{C}P^{n-k}],$$

as claimed.

Remark 11.41. Here, try to compare Example 10.41 as explained in Remark 10.42.

Notice that we prove this fact in $\mathbb{R}$ -coefficient using a certain integration trick, which indicates the deep relation between Poincaré duality and integration of differential forms. In fact, we can develop the entire de Rham version of Poincaré duality using integration, this is the topic of [BT82].

Exercise 11.42. * Show that $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^\infty) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x]$ with $|x| = 2$. The ring is useful when you study the first Chern class and the S^1 -equivariant cohomology.

Exercise 11.43. Using the $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^{2n}) \cong \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{2n+1})$ to show that there is no homotopy equivalence $f : \mathbb{C}P^{2n} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}P^{2n}$ such that f^{4n} maps x^{2n} to $-x^{2n}$.

Here, we notice that $x^{2n} = [\mathbb{C}P^{2n}]$ (the RHS means the cohomological fundamental class here) for an orientation. Then the exercise tells that all homotopy equivalences of $\mathbb{C}P^{2n}$ preserve the orientation of $\mathbb{C}P^{2n}$.

Exercise 11.44. Now, you may be strong enough to prove by yourself the ring isomorphism $H^*(\mathbb{R}P^n, \mathbb{F}_2) \cong \mathbb{F}_2[x]/(x^{n+1})$ with $|x| = 1$.

Supplement material 11.45. We mention a dual point of view for the pairing (in the language of differential topology). Let M be an oriented compact n -dimensional smooth manifold. We define the following pairing, which is called the intersection product,

$$\cap : H_{n-p}(M) \otimes H_{n-q}(M) \rightarrow H_{n-p-q}(M)$$

by the following diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H^p(M) \times H^q(M) & \xrightarrow{\smile} & H^{p+q}(M) \\ \downarrow PD \otimes PD & & \downarrow PD \\ H_{n-p}(M) \times H_{n-q}(M) & \xrightarrow{\cap} & H_{n-p-q}(M) \end{array}$$

The interesting thing is that for chains represented by submanifolds, we can compute the intersection product by geometric intersection (counted algebraically):

Let $i : X \rightarrow M$, $j : Y \rightarrow M$ are oriented compact smooth submanifolds. We want to compute $i_*[X] \cap j_*[Y]$ (the intersection product, not the set theoretical intersection).

We assume that $di_p \oplus dj_p : T_p X \oplus T_p Y \rightarrow T_p M$ is surjective for all $p \in X \cap Y$, i.e. X and Y intersect transversely. This is an gentle assumption: By Thom's transversality theory, we can always pick a small perturbation of i, j such that the transversality condition is satisfied and the cycles $i_*[X], j_*[Y]$ do not change.

In this case, we have that $k : X \cap Y \rightarrow M$ is a submanifold of dimension $n - \dim X - \dim Y$, and there exists a unique orientation such that $T_p M \cong T_p X \oplus T_p Y / T_p(X \cap Y)$ is orientation preserving, and we take the class $k_*[X \cap Y]$ for this orientation. We define $i_*[X] \cap j_*[Y] := k_*[X \cap Y]$. The main theorem here is that $PD^{-1}(i_*[X] \cap j_*[Y]) = PD^{-1}(i_*[X]) \smile PD^{-1}(j_*[Y])$ [Bre93, Chapter IV, Theorem 11.9]. It gives a geometric interpretation of the cup product.

For example, when $\dim X + \dim Y = n$, transversality means that $\forall p \in X \cap Y$ the linear map $J_p = di_p \oplus dj_p$ is rank n , and in this situation $X \cap Y$ is a finite set. We set $\epsilon_p = \text{sign}(\det(J_p))$, then we have

$$i_*[X] \cap j_*[Y] = \sum_{p \in X \cap Y} \epsilon_p [\text{pt}] \in \mathbb{Z} \cong H_0(M).$$

For example in T^2 (compare to Example 11.36), you can see that $PD(\alpha \smile \beta) = b \cap (-a) \in H_0(T^2)$, and a, b are represented by some S^1 . Those circles are intersected at exactly 1 point, which corresponds to $\alpha \smile \beta = [T^2]$ (be careful with the orientation). You may also try to think about how to compute the cup product of Σ_g in the geometric intersection way.

Another application of this geometric construction allow you compute the ring structure of $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n)$ differently. We set $x_k = PD^{-1}[\mathbb{C}P^{n-k}]$, where $\mathbb{C}P^{n-k} \subset \mathbb{C}P^n$ as the linear subspace, as the generator $H^{2k}(\mathbb{C}P^n)$. Then notice that a generic $n - i$ dimension ($\mathbb{C}$ -linear) subspace intersection with a generic $n - j$ dimension subspace intersection at a $n - i - j$ dimension subspace (empty if $i + j > n$), it tells you that $x_i \smile x_j = x_{i+j}$, and then we know $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n) = \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{n+1})$ again by setting $x := x_2$.

Nowadays, the intersection product is developed into intersection theory, which can be define in more settings (for example scheme or stack).

Finally, we present the Lefschetz fixed point theorem. (One of) its proof deeply relies on the Poincaré duality.

Definition 11.46. Let $f : X \rightarrow X$ be a map and assume that $H^q(X)$ are all finitely generated, then we define the Lefschetz number to be

$$\Lambda(X, f) := \sum_q (-1)^q \operatorname{Tr}[f^q : H^q(X; \mathbb{Q}) \rightarrow H^q(X, \mathbb{Q})].$$

Exercise 11.47. (1) Show that $\Lambda(X, \operatorname{id}) = \chi(X)$ when it can be defined.

(2) For $f : S^n \rightarrow S^n$, show that

$$\Lambda(X, f) = 1 + (-1)^n \deg(f).$$

Theorem 11.48. Let M be a compact oriented topological manifold, and $f : M \rightarrow M$ a map. We have that if $\Lambda(X, f) \neq 0$, then f has a fixed point.

Exercise 11.49. Let $f : \mathbb{C}P^n \rightarrow \mathbb{C}P^n$. Here we want to study existence of fixed points of f using the cohomology ring $H^*(\mathbb{C}P^n, \mathbb{Q}) \cong \mathbb{Q}[x]/(x^{n+1})$ and the Lefschetz fixed point theorem.

Show that: 1) If n is even, then f has a fixed point. 2) If n is odd, and $f^*(x) \neq -x$, then f has a fixed point.

Supplement material 11.50. You can also develop the Lefschetz fixed point theorem in other cohomology theories. For example, the Lefschetz fixed point theorem for ℓ -adic étale cohomology plays a very basic role in solving the Weil conjecture.

12. HOMOLOGY FOR PAIRS AND EXCISION PRINCIPLE

In this section, we explain homology for pairs and the excision principle. This toolkit is more or less equivalent to Mayer-Vietoris, but has certain conveniences.

In this course, we will not essentially use any tools here, so you may safely skip this section. But you may need it at some moment in your life.

12.1. Relative homology for pair and LSE. Recall that a space pair (X, A) consists of a space X and its subspace A . To a space pair where $i : A \subset X$ is the inclusion, we have defined

$$i_{\#} : S_*(A) \rightarrow S_*(X).$$

It is clear that this is a degree-wise injective chain map, and we can regard $S_*(A)$ as a sub-chain complex of $S_*(X)$ (i.e., degree-wise subgroups, and inclusion commutes with the differential since $i_{\#}$ is a chain map).

Definition 12.1. We define the singular chain for the pair (X, A) (or relative chain) to be

$$S_*(X, A) := S_*(X)/S_*(A).$$

Precisely, $S_q(X, A) = S_q(X)/S_q(A)$ and $\partial_{S_*(X, A)}$ is descended from $\partial_{S_*(X)}$.

We define $H_q(X, A)$ as $H_q(S_*(X, A))$ as the singular homology for a pair, or relative homology.

In particular, when $A = \emptyset$, $S_q(X, \emptyset) = S_q(X)$ and $H_q(X, A)$ as $H_q(X)$ that recover the absolute case.

Similarly, we may also define the reduced version of cochain $\tilde{S}^*(X; M) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\tilde{S}^*(X), M)$, and relative version $\tilde{S}^*(X, A; M) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\tilde{S}^*(X, A), M)$ and their cohomology $\tilde{H}^q(X; M)$, $H^q(X, A; M)$.

Remark 12.2. We can develop the $H_q(X, A; M)$ as well. To simply notation, we will not do it here.

Remark 12.3. In fact, $S_q(X, A) = S_q(X)/S_q(A)$ is a free abelian group generated by singular simplexes $\sigma : \Delta^q \rightarrow X$ with $\text{im}(\sigma)$ does not entirely in A . But we will keep our convention to treat it as a quotient.

Exercise 12.4. If $f : (X, A) \rightarrow (Y, B)$ is a map between pairs, try to define the induced map

$$f_{\#} = S_*(f) : S_*(X, A) \rightarrow S_*(Y, B), \quad f_q : H_q(X, A) \rightarrow H_q(Y, B).$$

Show that f_* has homotopy invariance with respect to the relative homotopy relation. Hint: Check carefully that the homotopy invariance relation descends to relative chains.

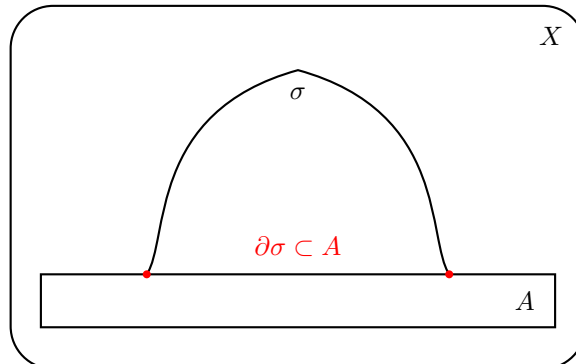
Exercise 12.5. For a pair (X, A) , we consider the following construction:

$$Z'_q(X, A) := \{c \in S_q(X) \mid \partial_q c \in S_{q-1}(A)\},$$

$$B'_q(X, A) := \text{im}(\partial_{q+1}) + S_q(A) \subset S_q(X).$$

Show that $B'_q(X, A) \subset Z'_q(X, A)$, and $H_q(X, A) \cong Z'_q(X, A)/B'_q(X, A)$.

The construction gives a more geometric intuition for thinking of homology classes of $H_q(X, A)$ as “cycles relative to A ”.



Theorem 12.6. For any space pair (X, A) , we have a long exact sequence

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_q(A) \xrightarrow{i_q} H_q(X) \xrightarrow{p_q} H_q(X, A) \xrightarrow{\partial_q} H_{q-1}(A) \rightarrow \cdots$$

If $f : (X, A) \rightarrow (Y, B)$ is a map between pairs, then f_q and $(f|_A)_q$ are natural with respect to the long exact sequence in the sense that the following diagram is commutative

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \longrightarrow & H_q(A) & \longrightarrow & H_q(X) & \longrightarrow & H_q(X, A) & \xrightarrow{\partial_q} H_{q-1}(A) \longrightarrow \\ & \downarrow (f|_A)_* & & \downarrow f_* & & \downarrow f_* & \downarrow (f|_A)_* \\ \longrightarrow & H_q(B) & \longrightarrow & H_q(Y) & \longrightarrow & H_q(X, B) & \xrightarrow{\partial_q} H_{q-1}(B) \longrightarrow \end{array}$$

Proof. By taking a degree-wise quotient, we have a degree-wise short exact sequence, which is moreover with respect to the differential

$$0 \rightarrow S_*(A) \xrightarrow{i_\#} S_*(X) \xrightarrow{p} S_*(X, A) \rightarrow 0.$$

The short exact sequence induces the long exact sequence by standard homological algebra. The naturality also follows since $f_\#$ induces chain maps between the short exact sequences

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & S_*(A) & \longrightarrow & S_*(X) & \longrightarrow & S_*(X, A) \longrightarrow 0 \\ & & \downarrow (f|_A)_\# & & \downarrow f_\# & & \downarrow f_\# \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & S_*(B) & \longrightarrow & S_*(Y) & \longrightarrow & S_*(Y, B) \longrightarrow 0 \end{array} \quad \square$$

Remark 12.7. Here, let us explain a little more about the connecting map

$$H_q(X, A) \xrightarrow{\partial_q} H_{q-1}(A)$$

It is given by

$$\partial_q([\sigma]) = [i_\#^{-1} \partial_{q,X} p^{-1} \sigma],$$

which is well defined by the argument for the snake lemma. We may compute the connecting map using the exercise below.

Exercise 12.8. Under the identification of Exercise 12.5, show that the connecting map $\partial : H_q(X, A) \rightarrow H_{q-1}(A)$ can be computed as follow: For any $z \in H_q(X, A)$, we can find $\sigma \in Z'_q(X, A)$ such that $[\sigma] = z \in Z'_q(X, A)/B'_q(X, A) \cong H_q(X, A)$, and then we have $\partial_q(z) = [\partial_q \sigma] \in H_{q-1}(A)$ (notice that $\sigma \in Z'_q(X, A)$ means that $\partial_q \sigma \in Z_{q-1}(A) \subset S_{q-1}$).

Exercise 12.9. Here, we recall subsubsection 2.4.2. Let $x \in X$ be a point, show that 1) $H_q(X, x) \simeq \tilde{H}_q(X)$ for all q . 2) $\tilde{H}_q$ also has the long exact sequence for pairs (recall the remark below).

Remark 12.10. You may also define $\tilde{H}_q(X, A) := H_q(S_*(X, a)/S_*(A, a))$ for $a \in A \subset X$. However, you do not get anything new since $S_*(X, a)/S_*(A, a) \cong S_*(X, A)$ as a chain complex. However, it may cause some convenience for some discussions.

Exercise 12.11. Let $f : (X, A) \rightarrow (Y, B)$ is a map between pairs such that $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $f|_A : A \rightarrow B$ are homotopy equivalences. Then $f_q : H_q(X, A) \rightarrow H_q(Y, B)$ are isomorphisms. Hint: Use the five lemma and the long exact sequence.

Notice that here we do not have a relative homotopy equivalence for pairs. So, this does not follow directly from the homotopy invariance. In practice, it may simplify some discussion (for example, it may be tricky to really find a relative homotopy equivalence, but easier to check two absolute homotopy equivalences).

Exercise 12.12. Write down and prove the Mayer-Vietoris sequence for relative cohomology. Notice that you may also write an MV sequence where you take intersection and union in the place of A for a pair (X, A) !

Lastly, we mention that we can study a space triple (X, A, B) where $B \subset A \subset X$, and related long exact sequences. It may give some interesting applications.

Exercise 12.13. Then show that we have the following long exact sequence

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_q(A, B) \xrightarrow{i_q} H_q(X, B) \xrightarrow{j_q} H_q(X, A) \xrightarrow{\partial_q} H_{q-1}(A, B) \rightarrow \cdots,$$

where $i : (A, B) \rightarrow (X, B)$ and $j : (X, B) \rightarrow (X, A)$.

For a morphism of triple $f : (X, A, B) \rightarrow (Y, C, D)$, we have the following commutative diagram of long exact sequences:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \cdots & \longrightarrow & H_q(A, B) & \longrightarrow & H_q(X, B) & \longrightarrow & H_q(X, A) \longrightarrow \cdots \\ & & \downarrow f_q & & \downarrow f_q & & \downarrow f_q \\ \cdots & \longrightarrow & H_q(C, D) & \longrightarrow & H_q(Y, D) & \longrightarrow & H_q(Y, C) \longrightarrow \cdots \end{array}$$

Hint: Simply repeat the proof of Theorem 12.6 for suitable chain complexes.

12.2. Excision principle. Now, we state the excision principle and prove it using the small chain theorem Theorem 4.2.

Theorem 12.14 (Excision principle). *Let (X, A) be a space pair and a subspace $U \subset A$ satisfying $\bar{U} \subset \text{Int}(A)$. Then the morphism of pairs*

$$f : (X \setminus U, A \setminus U) \hookrightarrow (X, A)$$

induces a quasi-isomorphism, i.e. isomorphisms on homologies

$$f_q : H_q(X \setminus U, A \setminus U) \xrightarrow{\cong} H_q(X, A).$$

Proof. Take $\mathcal{U} = \{X \setminus U, A\}$. Then the condition $\bar{U} \subset \text{Int}(A)$ implies that

$$\text{Int}(X \setminus U) \cup \text{Int}(A) = (X \setminus \bar{U}) \cup \text{Int}(A) = X.$$

Then we can use Theorem 4.2 to $\mathcal{U}$. Here, we take i_*, r_*

$$i_* : S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X) \subset S_*(X), \quad r_* : S_*(X) \rightarrow S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X)$$

constructed from the small chain theorem. We also notice that in this case, we have

$$S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X) = S_*(X \setminus U) + S_*(A).$$

Notice that $A \in \mathcal{U}$, so $S_*(A)$ is a sub-chain complex of $S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X)$ as well as $S_*(X)$. The condition $r_* i_* = \text{id}$ guarantee that $r_*|_{S_*(A)} = \text{id}_{S_*(A)}$. Consequently, r_* and i_* descend to chain maps

$$S_*^{\mathcal{U}}(X)/S_*(A) = [S_*(X \setminus U) + S_*(A)]/S_*(A) \hookrightarrow S_*(X)/S_*(A) = S_*(X, A).$$

Moreover, $i_* r_* \simeq \text{id}$ through F_* , and moreover $F_*(S_*(U_i)) \subset S_{*+1}(U_i)$ for all $U_i \in \mathcal{U}$. Then we have F_* also descends to a chain homotopy.

Therefore, we have i_* induces

$$H_q([S_*(X \setminus U) + S_*(A)]/S_*(A)) \cong H_q(X, A).$$

On the other hand, by the third isomorphism theorem, we have

$$S_*(X \setminus U, A \setminus U) = S_*(X \setminus U)/S_*(A \setminus U) = S_*(X \setminus U)/[S_*(X \setminus U) \cap S_*(A)] \cong [S_*(X \setminus U) + S_*(A)]/S_*(A).$$

Therefore, we have

$$H_q(X \setminus U, A \setminus U) \cong H_q([S_*(X \setminus U) + S_*(A)]/S_*(A)) \cong H_q(X, A).$$

Lastly, it remains to verify that the isomorphism is induced by f_q . We left it as an exercise. $\square$

Remark 12.15. Here, we use the small chain theorem to give a direct proof of the excision principle. You may also prove the excision principle using the Mayer-Vietoris sequence for pairs. In fact, the excision principle and the Mayer-Vietoris sequence are equivalent. But the proof for the equivalence is tricky, and we left you to explore.

Exercise 12.16. If $j : A \hookrightarrow X$ is the inclusion of a subset (not necessarily closed), show by the long exact sequence of homology of pairs 12.6 and the excision principle that we have a natural isomorphism $H_*(X, A) \simeq \tilde{H}_*(C(j))$.

To apply it more effectively, we introduce the following notion.

Definition 12.17. We say a pair (X, A) is good, if $A \subset X$ is a closed subspace and A has an open neighborhood $V \subset X$, and $A \subset V$ is a deformation retraction.

Proposition 12.18. For a good pair (X, A) , we have the quotient map $\pi : (X, A) \rightarrow (X/A, A/A)$ induces isomorphism

$$\pi_q : H_q(X, A) \simeq H_q(X/A, A/A) = \tilde{H}_q(X/A).$$

Proof. We consider the following commutative diagram induced by evident maps between pairs

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} H_q(X, A) & \xrightarrow{a} & H_q(X, V) & \xleftarrow{b} & H_q(X \setminus A, V \setminus A) \\ \downarrow \pi_q & & \downarrow \pi_q & & \downarrow \pi_q \\ H_q(X/A, A/A) & \xrightarrow{c} & H_q(X/A, V/A) & \xleftarrow{d} & H_q(X/A \setminus A/A, V/A \setminus A/A) \end{array}$$

By Exercise 12.11, we have a, c are isomorphisms. By Theorem 12.14, we have b, d are isomorphisms.

However, the right most π_q is an isomorphism since π restrict to a homeomorphism between $(X \setminus A, V \setminus A)$ and $(X/A \setminus A/A, V/A \setminus A/A)$ by definition of quotient space.

Then the left most π_q is an isomorphism by the commutativity of the diagram. $\square$

Exercise 12.19. For $n \geq 1$, we have $H_q(D^n, S^{n-1}) = \mathbb{Z}$ for $q = n$, and otherwise trivial. Hint: Use Proposition 12.18 and the computation of $\tilde{H}_q(S^n)$.

Exercise 12.20. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Consider the mapping cone $C(f)$, see Example 4.28. We can treat Y as a subspace of $C(f)$ via the map $Y \rightarrow Y \sqcup C(X) \rightarrow C(f) = (Y \sqcup C(X))/\sim$ (check this is a closed embedding), then show that $(C(f), Y)$ is a good pair and $C(f)/Y \cong \Sigma X$. Consequently, we have $\tilde{H}_q(\Sigma X) \cong H_q(C(f), Y)$, and you may prove the mapping cone sequence using the long exact sequence for pairs.

Exercise 12.21. For a CW complex X , show that (X^q, X^{q-1}) is a good pair for all $q \geq 1$. Then we have $C_q(X) \cong H_q(X^q, X^{q-1})$. This is another way to define cellular homology (try to use the previous exercise to show two definitions are equivalent).

Supplement material 12.22. We already see that homology for mapping cone and quotient are deeply related. This is a pattern of a more general notion of cofibration (see [Die08, Chapter 5]), and we use the special case: $A \rightarrow X$ is a cofibration when (X, A) is a good pair. The notion is very useful in further study of homotopy theory.

12.3. Relative cohomology.

Definition 12.23. We define the reduced version of cochain $\tilde{S}^*(X; M) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\tilde{S}_*(X), M)$, and relative version $\tilde{S}^*(X, A; M) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\tilde{S}_*(X, A), M)$ and their cohomology $\tilde{H}^q(X; M)$, $H^q(X, A; M)$.

Remark 12.24. To relative cochain $c \in S^q(X, A; M)$,

$$c : S_q(X)/S_q(A) \rightarrow M,$$

we can literally think it as a $c \in S^q(X; M)$ such that $c|_{S_q(A)} = 0$. The reason is the following: for chains, we have $S_q(X) \rightarrow S_q(X)/S_q(A)$ is a surjective homomorphism, but after applying $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(-, M)$, we have an injective homomorphism (see Exercise 10.1)

$$S^q(X, A; M) \hookrightarrow S^q(X; M),$$

whose image can be characterized by $c \in S^q(X; M)$ such that $c|_{S_q(A)} = 0$. And in the case of cochain, we have $S^q(X) \rightarrow S^q(A)$ is a quotient (looks a little weird, but this is the feature! Not a bug.)

Theorem 12.25. For a map $f : (X, A) \rightarrow (Y, B)$, we have induced cochain map $S^*(f) = f^\#$ and its cohomology $H^q(f) = f^q$

$$f^\# : S^*(Y, B) \rightarrow S^*(X, A), \quad f^q : H^q(Y, B) \rightarrow H^q(X, A),$$

which are compatible with composition.

When $f \simeq g$, we have $f^\# \simeq g^\#$ (as cochain maps), and then $f^q = g^q$.

Theorem 12.26. We have the following long exact sequences:

(1) For any space pair (X, A) , we have a long exact sequence

$$\cdots \rightarrow H^q(X, A) \xrightarrow{q} H^q(X) \xrightarrow{i^q} H^q(A) \xrightarrow{d} H^{q+1}(X, A) \rightarrow \cdots.$$

If $f : (X, A) \rightarrow (Y, B)$ is a map between pair, then f^q and $(f|_A)^q$ are natural with respect to the long exact sequence in the sense that the following diagram is commutative

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \longrightarrow & H^q(X, A) & \longrightarrow & H^q(X) & \longrightarrow & H^q(A) & \xrightarrow{d} H^{q+1}(X, A) \longrightarrow \\ & \downarrow f^* & & \downarrow f^* & & \downarrow (f|_A)^* & \downarrow f^* \\ \longrightarrow & H^q(Y, B) & \longrightarrow & H^q(Y) & \longrightarrow & H^q(B) & \xrightarrow{d} H^{q+1}(Y, B) \longrightarrow \end{array}$$

(2) Let (X, A) be a space pair and a subspace $U \subset A$ satisfying $\bar{U} \subset \text{Int}(A)$. Then the morphism of pair

$$f : (X \setminus U, A \setminus U) \hookrightarrow (X, A)$$

induces an quasi-isomorphisms, i.e. isomorphisms on homologies

$$f^q : H^q(X, A) \xrightarrow{\cong} H^q(X \setminus U, A \setminus U).$$

Proof. (1) Similar to Theorem 10.6, we only need that

$$0 \rightarrow S^*(X, A) \xrightarrow{p} S^*(X) \xrightarrow{i^\#} S^*(A) \rightarrow 0$$

is exact since $S^*(A)$ is a degree-wise free chain complex. The chain level result

(2) Simple the dual of Theorem 12.14 because we have a chain homotopy there. $\square$

Corollary 12.27. For a good pair (X, A) , we have the quotient map $\pi : (X, A) \rightarrow (X/A, A/A)$ induces isomorphism

$$\pi^q : H^q(X/A, A/A) = \tilde{H}^q(X/A) \simeq H^q(X, A).$$

12.4. Relative cup product. Here, we mention the relative cup product. Recall that the chain-level cup product is the bilinear map (written explicitly)

$$S^p(X) \otimes S^q(X) \rightarrow S^{p+q}(X), c \otimes d \mapsto c \smile d = [\sigma \in S_{p+q}(X) \mapsto c(p\sigma)d(\sigma_q)].$$

Now, as we have Remark 12.24, we regard $c \in S^p(X, A)$ as $c : S_p(X) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ that restricts to 0 on $S_p(A)$.

Lemma 12.28. Let $c \in S^p(X, A)$ and $d \in S^q(X, B)$, then for $\sigma \in S_{p+q}(A) + S_{p+q}(B) \subset S_{p+q}(X)$, we have $c \smile d(\sigma) = c(p\sigma)d(\sigma_q) = 0$.

Proof. By definition of σ we have $\sigma = \sigma_A + \sigma_B$, where $\sigma_A \in S_{p+q}(A)$ and $\sigma_B \in S_{p+q}(B)$. Without loss of generality, we assume that $\sigma = \sigma_A$. Then $p(\sigma_A) \in S_p(A)$ and $(\sigma_A)_q \in S_q(A)$. $\square$

Proposition 12.29. If A, B is a Mayer-Vietoris duo, then the chain level cup product induces a relative cup product

$$\smile : H^p(X, A) \otimes H^q(X, B) \rightarrow H^{p+q}(X, A \cup B).$$

Proof. The previous lemma shows that the chain level cup products a bilinear map

$$\smile : S^p(X, A) \otimes S^q(X, B) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_{p+q}(X)/[S_{p+q}(A) + S_{p+q}(B)], \mathbb{Z}), c \otimes d \mapsto c \smile d.$$

Moreover, $\{A, B\}$ is a Mayer-Vietoris duo, then we have the natural map

$$S_{p+q}(X)/[S_{p+q}(A) + S_{p+q}(B)] \rightarrow S_{p+q}(X)/[S_{p+q}(A \cup B)]$$

induces a quasi-isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X)/[S_*(A \cup B)], \mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(S_*(X)/[S_*(A) + S_*(B)], \mathbb{Z})$$

by the 5-lemma. Then all the rest things are routine linear algebra. $\square$

Remark 12.30. We often use the following cases, $\{A, B\} = \{A\}$ or $\{A, B\} = \{A, \emptyset\}$, where the condition of the proposition is automatically true.

Similarly, you can define relative cap product and relative cross product.

Those relative products can be use to state and prove some relative version of Poincaré duality, which is useful in study of vector bundles. For example, the Thom isomorphism theorem and Gysin sequence follows from that, and they also related to the Characteristic classes theory. We refer to [Die08, Chapter 17, 18] for more details.

APPENDIX A. CHEAT SHEET ON HOMOLOGICAL ALGEBRA

Here, we should recall exactness and useful situations. Also, the five lemma and the snake lemma. We refer to [Wei94, Chapter 1-3] for more details.

In the following, we state in the homological convention (i.e., the differential decrease degree by 1), you may easily write down the same result for the cohomological convention.

A.1. Exactness.

Definition A.1. Let

$$\cdots \xrightarrow{f_{i-1}} A_i \xrightarrow{f_i} A_{i+1} \xrightarrow{f_{i+1}} \cdots$$

be a sequence of abelian groups and group homomorphisms. We say the sequence is *exact at* A_i if

$$\text{im}(f_{i-1}) = \ker(f_i).$$

A sequence is called *exact* if it is exact at every term.

The following exact sequence of 5-terms is called a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \rightarrow 0$$

Equivalently, f is injective, g is surjective, and $\text{im}(f) = \ker(g)$.

We often split long exact sequences into many short exact sequences.

Lemma A.2. Let

$$\cdots \rightarrow A_{q+1} \xrightarrow{f_{q+1}} A_q \xrightarrow{f_q} A_{q-1} \rightarrow \cdots$$

be a long exact sequence of abelian groups. Then for every q there is a natural short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \text{coker}(f_{q+2}) \rightarrow A_q \rightarrow \ker(f_{q-1}) \rightarrow 0.$$

Definition A.3. A short exact sequence of abelian groups

$$0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \rightarrow 0$$

is said to *split* if one of the following equivalent conditions holds:

- (1) there exists a homomorphism $s : C \rightarrow B$ such that $g \circ s = \text{id}_C$;
- (2) there exists a homomorphism $r : B \rightarrow A$ such that $r \circ f = \text{id}_A$;
- (3) $B \cong A \oplus C$ and under this identification f and g are the standard inclusion and projection.

Proposition A.4. If

$$0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow 0$$

is a short exact sequence and C is a free abelian group, then the sequence splits.

Proposition A.5 (Five lemma). Consider a commutative diagram of abelian groups with exact rows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} A_1 & \longrightarrow & A_2 & \longrightarrow & A_3 & \longrightarrow & A_4 & \longrightarrow & A_5 \\ \downarrow f_1 & & \downarrow f_2 & & \downarrow f_3 & & \downarrow f_4 & & \downarrow f_5 \\ B_1 & \longrightarrow & B_2 & \longrightarrow & B_3 & \longrightarrow & B_4 & \longrightarrow & B_5. \end{array}$$

If f_1, f_2, f_4, f_5 are isomorphisms, then f_3 is an isomorphism.

Theorem A.6 (Snake lemma). Consider a commutative diagram of abelian groups

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} A & \xrightarrow{f} & B & \longrightarrow & C & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & \downarrow \alpha & \downarrow \beta & & \downarrow \gamma & & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & A' & \longrightarrow & B' & \xrightarrow{g} & C' \end{array}$$

whose rows are exact. Then there exists a natural exact sequence

$$\ker(f) \rightarrow \ker(\alpha) \rightarrow \ker(\beta) \rightarrow \ker(\gamma) \xrightarrow{\partial} \text{coker}(\alpha) \rightarrow \text{coker}(\beta) \rightarrow \text{coker}(\gamma) \rightarrow \text{coker}(g).$$

The homomorphism $\partial : \ker(\gamma) \rightarrow \text{coker}(\alpha)$ is called the connecting morphism.

A.2. Chain complexes.

Definition A.7. A chain complex (C_*, ∂_*) of abelian groups consists of a sequence of abelian groups and homomorphisms

$$\cdots \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+2}} C_{q+1} \xrightarrow{\partial_{q+1}} C_q \xrightarrow{\partial_q} C_{q-1} \xrightarrow{\partial_{q-1}} \cdots$$

such that

$$\partial_q \circ \partial_{q+1} = 0$$

for every q .

Definition A.8. Let (C_*, ∂_*^C) and (D_*, ∂_*^D) be chain complexes. A chain map $f_* : C_* \rightarrow D_*$ is a collection of homomorphisms

$$f_q : C_q \rightarrow D_q$$

for all q , such that for every q the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} C_q & \xrightarrow{\partial_q^C} & C_{q-1} \\ \downarrow f_q & & \downarrow f_{q-1} \\ D_q & \xrightarrow{\partial_q^D} & D_{q-1} \end{array}$$

that is,

$$f_{q-1} \circ \partial_q^C = \partial_q^D \circ f_q$$

for every q .

Proposition A.9. Let $f : C_* \rightarrow D_*$ be a chain map between chain complexes. Then f induces homomorphisms

$$H_q(f) : H_q(C_*) \rightarrow H_q(D_*)$$

for all q . Moreover, if $g : D_* \rightarrow E_*$ is another chain map, then

$$H_q(g \circ f) = H_q(g) \circ H_q(f), \quad H_q(\text{id}_{C_*}) = \text{id}_{H_q(C_*)}.$$

Proposition A.10. Let

$$0 \rightarrow A_* \xrightarrow{f} B_* \xrightarrow{g} C_* \rightarrow 0$$

be a short exact sequence of chain complexes. Then there is a natural long exact sequence on homology

$$\cdots \rightarrow H_q(A_*) \xrightarrow{H_q(f)} H_q(B_*) \xrightarrow{H_q(g)} H_q(C_*) \xrightarrow{\partial} H_{q-1}(A_*) \rightarrow \cdots$$

Definition A.11. Let $f, g : C_* \rightarrow D_*$ be chain maps. A chain homotopy from f to g is a family of homomorphisms

$$h_q : C_q \rightarrow D_{q+1}$$

such that

$$\partial h + h \partial = f - g.$$

In this case we write $f \simeq g$.

Proposition A.12. If two chain maps $f, g : C_* \rightarrow D_*$ are chain homotopic, then they induce the same maps on homology:

$$H_q(f) = H_q(g)$$

for all q .

Definition A.13. A chain map $f : C_* \rightarrow D_*$ is called a quasi-isomorphism if

$$H_q(f) : H_q(C_*) \rightarrow H_q(D_*)$$

is an isomorphism for every q .

Definition A.14. Two chain complexes C_* and D_* are *chain homotopy equivalent* if there exist chain maps

$$f : C_* \rightarrow D_*, \quad g : D_* \rightarrow C_*$$

such that

$$g \circ f \simeq \text{id}_{C_*}, \quad f \circ g \simeq \text{id}_{D_*}.$$

Proposition A.15. *If two chain complexes are chain homotopy equivalent, then they are quasi-isomorphic.*

Proposition A.16. *Let*

$$C_* = \bigoplus_{\alpha \in I} C_*^{(\alpha)}$$

be a direct sum of chain complexes. Then

$$H_q(C_*) \cong \bigoplus_{\alpha \in I} H_q(C_*^{(\alpha)})$$

for every q .

Theorem A.17 (Algebraic universal coefficient theorem for homology). *Let C_* be a chain complex of free abelian groups, and let M be an abelian group. Then for every q there is a natural short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow H_q(C_*) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} M \rightarrow H_q(C_* \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} M) \rightarrow \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_{q-1}(C_*), M) \rightarrow 0.$$

Moreover, this short exact sequence splits, though not naturally in general.

Theorem A.18 (Algebraic universal coefficient theorem for cohomology). *Let C_* be a chain complex of free abelian groups, and let M be an abelian group. Then for every q there is a natural short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(H_{q-1}(C_*), M) \rightarrow H^q(\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(C_*, M)) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(H_q(C_*), M) \rightarrow 0.$$

Moreover, this short exact sequence splits, though not naturally in general.

Theorem A.19 (Algebraic Künneth theorem). *Let C_* and D_* be chain complexes of abelian groups. Assume that one of C_* and D_* is a chain complex of free abelian groups. Then for every n there is a natural short exact sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=n} H_p(C_*) \otimes H_q(D_*) \rightarrow H_n(C_* \otimes D_*) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{p+q=n-1} \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_p(C_*), H_q(D_*)) \rightarrow 0.$$

Moreover, this short exact sequence splits, though not naturally in general.

Remark A.20. Those 3 theorems are about derived tensor / derived Hom. So, freeness is sufficient to compute the derived tensor (free implies flat) / derived Hom (free implies projective).

Let A, B, M be abelian groups. The following identities are frequently used.

- (1) $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A, B) \cong \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(B, A)$.
- (2) $\text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, B)$ is contravariant in A and covariant in B , while $\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A, B)$ is covariant in both variables.
- (3) If F is a flat abelian group (for example, free or fields of characteristic 0), P is a projective abelian group (for example, free), and I is an injective abelian group (for example, $I = \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$), then

$$\text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(F, M) = 0, \quad \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(P, M) = 0, \quad \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, I) = 0.$$

- (4) For every $n \geq 1$,

$$M \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}/n \cong M/nM, \quad \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(\mathbb{Z}/n, M) \cong \{m \in M \mid nm = 0\}, \quad \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(\mathbb{Z}/n, M) \cong M/nM.$$

- (5) For every $m, n \geq 1$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{Z}/m \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}/n &\cong \mathbb{Z}/\text{gcd}(m, n), \\ \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(\mathbb{Z}/m, \mathbb{Z}/n) &\cong \mathbb{Z}/\text{gcd}(m, n), \\ \text{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(\mathbb{Z}/m, \mathbb{Z}/n) &\cong \mathbb{Z}/\text{gcd}(m, n). \end{aligned}$$

(6) We have

$$\mathrm{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(\bigoplus_i A_i, B) \cong \bigoplus_i \mathrm{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A_i, B), \quad \mathrm{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A, \bigoplus_j B_j) \cong \bigoplus_j \mathrm{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A, B_j);$$

and

$$\mathrm{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(\bigoplus_i A_i, M) \cong \prod_i \mathrm{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A_i, M), \quad \mathrm{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, \bigoplus_j B_j) \cong \bigoplus_j \mathrm{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, B_j)$$

whenever A is finitely generated.

(7) If $A \cong \mathbb{Z}^r \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^k \mathbb{Z}/n_i$, then

$$\mathrm{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(A, M) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^k \{m \in M \mid n_i m = 0\},$$

$$\mathrm{Ext}_{\mathbb{Z}}^1(A, M) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^k M/n_i M.$$

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